

*Our Commitment to Carry A.A.'s Message—  
Enthusiasm and Gratitude in Action*

**THE FIFTY-NINTH ANNUAL MEETING  
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE  
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

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*2009  
Final Report*

*Crowne Plaza Times Square, New York, NY April 26–May 2 , 2009*

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### **Confidential—full names used**

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use respects our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications and with media (press, radio, TV, etc.).

## 59th GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

### Our Commitment to Carry A.A.'s Message — Enthusiasm and Gratitude in Action

The 59th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous in the U.S. and Canada met at the Crowne Plaza Times Square, New York, April 26-May 2, 2009.

"This week will be a very busy and spiritually moving experience," said Joe Barrett (Mid-Southern California), the Conference delegate chair, summing up the experience of A.A.'s annual General Service Conference in a nutshell. "We will start early and end late. There may be a time or two during the week that you may (or may not) find it hard to see how our Higher Power is working through us to make the decisions we must make for our Fellowship as a whole, through the exciting tedium and clearly confusing avalanche of information that all of us must digest to reach an informed conscience of the 59th General Service Conference."

The Conference officially opened Sunday afternoon with the roll call by G.S.O. general manager, Phyllis Halliday, followed by greetings from the delegate chair, the Keynote address by trustee-at-large/U.S., Dorothy Wilson, and a general review of the week to come. Conference members then took up the vital committee work at the heart of the Conference as they attended their first committee meetings to address the agenda items each committee had been assigned.

Sunday evening, Conference members and guests gathered for the Conference opening dinner. Before the A.A. meeting, Margaret Carlson-Burnham, past trustee-at-large/U.S. and past delegate, Panel 20 (1970), Western Massachusetts, was asked to speak. Margaret, who was sober 50 years in February, had a captive audience as she spoke of the first Conference dinner she had attended, 39 years ago, as a delegate. No one knew how ill Bill was and that it would be his last Conference.

She also heard Bernard Smith (Class A trustee, 1954-1970) not knowing that this would be his last Conference as well. Bernard Smith, known as the "architect of the Conference," quoted from his famous 1954 talk, "We may not need a General Service Conference to insure our own recovery. We do need it to insure the recovery of the alcoholic who still stumbles in the darkness...." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S19)

Saturday morning, Margaret related, Bill spoke at the closing brunch, saying that he had now been involved in 20 General Service Conferences. He shared that he felt very proud and, although we might live in a perilous era, that our Society would survive, under God's will, for as long as He may need us. In closing, Bill said, "May God bless us forevermore."

Margaret's final words to the 59th Conference were that it is now "Your turn to hold this legacy that has been left to us, gently keeping it safe, and undiluted for all those who shall follow us."

The open A.A. meeting which followed was chaired by Joan Ramsey (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire, New York) and led by Mar-

tin Aire (Western Ontario). Speakers were: Ken Brueggemann (trustee), JoAnne Nelson (Northern Minnesota), Rick Walker (G.S.O. staff), Robert Hill, (South Carolina), and Roberta Lindeman (A.A.W.S. director).

This year's Conference was chaired by Phyllis Halliday, G.S.O. general manager, Leonard Blumenthal (nonalcoholic) trustee, and Joe Barrett, delegate chairperson. Doug Richardson, G.S.O. staff, was the Conference coordinator.

Three observers to this year's Conference were: Claudio Mauricio Teixeira da Silva, trustee-at-large, Brazil; Plinio Barrera Plazas, general manager, G.S.O. Colombia; and Mario Valdivieso Camacho, trustee, General Service Board of Colombia.

A sad note at this Conference was the death, in early April, of general service trustee John Skilton. A Panel 47 delegate from the District of Columbia, John was sober 21 years. "John's dedication and service to Alcoholics Anonymous will be remembered by all who knew him," said John Kane, Northeast regional trustee and a colleague on the A.A.W.S. Board. "His leadership and sensitivity will be greatly missed."

Joe Schranck, Panel 58, Delaware, also died suddenly. Joe had already written his Presentation, "The Grapevine is always..." and his words were read by Frank Ziemba, the alternate delegate.

New York Intergroup hosted a Hospitality Suite for early arrivals, and throughout the week New York A.A. and Al-Anon members arranged tours and activities for the delegates' spouses and guests. Events included visits to Ellis Island, the Brooklyn Museum of Art and the Brooklyn Botanic Garden.

Tuesday afternoon Conference members and their guests took the subway uptown for a visit and tour of the General Service Office and the Grapevine. As usual, the Archives was the hit of the afternoon.

For those who like to begin the day with an A.A. meeting, the GSC Serenity Group met every morning at 7:30 with each day's

#### In Memoriam

Al Herr, the artist whose drawings illustrated the *Final Conference Report* for many years, died this past fall. Al, sober 39 years, was a fixture during Conference week, quietly sitting against the wall or in a corner with his big sketch pad. Once a delegate drew a sketch of Al sketching.

As a tribute we have gone back and retrieved some of his illustrations from past years for this *Final Report*. We hope Al would have been pleased.

topic based on a reading from A.A. literature. The meeting was chaired by Martin Aire (Western Ontario).

The main focus of the Conference is on the deliberations of each of the 13 Conference committees, and it is during the committee meetings that the major work of the Conference is done. After a joint meeting with corresponding trustees' committees, the Conference committees review material and recommendations, weigh and discuss various issues and come up with recommendations which may result in Conference Advisory Actions.

Among the agenda items reviewed at this year's Conference: The Cooperation With the Professional Communities Committee reviewed a draft video directed to professionals in the Employment/Human Resources field, and Finance discussed aspects of self-support. The Literature Committee reviewed revisions of two pamphlets: "A.A. for the Native North American" and "The A.A. Member—Medication and Other Drugs." The Public Information Committee reviewed current television P.S.A.s (Public Service Announcements) and assessed the need for new ones. Archives explored various ways to make A.A.'s Archives and history more readily available to the Fellowship, and Treatment Facilities reviewed the revised video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous*.

Of special interest at the Conference this year were presentations on the 20th World Service Meeting, held in New York City, October 2008, and, while it is still over a year away, excitement is growing about A.A.'s 75th Anniversary celebration at the 13th International Convention, July 1-4, 2010, in San Antonio, Texas.

Wednesday afternoon trustee elections were held. The new Southeast regional trustee will be Eleanor Nault, of South Carolina, replacing Howard Lowery; East Central regional Robert Mayer will be followed by Pamela Reising, of Michigan; and the new trustee-at-large/U.S. will be Don Massey of Louisiana, filling the spot previously held by Dorothy Wilson. New general service trustees are George Martin, of Michigan, who will be a director on the A.A.W.S. Board, and Don Miller, of Colorado on the Grapevine Board.

Delegate chairperson of the 2010 General Service Conference will be Lowell Long, Pennsylvania; alternate chairperson will be Betsy Gerber, of SE Texas.

Also rotating at the end of the Conference was Leonard Blumenthal, L.L.D., who has served on the General Service Board since 2000, and as board chair since 2005. Assuming the responsibilities of chairman of the board is Ward B. Ewing, D.D., of New York City, who has been a Class A trustee since 2004. The new Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees are Frances Brisbane of New York and Corliss Burke, Yukon.

After the final committee reports had been given, the resulting Advisory Actions recorded and the final presentation delivered, the Conference closed early Saturday morning (2:15 am) with the Serenity Prayer in three languages, led by Sylvain Lelièvre, NW Quebec, in French; Antonio Rodriguez, Puerto Rico, in Spanish; and Helon Hill, Mississippi, in English.

Saturday morning Conference members gathered for the last time at the closing brunch, a bittersweet time of farewell talks by rotating trustees: Paul Cleary and Ray Massey, general service trustees; Dorothy Wilson, trustee-at-large/U.S.; Herb Goodman, Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee; Howard Lowery, Southeast regional; Bob Mayer, East Central regional; and Leonard Blumenthal, chairman of the General Service Board.

Then it was time to return home and begin preparations for the 60th General Service Conference—for the process goes on 365 days of the year—in the regions, areas, districts and, most of all, at the top of the triangle, your home group.

## Greetings from Delegate Chairperson

I feel honored and privileged to serve as this year's delegate chair, and I am very much looking forward to working with all of you over the next several days of the 59th General Service Conference.

This week will be a very busy and spiritually moving experience. We will start early and end late. During the week, through the exciting tedium and confusing avalanche of information all of us must digest to reach an informed conscience of the 59th General Service Conference, there may be a time or two, that you may (or may not) find it hard to see how our Higher Power is working through us to make the decisions we must make for our Fellowship as a whole.

We will all share this week in the wonder of witnessing how a bunch of recovering drunks from all across the United States and Canada can join together, putting aside our egos and personal agendas, to do what is best for Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole.

Being here last year was one of the single most influential and powerful experiences I have had the good fortune of being a part of. I would also like to add that being a part of this process has given me a better understanding of the great and solemn duty that rests with us all. This process may not be perfect, but I truly believe it is about as close to perfection that a group of men and women like us will ever have the privilege to be a part of. I would like to invite all of you to join me in this magnificent process.

Last year, during Tuesday night's Delegates Only dinner meeting, my name was drawn from the hat as this year's delegate chair. Just as I was starting to become a little comfortable with the process of this Conference, God, in his infinite wisdom, decided to give me just a little bit more of a challenge. Before the Conference was even halfway through, I started wondering what I was going to be doing at next year's Conference. Man – talk about getting ahead of myself. So, right after that meeting, I went up to my room and called my sponsor. I was already feeling inadequate, way out of my league. So I asked him "Now what am I supposed to do?" He asked me if there was anything that I needed to read that night to help prepare for the next day. I told him no, that I felt that I had read all that I could, and felt good about having a basic knowledge of what was going on. Then he asked me if I had set my alarm and if I had clean clothes to wear in the morning? I told him yes. Then he told me to read page 25 from the Big Book before I went to bed. And I did. I am still amazed at how quickly I forget. No matter how many times it is proven to me, I still need to be reminded about "the great fact" that God is working in miraculous ways! All of this for me is a God thing.

The theme of this year's General Service Conference is "Our Commitment to Carry A.A.'s Message—Enthusiasm and Gratitude in Action."

First of all, I have got to tell you that I love A.A., I love absolutely everything about A.A.—the good and the bad. I love the vast amount of examples that are presented to me through everyone in this Fellowship of how to live, and how not to live. Today, I have an overwhelming sense that everything I know that works well in my life, I learned here in Alcoholics Anonymous, I love it!

When I first darkened the doors of A.A. I wasn't coming to find help for a problem that was destroying the entire fabric that was my life at the time. I came because I needed to get the heat off. I had been homeless for over a year and finally found somebody to take me in and take care of me. But that order of friars became tired of my behavior pretty quick and told me that if I wanted to stay there, I would have to look for help for a problem that I didn't believe I had. So I looked for help. And that is what I found, *Help!* A.A. has helped me in so many ways. I came to A.A. a functional illiterate, and you allowed me into the circle and



taught me to read using the Big Book: I had never balanced my checking account, and you taught me simple accounting; you taught me that if I wanted to feel self-esteem that I needed to do estimable things and that it was impossible to cure loneliness through isolation. I am grateful that when I came into Alcoholics Anonymous I was welcomed into a group of men and women so easily and cheerfully that I felt a part of them right away. And although I was a little angry, and somewhat confused, you made sure that these doors of Alcoholics Anonymous were open wide enough for me to find my way in, and to the seat that you had been keeping warm for me.

For so many years I have been trying to repay this debt, which I owe to all of you for what you have given to me so freely. I have been of service since I can remember being struck sober.

My first commitment was the clean-up guy, sweeping the floors after I put up the chairs. Directly after rotating out of that commitment I was elected into the coffee commitment for that meeting. I was so excited to have "the most important job in all of A.A.," (that was what I was told then, and I still believe it today). And all the while I was keeping an eye out for how well the new guy was putting up the chairs and sweeping the floor.

It seemed that the more work I did the more I was given, and when I tried to give that away I was given even more. It's like this beautifully vicious cycle of unencumbered loving development. That is a fact for me.

After all this time, I still love being a part of something so indescribably wonderful that, for me, transcends reason. You see, it is through this process that I have developed a profound trust, a faith—a faith that works in all aspects of my life.

Every day I thank God for his continual gifts to me, and for that day in May 1990, when I finally came to in A.A. And although I came to scoff, I now remain to pray.

At this time and in this very spot, as we walk hand in hand with our Creator, I would like to welcome all of you to the 59th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous.

*Joe Barrett, Mid-Southern California*

## Keynote

My name is Dorothy Wilson and I am an alcoholic. I cannot begin to describe the heartfelt gratitude that has overwhelmed me since I received my invitation from Doug to give the keynote address to the 59th annual meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous.

It is a joy and special honor for me to share for a few minutes on the Conference theme: "Our Commitment to Carry A.A.'s Message—Enthusiasm and Gratitude in Action." What do we mean by "commitment"? Webster's dictionary states that it is a pledge to do something, a giving in charge or entrusting. When I first walked through the doors of Alcoholics Anonymous, commitment was not a part of my vocabulary. I did not want to commit to anything because I knew that I wouldn't follow through, or if I said I would do anything at all it depended upon how I felt at that time, and usually I was not filled with enthusiasm or gratitude. Everything I did was an effort.

My experience in Alcoholics Anonymous has shown me that our Higher Power has given us the gift of sobriety after we had conceded to our innermost selves that we are powerless over alcohol and we needed help. The Twelfth Step reads: "Having had a spiritual awakening as a result of these steps, we tried to carry this message to alcoholics, and to practice these principles in all our affairs."

So, what is our message? Our message of hope is that we have recovered from a seemingly hopeless state of mind and body.

Wow! Isn't that amazing! What a miracle! It has been my experience that with sobriety comes responsibility and with responsibility comes commitment. I have found that if I put Alcoholics Anonymous first in my life, everything else falls into place. You may ask, How do we carry this message? First and foremost I believe that if we are truly grateful for this miracle in our lives, we will have experienced the importance of working with another alcoholic, remembering that many times we are the only example of the Big Book that some people will ever see. Are we exemplifying ourselves as part of the solution or part of the problem? Are we showing enthusiasm and gratitude for the program? If not, what is missing?

On page 37 of *As Bills Sees It*, there is an article written by Bill W. for the March 1962 Grapevine which reads: "One exercise that I practice is to try for a full inventory of my blessings and then for a right acceptance of the many gifts that are mine — both temporal and spiritual. Here I try to achieve a state of joyful gratitude. When such a brand of gratitude is repeatedly affirmed and pondered, it can finally displace the natural tendency to congratulate myself on whatever progress I may have been enabled to make in some area of living."

"I try hard to hold fast to the truth that a full and thankful heart cannot entertain great conceits. When brimming with gratitude, one's heartbeat must surely result in outgoing love, the finest emotion that we can ever know."

This week will be filled with a lot of emotion. There are Conference members who will bring forward to the floor issues regarding policies and procedures they feel need to be discussed, and these matters may create heated debate. These may not be easy topics to address and there may not be easy answers, but because of our gratitude for our sobriety and our commitment to guard the Traditions and the Concepts, we need to listen, and to listen with love and tolerance; we must also listen to and respect the minority opinion when it is voiced. This willingness to openly and respectfully listen to all voices in our Conference is what makes our spiritualized society work so well.

I believe that each and every one of us present here has a special kind of commitment to Alcoholics Anonymous serving in the capacity that we are serving at this time. We have been delegated a responsibility to carry the message in a different light.

In our personal lives, we make a commitment to carry the message or we ourselves can wither and those who haven't been given the truth may die. Then Tradition One states each member is but a small part of a great whole and our common welfare comes first. Tradition Five states "Each Alcoholics Anonymous group ought to be a spiritual entity *having but one primary purpose*—that of carrying its message to the alcoholic who still suffers." Since we are members of a group, we have a commitment to serve that group by carrying its message.

Our commitment and responsibility as Conference members is written in Concept II: "When, in 1955, the A.A. groups confirmed the permanent charter for their General Service Conference, they thereby delegated to the Conference complete authority for the active maintenance of our world services and thereby made the Conference—excepting for any change in the Twelve Traditions or in Article 12 of the Conference Charter—the actual voice and the effective conscience for our whole Society."

We are here this week to be the voice for Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole and not for our personal agendas. As we move forward this week, my hope would be that we treat each other with love and respect and remember that there is but one ultimate authority—a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience.

*Dorothy Wilson, trustee-at-large/U.S.*

# Conference Advisory Actions

*Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 2009 Conference.*

## AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 1 The theme for the 2010 General Service Conference be: "Practicing A.A.'s Principles—the Pathway to Unity."
- 2 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2010 General Service Conference:
  - a) Practicing These Principles in All Our "Service" Affairs:
    - 1) What is the Difference Between General Service and Service in General?
    - 2) Love and Tolerance is Our Code.
    - 3) Setting an Example—Attraction to Service.
  - b) Unity Through Inventory:
    - 1) Our Common Welfare Should Come First.
    - 2) This We Owe to A.A.'s Future.
    - 3) What Happens After Inventory?
  - c) General Service Conference Agenda Selection Process:
    - 1) How it Works.
    - 2) Collective Participation.
    - 3) Communication—The Key to an Informed Decision.
- 3 The following be the workshop topic for the 2010 General Service Conference: "Discuss the General Service Conference Agenda Selection Process" and that all background provided to the 2009 Conference Agenda Committee regarding the "General Service Conference Agenda Selection Process," be sent to the members of the 60th General Service Conference in February 2010 as background for the 2010 Conference workshop session along with any additional related background material that may be compiled by the General Service Board, the trustees' Committee on the Conference, the General Service Office or other sources.

## ARCHIVES<sup>1</sup>

No recommendations.

## COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

It was recommended that:

- 4 The video segments directed to professionals in the employment/human relations field to be streamed on to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site be approved.

## CORRECTIONS

It was recommended that:

- 5 The trustees' Committee on Corrections undertake a revision of the pamphlet, "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," which will take into consideration:
  - More stories of recovery from alcoholism through the prin-

ciples of Alcoholics Anonymous, drawn from *Sharing From Behind the Walls*, Box 4-5-9 or other available sources.

- Less use of 'directive' language (such as that used in the section on H.A.L.T.).
- Including photographs that reflect current times.

and that a draft pamphlet or a progress report be brought back to the 2010 Conference Committee on Corrections.

- 6 The photo on page 18 of the pamphlet, "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," which shows an inmate smoking a hand-rolled cigarette, be replaced with a photo of the current edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, in future reprints, as well as in any revision.

## FINANCE

It was recommended that:

- 7 The trustees' Finance Committee gather input from the Fellowship on the following for review by the 2010 Conference Committee on Finance:
  - a) If we continue to use literature profits to partially fund services, should there be a limit?
  - b) If there is a limit how do we continue to pay for services if there is a shortfall in contributions?(The committee requests that the statement of policy "Self-Support of the World Services of Alcoholics Anonymous" be distributed as background.)
- 8 A discussion of additional ways to communicate with the Fellowship about Self-Support be included on the agenda for the Conference Finance Committee for the 60th General Service Conference.

## GRAPEVINE

No recommendations.

## INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS<sup>1</sup>

It was recommended that:

- 9 An anonymity-protected photograph of the flag ceremony be taken at the 2010 International Convention.
- 10 An encrypted, anonymity-protected Internet broadcast of the 2010 International Convention Opening Flag Ceremony be approved.

## LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

- 11 The revised draft pamphlet, "A.A. for the Native North American," be approved.
- 12 The trustees' Literature Committee undertake a thorough review of the pamphlet, "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship," and eliminate or revise outmoded ethnic, cultural and vocational references.
- 13 A Special Needs recovery pamphlet for newcomers or prospective members be developed and that stories be solicited from members with various special needs, for example, members

<sup>1</sup>Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

who are deaf, blind, wheel-chair bound, etc. [Note: The approximate cost is \$6,850.]

- 14 A sentence encouraging newcomers to obtain and study the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, be added to the pamphlet, "A Newcomer Asks."
- 15 The title of the pamphlet, "44 Questions," be changed to "Frequently Asked Questions About A.A."

## POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

- 16 Frank Ziemba, alternate delegate, Area 12, Delaware, be seated as a Conference member at the 59th General Service Conference because Joe Schranck, the Panel 58 delegate for Area 12, passed away.
- 17 Claudio Mauricio Teixeira da Silva from the General Service Board of Brazil, Mario Valdivieso Comacho from the General Service Board of Colombia and Plinio Barrera Plazas, manager, G.S.O. Colombia, be admitted to the 59th General Service Conference as observers.
- 18 The 62nd General Service Conference be held April 22-28, 2012 since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays, hotel availability and Bylaws' deadlines of the General Service Board, Inc.
- 19 The General Service Board develop a procedure for the submission of Concept V minority appeals to the General Service Conference and bring a draft to the 2010 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee for their review.

The committee asked that the following questions from the report, "Trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference Subcommittee on Forwarding Minority Reports and Presentations to the General Service Conference" be addressed in the proposed procedure:

- a) To whom does the minority announce that it intends to present a minority report to the Conference?
  - b) What is the deadline for making such a decision?
  - c) What Conference members, if any, are given advance notice of the decision?
  - d) Who is responsible for seeing that the minority report and its documentation are in fact physically made available to the Conference?
  - e) What is the deadline for distributing the minority report and its documentation?
  - f) To whom are the minority report and its documentation given?
- 20 The General Service Board develop a plan for the General Service Conference to conduct an inventory of itself that includes a planning committee consisting of representatives of delegates, trustees, directors, nontrustee directors, and staff, and that a progress report be presented to the 2010 Policy/Admissions Committee.

## PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

- 21 The updated pamphlet, "A Message to Teenagers," containing text and graphics from the current "Too Young?" pamphlet, be approved with minor changes.

22 The wall poster for young people with information about Alcoholics Anonymous be approved with minor changes.

23 A new A.A. television public service announcement be developed for review by the 2010 Conference Committee on Public Information at a cost not to exceed \$40,000, and that full faces of actors portraying A.A. members not be shown in this P.S.A.

24 The revised script for "Combination Radio P.S.A.s on CD," omitting P.S.A. #15, be approved with minor changes and recorded at a cost not to exceed \$20,000.

Note: The committee suggested that older alcoholics and alcoholics with special needs be portrayed in this P.S.A.

25 The four selected A.A. Videos for Young People be approved with minor changes.

26 The videos, "A.A.—Rap With Us" and "Young People and A.A.," be discontinued.

27 The draft 2010 Membership Survey Questionnaire be approved.

## REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

28 The sentence "A nontrustee director can serve up to four one-year terms" be added to the end of the section "Choosing Nontrustee Directors for A.A. World Services and The A.A. Grapevine" on page S75 of *The A.A. Service Manual combined with Twelve Concepts for World Service* so that it reads as follows:

"The remaining candidates are interviewed by the corporate board's nominating committee, which recommends a nominee to the full board. The name and resume of the nominee are then forwarded to the trustees' Nominating Committee, for approval by the General Service Board and the General Service Conference. Per the A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine Bylaws, a nontrustee director can serve up to four one-year terms."

29 All changes to *The A.A. Service Manual combined with Twelve Concepts for World Service* be listed in the edition in which the changes appear for the first time, and organized by source of change (General Service Board, Conference Advisory Action, Conference Committee on Report & Charter, Publications Department). Conference Advisory Actions will be noted by vertical margin change bars in the edition in which the change appears for the first time.

30 The General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. Board and the A.A. Grapevine Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual combined with Twelve Concepts for World Service* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter.

31 The title "Conference Language" on page S19 be changed to "Glossary of General Service Terms" and that the subheading "A glossary of terms frequently used in general service activities" be removed.

32 The last sentence of page S70 of the 2008-2009 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual combined with Twelve Concepts for World Service* in the section "Appointed Committee Members" be changed from "The term of service is four years, renewed on a yearly basis" to "Appointed Committee Members are appointed for one year, but the term may be extended depending on committee projects (maximum four years)."

Note: This language makes the description of the terms

of service of Appointed Committee Members consistent with the language in the trustees' Committee on Nominating Procedure No. 2, "Procedures for Selecting Appointed Committee Members for General Service Board Committees."

- 33** Area numbers be inserted next to area names in Appendix D, pages S105 and S106 of *The A.A. Service Manual combined with Twelve Concepts for World Service*.

## TREATMENT FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

- 34** The revised video, *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous*, be approved.
- 35** The committee's scope be expanded to include service to Special Needs/Accessibilities committees and that the name of the committee be changed to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities/Special Needs/Accessibilities.

## TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

- 36** The following slates of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. in May 2009:

### Class A

|                            |                     |
|----------------------------|---------------------|
| Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE | Ward B. Ewing, D.D. |
| Frances L. Brisbane, Ph.D. | The Honorable       |
| Corliss Burke              | Rogelio R. Flores   |
| William D. Clark, M.D.     | Jeanne S. Woodford  |

### Class B

|                        |                      |
|------------------------|----------------------|
| Kenneth P. Brueggemann | Don Massey           |
| Conley F. Byrd, Jr.    | Don Miller           |
| Dorothy L. Hurley      | Eleanor W. Nault     |
| John J. Kane, Jr.      | Madeleine J. Parmley |
| Jo-Anne Lowenberger    | Victor Phillips      |
| George G. Martin       | Pamela Reising       |

Note: The General Service Board will operate short one Class B regional trustee and one Class B general service trustee.

On April 27, 2009 the General Service Board approved a motion that the trustees' Nominating committee, in consultation with the A.A.W.S. Board, consider actions to fill the vacant general service trustee position and report their conclusions to the General Service Board at its summer 2009 meeting. At that time the General Service Board may choose to appoint a Class B general service trustee.

### Officers of the General Service Board

|                                |                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------|
| <i>Chairperson</i>             | Ward B. Ewing, D.D.        |
| <i>First vice-chairperson</i>  | Madeleine J. Parmley       |
| <i>Second vice-chairperson</i> | William D. Clark, M.D.     |
| <i>Treasurer</i>               | Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE |
| <i>Secretary</i>               | Conley F. Byrd, Jr.        |

- 37** The February 2009 appointment of the following officers by the chair of the General Service Board be approved at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in May 2009:

|                            |                  |
|----------------------------|------------------|
| <i>Assistant Treasurer</i> | Donald W. Meurer |
| <i>Assistant Secretary</i> | Adrienne Brown*  |

This appointment process is in accordance with the 2007 General Service Board Bylaws.

- 38** The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. World Services Corporate Board in May 2009:

|                     |                     |
|---------------------|---------------------|
| Andrea G. Barthwell | Jo-Anne Lowenberger |
| Adrienne Brown*     | George G. Martin    |
| Phyllis A. Halliday | William Noonan      |
| John J. Kane, Jr.   | Victor Phillips     |
| Roberta Lindeman    |                     |

- \* To be replaced at G.S.O. staff rotation, July 2009.

Note: The Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. Board will operate with the Class B trustee-at-large/Canada serving as a director, replacing a Class B general service trustee director.

- 39** The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board in May 2009:

|                     |                   |
|---------------------|-------------------|
| Ginger Rhoades Bell | Nancy Haynes      |
| Robin Bromley       | Dorothy L. Hurley |
| Kenneth Brueggemann | Don Miller        |
| Conley F. Byrd, Jr. | Albin Zezula      |

Note: The Grapevine Corporate Board will operate short one Class A trustee director.

- 40** In light of the extensive confidential information in the trustees' election resumes, resumes of all election candidates would no longer be made available to all Conference members immediately prior to the Conference trustees' election session. Distribution of trustee resumes at the Conference would be limited to only voting delegates and members of the Conference Committee on Trustees and the trustees' Committee on Nominating. The resumes of the elected trustees would be distributed to all Conference members immediately after the election session.

Note: The purpose of this suggested limited distribution of Conference trustee election resumes is to emphasize the General Service Board's and the Conference's commitment to protecting the confidentiality of trustee candidates' resume information.

## FLOOR ACTIONS REFERRED TO A COMMITTEE

It was recommended that:

- The revised 59th Conference pamphlet, "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs," be returned to the trustees' Literature Committee for additional discussion and report back to the 2010 Conference Committee on Literature.

Note: This Floor Action refers to the *draft* pamphlet reviewed by the 2009 Conference Literature Committee. (The initial Conference Literature Committee recommendation to approve this pamphlet as submitted was defeated.)

- We develop Conference-approved literature that focuses on spirituality and includes stories from atheists and agnostics who are successfully sober in Alcoholics Anonymous. (**Referred to the 2010 Conference Literature Committee**)

# Presentations and Reports

## FINANCE REPORT

*Monday afternoon, the Finance report, followed by questions and sharing, was given by Terry Bedient, treasurer of the General Service Board and chairman of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. For more details please see the finance section of this Report, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary report.*

My name is Terry Bedient and I am a grateful Class A trustee and treasurer of the General Service Board. It is my privilege to deliver the Treasurer's report to the 59th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The complete report of our independent auditor, Owen J. Flanagan and Company, will be included in the finance section of the Final Conference Report. Flanagan's audit partner, Kevin Sunkel, is here this afternoon and available to answer any questions that may arise from this report. Also available today and throughout the week are Don Meurer, chief financial officer of the General Service Office, and Eugene O'Brien, controller of the A.A. Grapevine.

Since this is my first Conference experience, the finance report format will be similar to that used by Vince Keefe in previous years. However, we will be working on some format changes for next year.

The PowerPoint presentation is designed to show key points of the financial position of the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, and the A.A. Grapevine. Our goal is to help you become as familiar as possible with our financial condition so that you will be able to communicate clearly when you return to your area. I believe that a sure way to improve the service structure is for each of us to develop a clear understanding of the finances of the Fellowship. Clarity in our understanding translates to clarity in our communications. Your area will be listening carefully to what you have to report after this Conference, so let us know what you may need in order to enhance the communication.

This presentation is organized into five basic components: (1) our General Service Office, (2) A.A.W.S. Publishing activities, (3) La Viña, (4) The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and (5) the General Service Board Reserve Fund. We will primarily focus on the results for the calendar year 2008, though prior year results and 2009 budget information are also included to permit a broader perspective.

Our first chart summarizes the cost of the service functions performed at your General Service Office on behalf of the General Service Board. I am sure that we are all familiar with each function listed, with the possible exception of the last line entitled Supporting Services. Supporting Services includes the administrative, accounting, human resources, information technology, rent, and other indirect overhead costs. It would be difficult for the various service functions to operate without this support structure. The total cost of the General Service Office functions for 2008 was \$9,447,260, approximately \$919,181 or 11% more than the \$8,528,079 spent in 2007.

### *Some explanations of increase:*

While some of the expenses showed increases, some showed decreases. 2008 was a World Service Meeting (in New York) year and the net cost of the WSM, which falls to the G.S.O. U.S./Canada, was \$225,000. Ap-

proximately \$85,000 additional was spent in the trustees category as the cost of searching for both the new general manager and the new chairman of the General Service Board falls here. In addition, the cost of the Conference increased from 2007 to 2008 by approximately \$113,000. I'm sure everyone is aware of the increase in the travel and hotel costs for the first half of last year. This is the primary reason we sought other venues to hold the Conference.

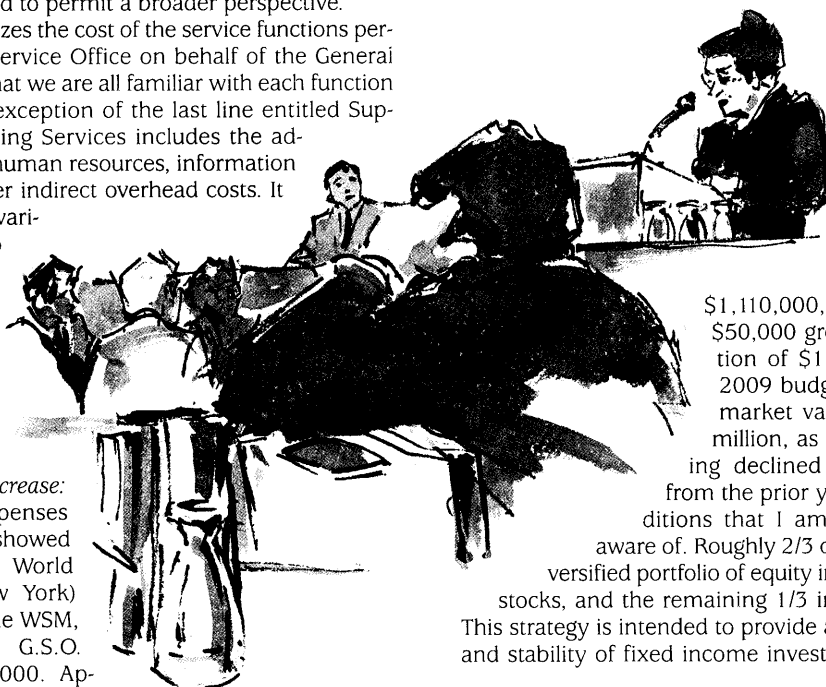
**Health Insurance Benefits for Retirees:** For many years we have offered health insurance coverage to our retirees. For each retired employee, we currently pay between 25% and 75% of this cost, depending on the length of service of the individual employee; the retiree pays the remainder. Until 2006, this practice was done on a "pay as you go" basis—no funds were set aside to pay future benefits. When the insurance bills came in, we paid them, and that was that. Generally Accepted Accounting Principles requires that our financial statements include an expense each year for a portion of the amount that will be paid for or on behalf of current employees during their retired years. As a result, each year a liability has been recorded for a portion of the future medical insurance payments, which will be made for the benefit of our current employees after their retirement. This liability as of 12/31/08 was \$3,965,968 and appears in the balance sheet included in your Conference Manual. The liability decreased \$156,349 from the 12/31/07 balance of \$4,122,317. Given the size of this liability, we decided in 2006 that it would be prudent to create a fund, separate from our Reserve Fund, to accumulate money to help pay these future benefits. Our goal is a modest one – to fund half of the balance sheet liability within the next 10 years. Payments have been made into this fund by A.A.W.S. and the A.A. Grapevine in the amounts of \$228,092 for 2006, and \$250,992 for 2007 and \$251,000 for 2008. We plan to make comparable payments into the fund each year for the foreseeable future. Premium payments to the insurance companies will continue to be made from the operating accounts of A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine, and not from the new fund.

**Defined Benefit Pension Plan:** The boards established a defined benefit pension plan in 1965 to provide pension benefits to A.A.W.S. and Grapevine employees. A contribution is made to this

plan each year by each of the corporations, and the plan then handles the monthly retirement payments. The amount of the contribution is based on the advice of our actuaries in order to assure that all legal requirements are being met. The contribution to the pension plan in 2008 amounted to

\$1,110,000, which was approximately \$50,000 greater than 2007. A contribution of \$1,430,000 is included in the 2009 budget. The pension fund had a market value of slightly less than \$11 million, as of December 31, 2008, having declined approximately \$3,000,000 from the prior year due to stock market conditions that I am sure everyone is painfully aware of. Roughly 2/3 of this fund is invested in a diversified portfolio of equity investments, such as common

stocks, and the remaining 1/3 in fixed income investments. This strategy is intended to provide a balance between the safety and stability of fixed income investments with the potential for



long-term growth provided by equity investments. In the short term, of course, common stocks exhibit much more volatility in value. One effect of the 2006 pension law will be that changes in the value of the Pension Trust portfolio will have a bigger effect on annual contribution requirements than they did in the past. Our annual obligation to contribute to the pension fund will thus be an increasingly important element in the cash flow planning of our A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors and management for the foreseeable future.

You will find in our consolidated balance sheet a net unfunded pension liability of about \$8,102,000 as of December 31, 2008. This is approximately \$3,500,000 more than the amount you would have seen in our financial statements last year and again most of the increase is due to the stock market decline this past year. These liabilities represent a commitment to future payments over a very long period of time, and with the continued support of the Fellowship, we should be able to meet these requirements.

The next chart is very similar to the first, except in this slide Supporting Services have been allocated across the activities to show the fully absorbed cost of each activity. Group and member statistics are shown at the bottom of the slide. We can see that an annual contribution of only \$7.04 per member or \$157.21 per group in 2008 would have allowed the Services to be fully self-supporting from contributions.

Chart #5 shows a detailed breakdown of the Group Services activities. This slide is intended to give a broader understanding of the range of services performed by the General Service Office on behalf of each group. The next few slides explore the question of how we pay for these important service functions. As you know, the General Service Board has three sources of funds: group contributions, A.A.W.S. literature profits and transfers from the Reserve Fund.

In 2008 the General Service Board received group contributions of \$6,462,760, which was a decrease of \$63,000, or just less than 1 % from last year. This is the first time in many years that contributions, made to support the activities of your General Service Office, have declined. I am sure I speak for everyone throughout our entire service structure when I say how deeply grateful we are for this support from across the Fellowship considering these tough times. We are grateful for every member who has sent in a contribution to help pay the bills of your General Service Office. A spe-

cial word of thanks to all the delegates, D.C.M.s, and G.S.R.s who worked to help make this strong result possible. Your hard work is most evident by looking at these gratifying results. The three things I hope you continue to do well are: communicate, communicate, and communicate.

Chart #7 summarizes the financial performance of A.A.W.S. publishing activities. Gross sales of literature in 2008 amounted to \$12,777,000, which was about \$47,000 or just less than 1 % greater than 2007. After deducting the cost of goods sold and shipping and warehousing costs there remains a gross profit of \$6,951,900, or 55.9 % of sales. We then deduct Program Expenses of \$2,504,744 and Supporting Expenses of \$1,740,228, leaving an Excess of Revenue over Expenses of \$2,706,929. In reviewing this chart last year, Vince Keefe noted a steady decline in the Gross Profit percentage. The A.A.W.S. Board has addressed this concern.

La Viña (Chart #8), our Spanish-language magazine, reported slightly worsening financial results for 2008. Gross Profit from the sale of magazines and related items equaled \$44,890, a decrease of \$22,891 from 2007. After deducting the costs and expenses of \$121,154, the result is a loss for 2008 of \$76,264. This compares to a loss in 2007 of \$(67,040).

The A.A. Grapevine incurred a loss as well. You will hear, in detail, about the extensive work underway to solve a myriad of issues before the Grapevine Board. The A.A. Grapevine reported total magazine income of \$2,076,060 in 2008. Magazine gross profit was approximately \$1,249,220. Gross Profit from related items was approximately \$491,197, giving a total Gross Profit of \$1,740,417. Total costs and expenses of \$1,945,073, less Interest Income of \$66,200, are then deducted, leaving a loss for 2008 of \$138,456. The Grapevine budget for 2009 anticipates a loss of slightly less than \$167,500.

You will hear more about this from me next year, but it appears that we have put the Grapevine in a no-win situation. Here is what we have done: **first**, we ask very capable and committed individuals to take on the responsibility of being directors of the Grapevine, **second**, we ask them to maintain the very precious tradition of being the independent voice of our Fellowship, and **third**, we ask them to be sure that the Grapevine remains self-supporting. After all of this, many of us then hesitate when it comes time to subscribe to the magazine. How can the Grapevine ever meet our expectations without the support of all of us?



For the past few years, Vince had spoken about the positive impact that 100 new subscribers per delegate area could have on the Grapevine's mission and financial status. Thanks in large part to your efforts circulation went up a little more than 2,100 in 2007, and 2,200 in 2008, reversing the downward trend we had seen in past years.

Chart #10 shows a combined financial overview of the General Service Board for the year ended December 31, 2008. The General Service Office shows contributions, interest and literature profits totaling \$9,171,895. We then subtract the cost of services provided of \$9,447,260, leaving a deficit for 2008 of \$275,365. Next we subtract the operating losses of the A.A. Grapevine (\$138,456) and La Viña (\$76,264), leaving a net combined deficit of \$490,085 for 2008.

The last part of our analysis will cover the General Service Board Reserve Fund. The Reserve Fund ended 2008 with an adjusted balance of \$11,920,756, equal to approximately 9.3 months of operating expenses. This means that we remain in the lower end of the acceptable range in terms of the number of months of expenses covered. The Reserve Fund at the end of 2007 was the equivalent of 9.6 months of operating expenses.

I would like to remind everyone again of the key actions that have been taken in recent years to maintain the Reserve Fund within an acceptable range. As you know we have:

- Reduced the price of the Big Book by \$1 coincident with the publication of the 4th edition.
- Restored the price of the Big Book in July 2004 by raising the price by \$1.
- Announced increases in certain book prices and handling charges effective July 1, 2005.
- Accomplished a major cost reduction program at the General Service Office to lower our annual operating costs.
- Both A.A.W.S. and the A.A. Grapevine have announced price increases to be effective during 2009.

As a result of these actions, the Reserve Fund has fluctuated between 12 equivalent months of operating expenses in calendar 2000 to 9.3 months at the end of 2008. So, what can we say about our financial condition as we end 2008 and move along into 2009? Here are some thoughts:

- Our Pension and Post retirement health obligations now account for 12% of the annual General Service Office budget. We will need to sustain this annual level of fund payments of approximately \$1,600,000 well into the future. In spite of the size of this obligation, we are managing our expenses to stay within our revenue stream.

- The management teams and boards of both operating corporations continue to perform extremely well and remain a true asset to the Fellowship.

- Group contributions were 1% lower in 2008 as compared to 2007. We are pretty sure that this is a result of the economic times or we would have seen another growth year. I believe that each delegate in the room today deserves a "tip of the hat" for a job well done. And, of course, the biggest accolades go to our contributing members. Thank you from everyone involved in the Service Structure of the Fellowship. Your contributions make it possible for our General Service Office to work tirelessly in the background of Twelfth Step work.

- The Grapevine and La Viña were both slightly off in financial performance in 2008. While La Viña subscriptions dipped slightly the Grapevine circulation did increase.

- A.A.W.S. finished the year with a slight deficit due to several factors, but they have addressed Vince's concern last year that they "might find it useful to look more closely at the recent decline in the percentage of gross profit on literature."

- The Reserve Fund declined just slightly from covering 9.6 months of expenses at the end of 2007 to 9.3 months at the end of 2008. This performance is undoubtedly influenced somewhat by a lower level of contributions and essentially flat literature sales. At the end of 2008, there were no excess funds to transfer to the Reserve Fund. Yet we shouldn't overlook the good management and attention to detail shown by our general manager, financial staffs, and operating boards; 2008 was another year of very good work.

- Some of you may know that as a result of a 1977 Conference Advisory Action our auditor is asked to comment annually on the availability, feasibility and adequacy of the Reserve Fund. Following are some of his comments:





"The question of 'adequacy' is considered in relation to the ability of the Reserve Fund balance to meet any circumstances or conditions in the foreseeable future. As stated in prior reports, while we believe that the assets of the Fund are sufficient to allow A.A. to meet any such demands in the short-term, we continue to be concerned about the long-term liabilities for pension and health benefits to retirees."

The auditor then describes his longer term concerns:

"Due to economic circumstances and market conditions, which are largely beyond the control of management, these liabilities have grown at a pace well above the inflation rate. Even more significantly, the meltdown in U.S. and global financial markets that began late in 2007, and continues at the time of this report, has decreased the value of the investments, which have been set aside to address those liabilities, particularly and most significantly, with the pension plan."

He notes steps taken to date to address these issues:

"Although management and the board of directors recognized this problem several years ago and have increased funding to address it, progress on these liabilities has been difficult, at best. It is also worth noting that the separate assets and liabilities of the pension plan itself make it a financial entity comparable in size to G.S.O.'s combined operating and Reserve Funds."

He then speaks of a possible use of the Reserve Fund:

"Therefore, if market conditions were to further deteriorate, it could eventually reach a point where the funding required from operations to meet these obligations might require assistance from the Reserve Fund so as not to severely impact current programs."

He again notes management has taken steps to address the issues:

"We do recognize that the positive operating budget approved for 2009 already includes an additional \$320,000 for pension funding, which should help alleviate these concerns, but also recognize that the net pension liability grew by \$3,500,000 in 2008."

He then ends his report with:

"Accordingly, with the current uncertainty of financial markets, the potential impact of an economy in recession on the ability of A.A. to continue to fund these costs out of operations alone, we would have to consider that the present level of the Reserve Fund is *not adequate* to meet A.A.'s long-term needs."

In closing, I am pleased to acknowledge the extraordinary talent and dedication that I am privileged to observe as treasurer. I say "thank you" to members of all the finance and audit committees who sort through enormous finance detail throughout the year. Thank you to Phyllis Halliday and Robin Bromley for competently overseeing our operating corporations. And a very special thank you to Don Meurer and Eugene O'Brien, our talented and dedicated finance managers. Don and Eugene tirelessly supervise our accounting activities but, more importantly, they guide our strategic financial planning.

2009 will undoubtedly be marked with some uncertainty and perhaps some surprises due to the hard economic times, but there



will be new faces, and plenty of opportunities for the Fellowship to continue to prosper. Let's just "keep on doing what we are doing," always trying to be a little better, and 2009 will be another good year for the Fellowship.

Thank you for your friendship and for your attention!

*Terrance M. Bedient, treasurer  
General Service Board*

## HUMILITY AND SACRIFICE

*Monday evening's presentations were moderated by Bob Mayer, East Central regional trustee.*

### Setting an Example

When I first started to write about this topic, my thoughts went back to early sobriety when I was taught so many things from the oldtimers. I realized that in my journey of sobriety and service in A.A., I have experienced two kinds of people. I have had people who set an example by their enthusiasm and gratitude. They are the ones that made me want to be like them. I had to have what they had. When I felt like getting drunk in early sobriety, because life was just too much, their words and actions helped me, even if they weren't around. I felt that maybe, just maybe, if I could stay away from a drink long enough, I too, could be, as they were. These are the feelings I get when someone shares with enthusiasm and gratitude. These actions offer hope and healing. I was attracted to what I saw and felt, and I kept coming back. I wanted to participate; I wanted to be a part of and help in any way that I could.

In service, there are many people, like those I have described, who have helped me along the way. I will never forget one man who really catapulted me into service. His name was Harold; we called him Moses. He was a lovely man, full of gratitude and action. The moment he walked into a room, I felt better. I knew that everything was going to be okay because Harold was there. He helped me get started doing Corrections service. The night that we were



to start a new meeting in our local jail, he told me something I will never forget. He said, "John, if you want someone to talk about you in A.A., just do something. They will talk because they are jealous and envy you. It doesn't matter, just keep doing it and take no offense. Service is not about you; it's about getting out of you. If you do service in A.A., with no motive, you will be rocketed into a new dimension. If you want to see the face of God, simply put your hand on the suffering alcoholic's shoulder, that's where you will see Him." The way he talked and walked with me made me want it. He was right. I love service in Alcoholics Anonymous because it is gratitude in action that fills the hole that used to be there. These types of people have become my leaders, mentors, sponsors, good friends and, at times, lifesavers.

The other type of person I have encountered is the one who, by example, shows me what it can be like to be a miserable sober member. This type has become a great example and teacher of what I do not want to be and what not to do in A.A. I do not get too close to this kind of person, but I do support them in their journey.

Then I started to think of what kind of example are we to set as delegates. In *The A.A. Service Manual*, page 39, Bill states in Concept IX, "Our leaders do not drive by mandate, they lead by example." Later he also states, "A leader in A.A. service is therefore a man (or woman) who can personally put principles, plans and policies into such dedicated and effective action that the rest of us want to back him up and help him with his job." As we meet here at this 59th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous, what sort of example are we setting? Is there harmony and trust among us? Are we willing to back our trustees, management and staff? As we go out from here, will we share the wonderful service that is being done around the world by our dedicated servants? When we report on the Conference, I pray that it is a positive message to help inspire involvement and inclusion. We hold the commitment to set an example for A.A. as a whole. If we are enthusiastic, grateful and humble, we will attract participation and support from all levels.

I have to remember one thing about being a leader. When someone is a leader, they will make mistakes. The more that we lead and do service for A.A., the more decisions we have to make; consequently, we will make more mistakes. We have natural leaders in our Fellowship. They may start off as a G.S.R., then become a D.C.M., and eventually a delegate. This does not happen by mistake. These leaders in A.A. have displayed some kind of an example to merit electing them to their respective positions. They have studied A.A.'s Traditions and Concepts and led by the examples in them. Surely they have done well, but along the way have made more mistakes with taking on a larger service position each time. I know that this has happened to me. The longer I am involved in service and the lower I have traveled down the upside-down pyramid, the more mistakes I have made. This is natural, and it is okay.

We have the responsibility to correct any flaws and mistakes in our structure, which is one of the reasons we meet here every year. Certainly, there are going to be mistakes at our General Service Office, General Service Board and Grapevine—nothing is perfect. I am sure of two things, though. First, we have put a tremendous load on our trusted servants and on our General Service Board. We expect them to carry out the directives we have set forth from the General Service Conference. That is what the trustees are directed to do and that is the service that they obviously wanted to do when they stood for the position. Second, there is nothing in A.A. that cannot be undone. That is the beautiful aspect of our structure. We can fix anything in A.A. if we determine we are going down the wrong path. We can support our servants and display true leadership by being a solution-oriented Conference and aiding them in these endeavors. These kinds of

actions and examples permeate throughout our Fellowship, just as negative actions flow out from here and affect our Fellowship as a whole.

One of our tasks is to report to the Fellowship. I feel as leaders we can report with a positive tone, making sure that there is no "us" and "them." We have the opportunity to enthusiastically report on a Fellowship that is being run with great care and diligence. The Fellowship needs positive, not negative, examples.

I believe that good leadership in Alcoholics Anonymous starts with setting a good example. It is essential that, in order to truly get support, you have to show enthusiasm. Why would anyone follow someone who is not excited in service? Why would anyone want to support a cause if there is negativity and rebellion?

In my home group, district and area, I want to be a good example. I pray that in my endeavors to carry the message I express enthusiasm and gratitude for every facet of A.A. This I owe to Alcoholics Anonymous for giving me not only one of the biggest joys in my life for being a servant, but for saving this hopeless, broken soul.

John Antol, Tennessee

## Changing Our Perceptions

Changing our perceptions is a topic we are all familiar with. Everyone here has had to change perception in order to admit powerlessness over alcohol. We have all had to change our understanding in order to accept the spiritual solution offered in A.A.'s Twelve Steps. Our basic text warns us if we hold onto our old ideas, the result is nil until we let go absolutely. Yes, we're all familiar with the topic or we wouldn't be here tonight.

What, however, does this topic mean to us as Conference members? Humility? Sacrifice? You mean Tradition Two asks me to be a leader and a servant at the same time? What alcoholic ego can possibly rise to such a request? We are familiar with who makes up the Conference. We all know by virtue of what position we became General Service Conference members. He is a first-year delegate. She is a trustee. The "who" is not questioned. We are all familiar with why we have a Conference. We read Bernard Smith's essay on why we need a Conference already this week, and it will be referenced again before the week is out. The "why" is not in question either. Perhaps changing our perceptions as it relates to us Conference members means paying a little more attention to what the Conference is or was intended to be. Let's examine the "what" a little further.

According to Concept II, the Conference is "*the active voice and the effective conscience of our whole Society in its world affairs.*" The long form says "actual," but I'm going to say "active," because my experience is that action is required in the consummation of our Three Legacies. The short form of Concept I states "final responsibility and ultimate authority...should always reside in the collective conscience of our whole Fellowship." Combine that idea with Concept II's proposal that the Conference is the active voice and the effective conscience of the Fellowship referenced in Concept I, and if you're like me you'll be overwhelmed with the burden of responsibility. The active voice and the effective conscience of our whole Society is a spiritual theory, but if we are diligent as Conference members, it is possible to live it.

The service spectrum is flanked by extremes. There are those who will question nothing, smile, nod and vote affirmatively to each suggestion offered. Similarly, there are those who question everything and everyone, scowl, express suspicion, and vote negatively to all suggestions other than their own. Neither extreme is useful to our Fellowship, and the "loving God as He may express himself in our group conscience," is nonexistent if an individual

Conference member thoughtlessly votes in the affirmative, or is suspicious to the point he or she can vote positive on nothing. You may think that a harsh statement, but let's look at it a minute.

If we vote a particular way just because the rest of our region is voting that way, or when we vote "yes" just because we aren't interested and didn't read the background material, the result is an *ineffective* conscience. If we argue every point, attempt to bring suspicion and controversy to every debate, or vote in the negative just because someone else is voting in favor, the result is a *reactive* voice. When a reactive voice meets an ineffective conscience, the result is anything but the active voice and the effective conscience of our Fellowship. The result is as far from Tradition Two's "loving God as he may express himself in our group conscience" as you can get.

So what do we do to combat a reactive voice or ineffective conscience of the Conference? Most of us don't want to define ourselves in one of the extremes, but changing our perceptions through humility and sacrifice will bring us to realize that we have inclinations in one direction or the other.

Humility requires an open mind, and the sacrifice of ego and fear. Open-mindedness does not mean we hold no opinion. After all, we all come to this level of service with our experience, our observations, and our knowledge of the spiritual principles contained in our Steps, Traditions, and Concepts. To ignore that experience and knowledge is wasteful. No, open-mindedness merely means entertaining the idea that our opinion might be wrong, and to entertain it long enough to listen to each other and humbly apply our experience and knowledge to see if, in fact, our viewpoints are derived from spiritual principle, or from fear and ego. Opinions are sometimes nothing more than old ideas disguised as knowledge and experience, so open-mindedness must remain after opinions are formed. Have you ever voted a particular way because you were afraid of what your friends would think? Have you ever voted a particular way because you were afraid of what would happen if you didn't? Quite honestly, I have. And there's no room for that here. Our Fellowship is depending on us. If we want the voice to be active, the conscience to be effective, we must humbly listen to our fellows, weigh what we hear against our knowledge, experience, and God-given instinct, and follow it through with the faith that God will express himself in that conscience despite our individual fears.

I like to think that sacrifice in service means my precious time. Who am I kidding? The only things that need be sacrificed are fear and ego, the same fear and ego that says don't admit you're wrong, or you can't change your mind now. A perception that all is well so vote "yes," may be right. A perception that all is not well so vote "no," may be right. The lessons we learned in recovery apply at the Conference as well. We learned we can't run our lives on fear. We can't run our Fellowship on fear either. We learned above all we must be rid of selfishness and self-centeredness, humility's opposites, and that God makes that possible. Open-mindedness that our perception may need to change is all that is required. God will do the rest.

Lori Geistlinger, Nebraska

## Anonymity—Sacrificing Our Egos

"Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions..."

When I first arrived at the rooms of Alcoholics Anonymous, I could not even pronounce it, let alone know the true meaning. I recall that when I walked into my very first A.A. meeting I was grateful there were huge signs on the door that read: A.A. meeting in progress. Tradition Twelve became very important to me early in my sobriety. I remember, after a particular meeting early in re-

covery, a couple of oldtimers invited me for coffee and ice cream at a local establishment. I gratefully accepted. I could pick their brains about staying sober. (Beware when they offer you ice cream.) The sharing and the ice cream were wonderful and at just about my last spoonful, they got down to business. You see, they loved me and cared enough to tell me the truth about myself. You can imagine my surprise when they both agreed and told me in no uncertain terms that my problem was EGO. I was floored. How could this be? Wasn't this particular character defect reserved for men only? Women did not suffer from this, or so I thought.

That day I received a big chunk of humble pie from these two loving A.A. members. I became aware, after I joined this Fellowship, that I had personality problems, so when I first heard it, the Tradition's message was very clear: there exists an immediate way for me to face, with others, my alcoholism and attendant anger, defensiveness, and offensiveness.

I saw Tradition Twelve as a great ego-deflator, and that became a turning point for me in my sobriety. I looked at the Steps and Traditions from a whole different angle. I realized that I was the problem and that we A.A.s are all on the same level playing field when we cross the threshold of any A.A. meeting room. It doesn't matter what we do for a living, what our religious beliefs are, how intelligent or how many degrees we have. It doesn't matter how rich, or poor, or what race we are. When we cross that threshold, we are just one alcoholic of many, equal in every way, just as God intended.

Tradition Twelve affirms that individual differences are unimportant within the program. We set aside any desire for personal distinction and meld willingly into a group. If I'm not looking eye-level at my fellow members, it's time for me to take a look at myself. This Tradition reminds me not to put barriers between myself and other members. We are all equal. Anonymity breaks down these barriers. To us, however, it also represents more than a sound public relations policy. It is more than a denial of self-seeking. This Tradition is a constant and practical reminder that personal ambition has no place in Alcoholics Anonymous. In it, each member becomes an active guardian of our Fellowship. My journey in service has tested these principles many times. I am not better or smarter than you are. I just have a love for this program that has saved my life. I am reminded that God has put me on this planet to serve.

Keeping my ego in check requires a constant awareness. Some members seem to look up to their trusted servants. Humility is a huge factor in keeping my ego in check and it takes the God of my understanding to accomplish this. I remember when I first became G.S.R. of my home group. I thought that I knew more than my average home group member because I had read *The A.A. Service Manual* and gone to assembly meetings. Service, like recovery, has been a process for me. My higher power has stepped in many times to keep me humble. I have found that my actions speak much louder than my words.

As I traveled down the service structure I have seen and heard many disturbing things in business meetings and area events at every level. Thank God that we are reminded that no one person can destroy A.A. Our humanness is prevalent throughout our Fellowship. I remain forever grateful for the giants that have gone before me in our wonderful program. My sponsor took me through the Steps and taught me to keep it simple and, most importantly, to pass it on. True humility is a gift from living the Steps and practicing the Traditions in our everyday lives.

One of the most rewarding and humbling moments in my recovery was when I was elected delegate to represent my area at the General Service Conference. To think that my fellow members put their trust in me to carry their collective group conscience to the Conference is a blessing. I still practice the same principles that I was taught early on. I ask God for help in everything that I

am asked to do for and in our Fellowship. I try to do it with enthusiasm and I remember that this is a huge commitment as well as my responsibility.

Anonymity remains important to our Fellowship at the level of press, radio and film. But let me remember not to be so anonymous that my fellow A.A. members don't know who I am. Bill W. concluded that the deeper purpose of anonymity was "actually to keep those fool egos of ours from running hog wild." In closing, I am reminded of the divine inspiration of the founding of our Fellowship and the words of Bill W.: "We are sure that humility, expressed by anonymity, is the greatest safeguard that A.A. can ever have."

I remain forever grateful,

*Cheryl Akin, Western New York*

## ENTHUSIASM AND GRATITUDE

*Before the Tuesday afternoon visit to the General Service and Grapevine Offices, Conference members heard presentations on Enthusiasm and Gratitude. Rogelio Flores, Class A trustee, was the moderator.*

## Hope and Purpose from Defeat and Despair

*Defeat and Despair:* Those two short words evoke a powerful emotional response in the mind of any alcoholic who has found themselves in a condition severe enough to seek help through Alcoholics Anonymous. Each of us can relate a story or several stories of situations of personal defeat and despair which lead in turn to surrender and recovery. For me, the terror of my last night of drinking comes to mind. I realized on that night, that I was powerless against the obsession of the first drink, that some force larger than my own will to stop drinking had me by the throat, and that left to my own devices, my situation was hopeless. It was on the following morning, with a hangover and late for my appointments, that I said a simple prayer, as I was walking to my car, that was to forever change the course of my life. "God—Please help me with my drinking problem." That day turned out to be my sobriety date.

An experience just as powerful as my last drunk was an experience I had at one-and-a-half years of sobriety, when I found myself cycling in and out of psychiatric hospitals with a bipolar diagnosis. Or at eight years of sobriety, with a depression severe enough to motivate me to complete a third unfinished Fourth Step inventory with the help of a new sponsor. Or at fifteen years of sobriety, when over a six month period, in the fall of 2000, I experienced the death of my father, election to public office, and the loss of a seven figure stock portfolio. All of these experiences brought me, to points of defeat and despair in sobriety, which lead me, in turn, to experience deeper surrenders and to pursue recovery with renewed vigor.

*Hope and Purpose:* Those two short words evoke an equally powerful emotional response in the mind of an alcoholic who has experienced a spiritual change sufficient to bring about recovery from alcoholism. For me, in early sobriety, it was simply the reassuring words of an oldtimer, that I was "going to be all right." It was also at two years of sobriety, reading a book about God and coming to believe that in the Second Step, God could indeed restore me to the sanity I so desperately needed. It was at nine years of sobriety, watching my first sponsee blossom as the result of having successfully completed the first nine Steps himself, that solidified in me the sense of purpose I had found in carrying our message of hope to another alcoholic. It was at sixteen years of sobriety, while taking a group of men through "We Agnostics," that I saw the hypocrisy of my own beliefs. If God was all powerful, then it was

impossible for me to have screwed up my life beyond repair, which, once again, renewed my faith in the sense of purpose I found in service, and gave me new hope for the future.

Equally important to me, and I assume to you, have been experiences in the A.A. Service Structure. For example, attending my first Regional Service Conference as a G.S.R. and seeing for the first time that I was a vital link in the chain of a worldwide Fellowship. And being a part of a district committee that published a district meeting list for the first time, and helping to develop a district phone answering service that still exists today. And as a delegate, carrying a message of unity and purpose to a dark district and watching the eyes of a struggling G.S.R. light up as they began to see the larger picture of service in A.A.

Through all of these experiences, I have come to believe that defeat and despair and hope and purpose are inextricably linked, that one cannot have the latter without the former. Defeat and despair are precursors to surrender. It is in surrender to God and through the actions of the Twelve Steps of recovery that I find hope; it is through selfless service to God and my fellows, in and out of A.A., that I find purpose and meaning in life. One might ask "Is it really necessary to experience defeat and despair in order to experience the sense of hope and purpose that is found in surrender and service?" Once we come to see surrender and service as desirable activities to pursue in their own right, then we can eliminate the need for defeat and despair as motivational forces in recovery. But that is knowledge that comes directly from the experience of having previously surrendered under the lash of defeat and despair.

The most heartbreaking cases I have seen in working with alcoholics have not been the A.A.s who have had the most tragic circumstances in their lives. Often, in those cases, the spiritual program of action was rejected because the afflicted did not see his case as being desperate enough to require the actions of A.A. I have known sober A.A. members who apparently lack the motivation to earnestly seek surrender and service to the degree I have found necessary for my survival and have watched them live lives of mediocre sobriety simply because they could. What a tragedy that is!

I have come to see through the crucible of my own experience and through the lives of the men and women I have tried to help, that defeat and despair are positive forces. It is in those moments of ego deflation that the miracles of change occur and we become teachable. It is through heartbreaking moments of defeat and despair that we experience deeper levels of unconditional surrender, which lead, in turn, to the renewed hope and purpose that is found through service. I have come to see, through my own experience, that defeat and despair have been my friends; it is they who have caused me to seek God and sobriety with an earnestness I would not have had without them. Those actions have given me my life in sobriety today.

Today, the knowledge that those hideous four horsemen are still out there, not far into the wilderness, keeps me on the right path in sobriety, with my shoulder to the wheel, earnestly seeking God in voluntary surrender and service. For I know in my heart that I am an alcoholic of the hopeless variety and I will either die from this thing or I will recover from it. The knowledge of that truth comes from having had the wolf breathe down my neck before sobriety and in sobriety. I have seen men die from this thing, both by drinking and by suicide, thinking that they had this thing licked. I don't want to join their ranks. So today I choose to put sobriety and God first and foremost in my life. I am grateful that today I have been given the choice to surrender and serve, and as a result I have found a life full of hope, meaning, and purpose.

*John Teupel, South Dakota*

## Happy, Joyous, and Free

The Big Book, Chapter 9, "The Family Afterward" (pp. 132-133) reads, "...we aren't a glum lot.... We absolutely insist on enjoying life....we think cheerfulness and laughter make for usefulness.... We are sure God wants us to be happy, joyous, and free."

After doing the Twelve Steps, especially when making amends, I realized that I was free! Free enough of my character defects—all the selfishness that blocked me from God and from my fellows, so that I could really be a channel of God's grace to others—that I could bear witness to God's power, love, and way of life. Having had a spiritual awakening as a result of the Steps, I had a message to carry. Step Twelve in *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* (p. 106) starts "The joy of living is the theme of A.A.'s Twelfth Step, and action is its key word." I found an enthusiasm to carry the message with energy that I never had before. Twelfth Step calls were exciting, but finally helping another woman through the Steps filled me with gratitude and joy beyond description. As a result of this new freedom and the joy of living these principles, I became happier than I had ever been.

General service added yet another dimension to "happy, joyous, and free." In my first G.S.R. assignment I realized that I really liked these service meetings. I appreciated hearing what others were doing to connect our area to the Conference, General Service Office, and the rest of Alcoholics Anonymous. My A.A. world was growing bigger. I began to see that my group could carry the message beyond our meeting by participation in the conscience of our area and with their contributions. Twelfth Step work could be done in places and in ways that my group could not do by itself—nor could we do as individuals. We were connected to other groups and the service entities by our voice and contributions. Our group contributions to our intergroup, combined with those from other groups, enabled the phones to be answered, public information to be provided, meeting schedules to be printed, and we had a place to purchase A.A. literature locally. I soon discovered that our General Service structure also carried the message in still more ways. The communications between the delegate and the area assembly allowed my group to participate in the decisions made by the Conference in all matters of importance to A.A.

A line in Chapter 11 of the Big Book (pp. 152-153) states that among members of A.A. I will make lifelong friends—that we will commence shoulder to shoulder our common journey. It has been a joy and pleasure to serve with other A.A. members and carry the message of service to groups, areas, and even other countries. Bill W.'s "vision of a society of drunks" that he pictured in his mind while in Towns Hospital, has become my own. My Higher Power has given me a vision of how General Service carries the message—and how I can cooperate with His Grace. I want to support our office in carrying the message to those places that my group cannot reach—either because of the distance or because my group doesn't have the resources by itself.

There are cities and hamlets in the U.S. and Canada that ask for information or services that our office gives to them freely. And beyond our borders there are requests from other countries where A.A. is just beginning—or just starting their service structure. Our G.S.O. responds to these calls for help because my group and many others have sent contributions that allow the staff and trustees to provide that encouragement and support. There may be a request for new literature, or the Big Book in another language, or maybe a visit from one of our trustees-at-large, or a G.S.O. staff member. When my group contributes to the General Service Office, we are participating in these services. We are carrying the message beyond our meeting room—to the near and far reaches of the world. We do this together with many groups and members. Our financial contributions connect my group with all groups around the

world. Sharing this commitment and responsibility makes the burden light. Enthusiasm springs from my gratitude for sobriety and all the many gifts my Higher Power has given me. That gratitude calls me to action—to sacrifice my time and money that others may also be happy, joyous and free.

*Gail Nelson, San Diego/Imperial California*

## Enthusiasm—A Gift of Inventory

My name is Dave Bruha and I am an alcoholic—Area 78 (Alberta/Northwest Territories). What a great venue to be talking about enthusiasm—a room full of concrete examples of "gratitude in action!"

I'm probably not much different than most of you here this weekend—a hopeless drunk who was freely given the gift of sobriety—a gift I did nothing to earn or deserve. But I am sober today! Sober because there were members of Alcoholics Anonymous who were committed to carrying the A.A. message to others like me—hopeless drunks looking for a way out of alcoholic misery. The wonder of this Fellowship is one alcoholic passing the message on to another—not because we need new members to mark on a score card or to keep the membership graph rising—but because our own lives depend on it.

Very few of us arrive in A.A. with anything that resembles gratitude. We generally arrive loaded down with insecurity, fear and a profound self-centered attitude that shuts us off from anything beyond ourselves. We don't want to help others—we want others to help us! Carrying the A.A. message is not a priority!

Page 62 of the Big Book describes the alcoholic as "...an extreme example of self-will run riot," and makes the bold statement, "Selfishness—self-centeredness! That, we think, is the root of our troubles." The leap from sick, self-centered drunk to "carrying the message with enthusiasm and gratitude" does not come about in a flash, and may never come about for those who don't get the real A.A. message from us. We have a responsibility to the newcomers to tell them what A.A. is about and to encourage them to become a part of the Fellowship—for their own recovery and for those still suffering. We are after all, "a society of men and women in action."

If we stick around for a little while we do start feeling better and many of us come to experience an initial wave of enthusiasm and gratitude that the members of my home group refer to as "riding the pink cloud." That pink cloud feeling often brings with it the first real enthusiasm we have known for a long time. It pushes away the dark clouds of despair we had become shrouded in and allows the sunlight of the spirit into our bleak lives. This initial wave of enthusiasm encourages us to become involved in Alcoholics Anonymous as more than spectators and opens the door to a life of service—a life of gratitude in action.

Watching a new member come alive and join with the ranks of others to carry the A.A. message is one of the most powerful, exciting and spiritual experiences that happens in A.A. There is nothing like the enthusiasm of a newcomer to knock the cobwebs off of the old guard and keep us all moving forward. Enthusiasm and Gratitude expressed through Action is the engine that drives Alcoholics Anonymous onward in our commitment to help those who are still suffering in alcoholic despair.

Unfortunately, the initial "pink cloud" can evaporate just as quickly as it arrived and our once profound sense of gratitude will wither under the dark clouds of indifference—stifling our enthusiasm. Simply put—we forget to be grateful—and "Our whole attitude and outlook on life will change!"

Gratitude begets enthusiasm, enthusiasm begets action, action begets a feeling of usefulness and usefulness generates gratitude—

a self-perpetuating cycle that is the lifeblood of our movement; alcoholics in action!

For A.A. members who have experienced the doldrums of sobriety (the waning of the pink cloud), the key to revival of gratitude is given to us in the principle of ongoing self-examination, or inventory, as it is referred to in Step Ten. Practicing the principle of inventory on a regular basis allows us to see ourselves exactly as we are and to measure that against where we have come from and plot a course for where we want to go—as individuals, as groups, or as service entities. A thorough fact-finding mission can revitalize our gratitude almost instantly; even alcoholics don't argue for long when the facts are laid out before them in black and white.

My own period of stagnation came when I moved to a small town and found myself in a group where newcomers were almost nonexistent; there seemed to be little opportunity to “carry the message” in the way I was used to. After months and months of the same routine, seeing the same few faces at meetings, over and over, my enthusiasm had dried up to less than a trickle. And I was suffering for it. I could feel the sunlight of the spirit fade as I lost the feeling of usefulness that comes from being active in A.A.

Finally, after suffering enough, I shared my feelings with a long-time member of my new group, and was told rather bluntly that there must be something wrong with me and I had better find a renewed sense of gratitude if I wanted to stay sober.

Doing nothing wasn't working, so I took his suggestion and delved into my inventory—convinced that there was nothing wrong with me and that it was somehow the group's fault that I was restless, irritable and discontent—the polar opposite of enthusiastic. Through the process I quickly realized that gratitude was missing from my life—I had forgotten where I had come from and how much I had to be thankful for in the present. Without having newcomers around to show me myself, as I once was (and could still be), my enthusiasm and commitment was smothered by being complacent and inactive.

Discovering how important it was to my own well being to be useful and active in A.A. is what actually led me into the service structure of Alcoholics Anonymous. When the group needed a general service representative (G.S.R.), I said yes, even though I had no idea what a G.S.R. was or what they were supposed to do. I only knew that I needed to continue to do whatever was necessary to carry the A.A. message forward—for my own sake.

As long as I keep active and am diligent with my inventory, every day can begin with a heart full of gratitude and the willingness to give back, which is a true gift for someone who arrived in A.A. as the poster child for self-centeredness.

Action is the key to perpetuating a life of service—a life of usefulness and fulfillment. Our part is to stay in motion, to be actively committed to carrying the A.A. message—for on this simple precept depends our lives and the lives of those yet to come.

Thank you for this opportunity to be of useful service to Alcoholics Anonymous.

*Dave Bruha, Alberta/N.W.T.*

## THE A.A. GRAPEVINE

*Wednesday afternoon's presentation discussion session was chaired by Jim Branscome, Grapevine director. The first presentation was written by Joe Schranck, Delaware, who died in early April. His presentation was delivered by Frank Ziembra, the alternate delegate, who took Joe's place.*

## “The Grapevine is Always...”

Since its inception in 1944, the A.A. Grapevine has always managed to remain timeless. While certain expressions and idioms have changed over the years, the message of hope and recovery still shines through in the pages of the magazine.

In our commitment to carry A.A.'s message, the Grapevine has proven to be a wonderful adjunct to the Big Book and Twelve and Twelve, as well as one-on-one contact with the still-suffering alcoholic.

When Bill Wilson gave his blessing to the six co-founders of the magazine, the idea of a “meeting-in-print” was launched and gradually grew to include subscribers from around the Fellowship. Today, with the use of the Internet and other technology, the Grapevine can continue to spread the message. Through I-say and aagrapevine.org, many members, especially the younger ones and the Loners, are able to participate and share their thoughts on a range of topics concerning the Fellowship.

While Bill W. contributed over 150 articles and commentaries in the Grapevine's first 26 years, the magazine has always provided a forum for individual A.A. members to share their experience, strength and hope.

The Grapevine also generates enthusiasm with the publication of a number of other items: books, CDs, etc. Last year's publication of the *Beginner's Book* has created quite a bit of interest and appears to have sold well. Also, by revamping the look and makeup of the magazine, with full-color, staple-free pages, and a more cohesive layout, interest and enthusiasm should increase.

The Grapevine's mission is always to remain our “meeting-in-print” and to that end, publishing La Viña six times per year allows a growing segment of our membership to be reached. By contributing articles, art work, photos, jokes, etc., the membership can demonstrate gratitude in action through giving back to the Fellowship. The pages of the Grapevine and La Viña are always there to be used by C.P.C., Corrections and other committees to help carry the A.A. message.

We can show our commitment to carry A.A.'s message, with enthusiasm and gratitude in action, by continuing to support the Grapevine and La Viña at the individual, group, and area levels. We should always ensure that our “meeting-in-print” remains timeless, relevant, and effective in carrying the message to the next suffering alcoholic, even to the alcoholic yet to be born.

Therefore, as the Grapevine approaches its 65th Anniversary, may it always be an integral part of our recovery, unity and service.

Thank you for this opportunity to be of service.

*Joe Schranck, Delaware*

## “Grapevine is Now...”

When I was sober just a few years, I signed up to be an alternate G.S.R. for my home group, the Sunrise Group in Brooklyn, and one of my first duties was to assist in a Conference-related questionnaire that included questions about the Grapevine magazine. I was very interested in it because I'm a magazine editor by trade. Everyone in the group added their say, and then I took my turn: “It needs a redesign! It's got great information, but it just looks dated.” I went into some more detail, and I remember my sponsor almost collapsing in hysterical laughter that a newcomer like me was proposing a whole new look for such a venerable magazine.

Well, fast-forward about six years and guess what? I got a job at the Grapevine as the managing editor and leading the editorial team on the redesign. All I can say is, “Be careful what you wish for!”

Grapevine is many things to many people. We have a new awareness campaign called “Grapevine is...” and we've asked people to enter on the Web or send in their one-word descriptions of

Grapevine. We've received more than 800 words describing Grapevine, and here are a few: centering, quintessential, fellowship, awareness.

However each one of us describes the Grapevine, we all share a passion for this magazine that has served as our meeting in print for nearly 65 years. Recently, we debuted the new design of the Grapevine, and I wanted to share with you some of the thinking from the editorial team on what Grapevine is today.

If you hold up a new issue next to an issue that's even a couple of months older, you'll notice some things that are different right away. It's in color on the inside and outside now. It's staple-free, so that it can easily be taken in to prisons. Also, there's a new logo.

Then there are some more subtle differences: it has a completely new style of typography with all new fonts. There are more of what we call pull-outs or point boxes. Images are simpler and more direct. This redesign was chosen for its simplicity: the typography and images work together to convey the content, not distract from it. It was also chosen for its fresh, modern look. More than 70% of the Grapevine audience are over age 50; 40% are over age 60. The purpose of this design is to attract new readers and subscribers in their 40s, 30s, maybe even 20s. The redesign was also chosen for its classic good looks; the logo harkens back to issues past. And it was chosen for its longevity—this is not a design that will go out of style any time soon.

More importantly, one thing that the Grapevine continues to be is a living, breathing tool of sobriety. Bill W. established that basic tenant of the Grapevine when he wrote in 1946, "The Grapevine will be the voice of the Alcoholics Anonymous movement. Its editors and staff will be primarily accountable to the A.A. movement as a whole. Within the bounds of friendliness and good taste, the Grapevine will enjoy perfect freedom of speech on all matters directly pertaining to Alcoholics Anonymous. Like the Alcoholics Anonymous movement it is to mirror, there will be but one central purpose: The Grapevine will try to carry the A.A. message to alcoholics and practice the A.A. principles in all its affairs." In this first phase of the redesign, we are collecting feedback and plan to do a careful assessment of the design and tweak it as needed. Grapevine will always be changing and evolving, a constant reflection of the Fellowship that provides its stories.

As a living, breathing, spiritual tool, the redesign of the A.A. Grapevine is really a gift to the entire Fellowship. By creating a design that appeals to a wider audience, one that keeps the legacy of the A.A. Grapevine and its current audience as a top priority, while also embracing a look and feel that will reach out to new audiences, the magazine will continue to flourish and function as our meeting in print.

As that spiritual tool, the A.A. Grapevine plays a vital role in A.A. and its growth throughout the world. It's a tool to be picked up and carried into the Fellowship and beyond. The Grapevine is your opportunity to carry the message from one alcoholic to another. Ultimately, that's what the A.A. Grapevine is for all of us in the Fellowship. It is our stories that we share with each other—one alcoholic helping another.

I take a meeting into a detox every other week, and I carry in the

latest issue of the Grapevine. They are always very excited to get the magazine, but when I took in the March redesigned issue, something remarkable happened. The meeting was winding down, and I looked in the back row where patients are usually sleeping. Three patients were sitting side by side, holding up the Grapevine and leafing through it. I'd never seen that before. I wish I had a picture!

The headline of the editor's note in the first redesigned issue said, "New look, same great stories." Whether it's a tale of sponsor meets sponsee; an oldtimer's memories of meetings past; a classic drunkalog or a narrative from a newcomer, the core of Grapevine remains unchanged. Grapevine is ultimately the many and varied stories—the voices of the Fellowship.

*Amber Eden, managing editor, A.A. Grapevine*

## SPIRITUAL PROGRAM IN ACTION

*Ginger Rhoades Bell, Grapevine director, was the moderator for Thursday afternoon's session.*

### Maximum Service

What is the Third Legacy?

"Our Twelfth Step—carrying the message—is the basic service that A.A.'s Fellowship gives; this is our principle aim and the main reason for our existence. Therefore, A.A. is more than a set of principles; it is a Society of alcoholics *in action*. We must carry the message, else we ourselves can wither and those who haven't been given the truth will die.

"Hence, an A.A. service is *anything whatever* that helps us to reach a fellow sufferer—ranging all the way from the Twelfth Step itself to a ten-cent phone call and a cup of coffee, and to A.A.'s General Service Headquarters for national and international action. The sum total of *all* those services is our Third Legacy." (*The Language of the Heart*, p.160)

From my early sobriety I had no idea what this meant, and sometimes today I am still not always sure. The one constant I have always had on this journey has been good sponsorship. On my one year anniversary I was elated; my sponsor had one question for me, "Now what are you going to do to give back to A.A.?" I was not sure what he meant, but I knew it had to do with being of service to A.A., so I said I would join a committee. (At the time it sounded good.) So the next thing I know, I was a member of the Correctional committee taking a lead into an adult facility every Thursday night for a year. I didn't know 52 people in A.A. at the time, but I was informed that I had made a commitment, so get on with it.

During my first year I had joined a home group that was service oriented; it was a men's meeting that was 90 men strong and met every Monday night. It was after I had served my year on the Correctional committee that at a group conscience meeting our group found I was in need of a G.S.R. What happened next I do not wish on anyone. I went to the restroom during the meeting and when I came back everyone was laughing, and yes, you guessed





it, I was nominated for the position. How could I turn it down when I was sitting next to my sponsor? So, for the next two years I attended the area assemblies and the mini-conferences with pen and paper in hand due to the fact that the oldtimers always had questions about things that seemed entirely irrelevant to me.

By this time, I was getting to enjoy being of service to my home group, but it was time to rotate. So what was next? Someone told me that the district my home group was now in need of a D.C.M. Not fully knowing what it entailed I, of course, said yes and ran for the position and won. Of course I ran unopposed. What I truly learned from this was humility. I was attending my home group as a D.C.M., and when I informed them of that the many oldtimers told me I was still wet behind the ears and if they needed my help they would ask for it. That did not deter me from my duties to the other 16 groups that I was responsible to, and yes, I still carried that pen and paper in hand.

From this point on, I served on various committees, and somehow I always seemed to end up becoming the chairman. This was not achieved because I was so knowledgeable about A.A., it was because I did as I was always taught, I suited up and showed up and gave my best effort possible, as I still do today.

But there was one part of service that for ten years eluded me. That was working one-on-one with another drunk who stayed sober. Yes, I heard all along that the most important person who stayed sober through all of it was me. To tell you the truth, after a while, that answer just did not cut it. But, as I was told, it will happen in God's time not John's time. This, of course, was another lesson in "be careful what you wish for, it may come true." Because since that time, I have had the honor and privilege of sponsoring some of the sickest of the sick. And yes, today this still brings a smile to my sponsor's face. I have found just how much time and dedication it really takes to work with another drunk, day in and day out. And for that I am eternally grateful.

So much for my experience. Now I would like to share something from the 1945 July Grapevine that overall describes one of the dangers that people very involved in service, such as myself, have experienced.

### Do Unto Others

How many of the rest of you get, in your eagerness to make up for lost time, that panicky sense of pressure because there just isn't "time enough?" In our enthusiasm for our new life and in our release from the old feeling of inadequacy, we are apt to say yes to every request and later find to our regret that there isn't enough "room" in the day to accomplish everything we optimistically planned to do.

We put on the pressure, only to find that little by little we are getting ourselves tied into knots from a binge of overdoing, followed, as of old, by the inevitable jitters and remorse because we are exhausted and have probably let somebody down.

A.A. tells us to go on a 24-hour program. That should be our starting point. Subtract the necessary hours required for adequate rest and then we can plot our course with the hours remaining. It might be well to write down an hour-by-hour outline of each day for the past week, listing on one side of the paper all those things we said we would do but didn't get around to, and on the other the things we did do. If we have a grain of intelligence, this should show us just how much activity can be comfortably taken on for any one 24-hour period and how balanced (or unbalanced) our program is for the average day.

The latter point is what I want to stress. Are we, perhaps, devoting too much time to A.A., per se, and neglecting the last part of the Twelfth Step, "—and practice these principles in all our affairs?"

I wonder if your wife has ever thought, "—Yes, I'm deeply grateful to A.A. and all it has done for us, but—I wish Joe would ask me to the movies, occasionally." Or has she ever said to other A.A. wives, "A.A. get-togethers are fun and I'm thankful for our many new friends, but it would be nice if Jimmy and I could have an evening together just once in a while and let the drunks fall where they may."

Drunk or sober, alcoholics are apt to be selfish. My own outstanding bit of neglect is toward my boy in the service.

He writes, "You know how I feel about your letters, so please send them soon and often."

I promptly make a mental vow to systematically set aside a time at least twice a week to send him the cheery bits of nonsense which he seems to love. Three weeks later I'm still saying, "I must write the boy—as soon as I make that A.A. call" or "as soon as I get back from the meeting."

I am not advocating that we give up meetings and calls. Perish the thought. I am simply suggesting that we be more rational and balanced in our planning. In my drinking days I put the bottle first and now, I'm putting sobriety there. That's as it should be.

But while working with other alcoholics is one of the most important parts of our program, A.A. can be practiced in other ways. If it works miracles on drunks, why not try it on our family and friends, those who bore the brunt of our thoughtlessness, our selfishness? And even on the strangers we meet in the course of a day? Result—more miracles!

One less long-winded A.A. telephone call, made solely for personal pleasure, might give you just enough time to get that letter off to your favorite serviceman. One evening's hashing over the past with the boys could occasionally be sacrificed to ask your wife to go out stepping—just the two of you, for some good clean normal enjoyment.

Giving and receiving help from other alcoholics, going to meetings, talking to A.A. friends and giving a hand to the newcomer must be paramount, but more and richer dividends may be ours if we but open the door and go out on the open road bearing the standard of A.A. "and practice these principles in *all* our affairs."

John Zidarín, NW Ohio/SE Michigan

### Persistence—The Key to Progress

When I think of "persistence," the passage on page 100 of *Alcoholics Anonymous* comes to mind: "If you persist, remarkable things will happen." Persistence seems to imply action, and action requires something to be done. Merriam-Webster defines persist as "going on resolutely or stubbornly in spite of difficulties." I have learned in A.A. to always examine my motives. If my motives are good, going on in spite of difficulties could be called *persistence*. But if my motives are not good, I could be called stubborn or obstinate.

At the core of the Alcoholics Anonymous program is the concept of persistence. At my first meeting, they said to keep coming back...to persist. The slogan on the wall said "One Day at a Time," but if one day seemed unattainable, could I persist for an hour, or maybe two? Could I make it to noon without drinking? These were huge lessons for me at the time, and remain so today. Though I seldom heard the word persistence, it was implicit in everything during those first days and weeks of sobriety. To stay sober, I had to persist; I had to go on resolutely in spite of difficulties.

It didn't take long before I was introduced to service and to the Responsibility Declaration. That brings me to this year's Conference theme, "Our Commitment to Carry A.A.'s Message—Enthusiasm and Gratitude in Action." Enthusiasm is simply persistence with a smile. Enthusiasm is compelling and contagious.



To me, there is no greater gift than the opportunity to work with another alcoholic in search of sobriety. I often get to see the confusion on the newcomer's face and am reminded of what it was like. The newcomer might wonder: "Why is he so happy?" "What's with the big smile and the hug?" "Why does he want to keep meeting, even if I slip?" Somehow being persistent with a newcomer doesn't feel like service—it simply feels like the right thing to do.

I stand on the shoulders of the millions of alcoholics who came before. If they had not persisted in carrying the A.A. message, there would have been no open door or waiting seat when I finally surrendered. The persistence of the people who came before me is a debt I can repay by doing the same thing, by being persistent in carrying the message.

Just when I think I understand persistence, there is another lesson to learn. A few years ago, while serving as Area Corrections chair, I was trying to fulfill a request from the New Mexico Corrections Department to bring meetings into a DWI prison in a remote part of our state. Potential volunteers lived in a town 90 miles from the DWI prison. The weekly meeting schedule coupled with high gas prices was discouraging volunteers from stepping forward. After six months of phone calls, e-mails, and visits to group and district meetings, my persistence had produced not one committed volunteer. I decided to make another attempt and accepted an invitation to speak at a district annual weekend retreat. I've spoken many times on corrections service and the incredible gifts volunteers receive. What had I missed; what hadn't I tried? The two-hour drive to the retreat gave me a chance to reflect on the lack of results; what could I do differently this time? Suddenly the answer was clear—I had not asked for God's help; I had not in-

vited God in. At the first opportunity, I pulled the car to the side of the road and prayed. Even though my motives for starting the new meeting were good, where was God? What if God had a different plan or a different timetable for this particular prison meeting? I prayed for the knowledge of God's will and the power to carry that out. And, I prayed for the willingness to accept the outcome, whatever that was.

It was an enjoyable evening with good food and great fellowship. After speaking, I was thanking the host when the District Corrections chair walked up and announced that five new volunteers had stepped forward. That prison meeting is still active today.

This event was rich with lessons. I learned that service can produce discouraging results, but persistence can be a safety net. If I give up too soon, I'm operating on Ralph's timetable, not God's. Seems like I've heard this before... "don't leave before the miracle happens."

Another lesson is that persistence can have a dark side. I became invested in the outcome of the new prison meeting and my ego pushed out a reliance on Higher Power. It was time to practice Step Eleven again. In fact, persistence is implicit in the Twelve Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous. If I work the Steps resolutely in spite of difficulties... If I persist... "remarkable things will happen."

*Ralph Trigg, New Mexico*

## Living the Traditions

Thank you the opportunity to share my experience, strength and hope on "Living the Traditions."

Representing the distilled experience of A.A.'s past, the Twelve Traditions are the basic principles by which A.A. members work together and relate as a whole to the world. By adhering to these, A.A.'s co-founder Bill W. pointed out: "A.A. cannot possibly be split apart by politics, religious differences, money, professionalism, public controversy—or by old-timers who take a notion to be big shots."

What better introduction could I have for this presentation? And we could read it in the Winter 2008 *About A.A.* newsletter.

To preserve Unity within our Fellowship was the motivation and purpose for writing what we refer to as our Legacy of Unity. To say that the Twelve Traditions have enhanced my recovery would be the understatement of the century. Not only was I hopelessly irresponsible when I first came to A.A., I also was totally unable to live in society. I could not suffer any rules. I passionately hated any type of authority. Does that sound familiar?

But you welcomed me "as is." And somehow, I welcomed you too. Against all odds, I fell in love with Alcoholics Anonymous at first sight. This was the first of many graces I have been blessed with over the last 31 years.

If working the Steps has taught me how to live with myself, the Twelve Traditions have shown me how to live with others, have helped me become a citizen of the world—and even enjoy being one. It all started in my home group. As we tried to be vigilant in respecting those "suggestions," I began to read about this part of our triple legacy. As I got to understand the First Tradition, I became aware of my selfishness and could only guess the size of my ego.

The Traditions also showed me the way to real autonomy and respect. The seed of financial responsibility was planted in me the first time I read in "A.A. Tradition—How It Developed, by Bill W.": "Where the proper use of money ends—and its misuse begins—is the point in 'spiritual space' we are all seeking." (p. 23). A.A.'s Traditions taught me not to judge people, to stay focused, to mind my own business, and that it's okay to ask for help. I started to grasp the true nature of anonymity as I got my first classes of Hu-



mility 101. Yes, I mean service. I began an apprenticeship in humility when I became G.S.R. for my group. I have yet to graduate. Today, I affectionately call service in A.A. the "ego crusher." And I thank God for it every day!

At any level of our service structure, there are not many "crises" that cannot be resolved with our Traditions. The moment we decide to put principles before personalities and our common welfare at the top of our priorities, it has been my experience that half of the problem, any problem, is solved. The immediate effect on me is that I stop wanting to be right. And when we add our primary purpose to complete the triad, all fights about money and power melt like snow in June. And then we can truly see "enthusiasm and gratitude in action."

I also observed that our group problems have the same roots as our individual problems. Situations are often triggered by financial insecurities, fear of the unknown, resistance to change or need to control circumstances and people. It is hard sometimes to let go and let God guide us through the growing process.

Unity, I believe, is the opposite of uniformity. We can really talk of Unity when we welcome and embrace diversity. I don't know about where you come from, but around where I live things are pretty uniform. I don't see in our rooms the patchwork of people that our society has become. And I ask myself if maybe there is something we don't do right. For example, at the beginning of all our meetings, we read in our A.A. Preamble that A.A. is not religious. And yet most groups in my area insist on ending the meetings with a Christian prayer. So I think "what a paradox for the newcomer in the room." It used to bother me during my first years. Nowadays, it only sometimes leaves me perplexed. Most of the time, I think it is part of our charm and it makes me smile.

We should not fear diversity. Our Traditions are perfectly adapted to preserve A.A.'s future and the universal nature of our Fellowship. It is no wonder Bill W. originally called them "Twelve points to assure our future." The Twelve Traditions are our best protection against anything that could harm us, from the inside or from the outside. Like water, they are strong enough to drill a hole in a rock as hard as my head, and supple enough to fit in any space.

For me, the Twelve Traditions are A.A.'s co-founders' way to tell us we have nothing to fear, as long as we stay focused on our singleness of purpose, and practice those principles in all of our affairs.

For the individual A.A. and for the whole Fellowship, to live the Traditions is to put principles before personalities. This might not be a natural approach for an alcoholic. But once we go into action in our spiritual program, including working with the Traditions, it doesn't take long to see the difference; to feel our heart and our mind open so that "a loving God may express Himself in our group conscience" and in our life.

*Ginette Williams,  
Southwest Quebec*

## 2010 INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

*Conley Byrd, Southwest regional trustee, was the moderator for the Presentations on A.A.'s 75th Birthday celebration.*

### 2010 International Convention

Hello, my name is Steve Yocum; I am the Area 68 delegate. I would like to thank the General Service Conference and the Fellowship for the opportunity to give this presentation on the 2010 International Convention. At first I was just excited being asked, then the fear of "What will I say?" started in my head. I remembered it says in the Big Book that when doubtful we pause and ask for the right thought or action. It was then I picked up the letter Doug had sent me and I read these words: "I am delighted to send you this loving invitation to give a presentation during the 59th General Service Conference." The theme, "Our Commitment to Carry A.A.'s Message—Enthusiasm and Gratitude in Action," led me to think of some of A.A.'s history. The first International in Cleveland in 1950 had 3,000 in attendance. During that Convention came the adoption of the Twelve Traditions, as well as Dr. Bob's last public message to the Fellowship. The 1955 International Convention in St. Louis floated a banner with a new symbol for A.A., a circle enclosing a triangle, and A.A.'s Three Legacies were turned over to the whole movement. The 1965 International Convention, celebrating A.A.'s 30th Anniversary, was where I Am Responsible was adopted: "I Am Responsible... When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that, I am responsible." In 1970, when A.A. reached the age of 35, "Unity" was in the theme: "This we owe to A.A.'s future: To place our common welfare first; to keep our fellowship united. For on A.A. unity depend our lives; and the lives of those to come."

A lot of historical events have taken place at past Internationals. What event will come to pass in 2010? What Class A trustee will come from the speakers who will be there in the future of Alcoholics Anonymous? What will be written or talked about after this International Convention?

In January 2010, we will be gathering names of A.A. members interested in volunteering. The support we are already receiving is awesome and we are excited by the enthusiasm and interest already being expressed for information about the 2010 Convention. We re-



mind the Fellowship to watch for more info at A.A.'s Web site, [www.aa.org](http://www.aa.org). We also would like to remind our members to continue to carry the message. Hopefully, many new members will be celebrating one year of sobriety in San Antonio. Page 139 in *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age* reads, "A.A.'s Twelfth Step, carrying the message, is the basic service that our fellowship gives; it is our principal aim and the main reason for our existence." Gathering together in San Antonio will be a wonderful opportunity to rededicate ourselves to carrying A.A.'s message of recovery. So it is with extreme enthusiasm and gratitude that I stand before you today with "A Vision for You" and offer my "Loving Invitation" to you from the Southwest Texas Area, and the city of San Antonio, for the 2010 International Convention of Alcoholics Anonymous' 75th Anniversary. This will be my first International Convention and the excitement is already building. As the delegate, I get asked everywhere I go about the International and what info can I give out. I try and pass my enthusiasm and excitement off to each person I come in contact with. I can only imagine the gratitude that I will receive from attending such an event.

We are expecting 3,000 to 4,000 volunteers to help, probably more volunteers than the number of attendees at the first International Convention. I sit and wonder sometimes if Bill and Bob had this same vision. I am sure they did. Please come and join me in San Antonio for the 75th Anniversary of Alcoholics Anonymous.

*Steve Yocum, Southwest Texas*

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Just think! In a little less than 15 months, we will meet to celebrate A.A.'s 75th Birthday at our International Convention in San Antonio. July 1-4, 2010, are the dates—so mark your calendar! Plans are well under way to make this a joyous and memorable event.

San Antonio is a vibrant, colorful city, filled with Southwest history. When we get there, we'll pack the Henry B. Gonzalez Convention Center with handshakes, hugs, kisses, and lots of meetings, panels and workshops. And of course, we'll have those extraordinary Big Meetings in the Alamodome Stadium.

The festivities start on Thursday night with a Party in Hemisfair Park right behind the Convention Center. Music will fill the summer night underneath the Tower of the Americas, a San Antonio landmark from the 1968 World's Fair. You can dance in the park, the Convention Center or the Grand Hyatt San Antonio.

At midnight on Thursday, marathon meetings will start, and will continue through Sunday morning. Friday morning, hundreds of meetings will begin at the Convention Center, and Friday night in the Alamodome we will hold the exciting Parade of Flags of countries represented at the Convention, followed by the three-speaker Big A.A. Meeting. The wonderful Oldtimers Stadium Meeting will take place on Saturday night, where oldtimers will be selected from the hat. What a great way to honor our history and hear first-hand what we used to be like. Sunday morning, we will have our customary three-speaker Big Meeting to close out the weekend and will say farewell until 2015 in Atlanta.

Early International A.A. Conventions were focal points for important moments in A.A. history. At the first Convention, in Cleveland in 1950, our Twelve Traditions were confirmed, helping to ensure the future of our Fellowship. At the 1955 Convention in St. Louis, Bill W. and the oldtimers turned the leadership of the Fellowship over to the General Service Conference. I am reading through *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age* with some of the guys I sponsor, and sometimes I get a jolt, thinking that I'm part of the Conference that Bill turned his responsibilities over to—us, sitting in this room today!

International Conventions offer the occasion for rich and varied experiences, some dramatic and historical, others quiet and serene. Those who talk about attending an International Convention speak of it as a highlight of their sobriety, and the emotion universally expressed is one of gratitude—gratitude for sobriety in A.A. and for having had the opportunity to celebrate that sobriety with tens of thousands of A.A. members and their loved ones in a spectacular gathering.

Many who travel to San Antonio with old friends, sponsors or home group members will have those on-the-road meetings that form such an important part of our Fellowship sharing. Those A.A. "coincidences" will occur—a beloved friend you lost track of will show up sober. Someone on your Eighth Step list will appear and provide you with the opportunity to make amends; perhaps you'll be on their Eighth Step list, as well. New and lifelong friendships will be made—perhaps in the wee hours of the morning, as we fellowship over ice cream and coffee. And Twelfth Step work will take place—we have all heard the stories of alcoholics who got sober during an International Convention.

These events affect not only the A.A. members in attendance—they provide a chance for the public to see us first hand. In 1950, a cab driver in Cleveland stated that we were the nicest convention they had ever had. A lady taxi driver in Seattle in 1990 commented, "You people have something special. You make me feel good. I'm usually dragged out by these summer conventions, but this time I'm looking forward to each run. Even when one of you gets cranky, the others talk him out of it. I've never seen anything like it. I wish I could send my kids."

In Toronto, one of the city department managers was crotchety through all of the planning. Before the Convention began, when they were setting up the refreshment stands in the park behind the Toronto Convention Center, she was there with her customary stone face, demanding that every city ordinance be followed to a tee. On Sunday afternoon, she sped up to a group of us in her golf cart, got off, strode up to us and practically shouted "I have one thing to say to you guys!—Don't go home." During the course of the weekend, the love and fellowship expressed among the attendees had converted her into an A.A. fan. She said in all her years of city service, she had never seen such cooperation and harmony among such a varied group.

As you may be aware, when planning International Conventions, we try very hard to emphasize to hotels and convention centers in Convention cities the magnitude of our event, yet the message doesn't always get across—during one Convention, disaster struck when all the major facilities in the city ran out of coffee—we drank them dry. But worse was yet to happen—in the same city, they ran out of toilet paper. These International Conventions are also opportunities to let the newcomer and the world know we are not a glum lot.

And now we are celebrating A.A.'s 75th Anniversary! The theme for this, our 13th International A.A. Convention, is "A Vision for You." We recognize this phrase as the title of Chapter 11 in the Big Book. This theme gives all members of our Fellowship the opportunity to reflect with gratitude on the favor we have been shown by God. Seventy-five years ago there was little hope for alcoholics like us. And yet here we are, two million individuals united in A.A. Our gratitude underscores our responsibility to offer our experience as a vision for other alcoholics.

In the chapter "A Vision for You" it says, "Some day we hope that every alcoholic who journeys will find a Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous at his destination." (p. 162) Each International Convention to date has been a manifestation of that vision. Ninety-three countries were represented at the Flag Ceremony Friday night in Toronto, a palpable experience of the breadth of A.A. All of this echoes the three purposes of the up-

coming International Convention:

- To provide opportunities for attendees to rededicate themselves to the primary purpose of A.A.
- To enable attendees to witness the success and growth of A.A. around the world.
- To let the whole world know that A.A. is alive, flourishing and available as a community resource.

You, the members of this Conference, will have a large part to play in the success and tone of the Convention. Most of the speakers will come from your recommendations. You already received requests to suggest non-A.A. speakers from professional fields. This fall, we will be asking you to send us suggestions for A.A. members to participate in the over 800 meetings taking place over the weekend.

Another major part in organizing this event is working with the Volunteer Host Committee. We would not be able to welcome so many members from around the world without an able and enthusiastic Host Committee. The core of the committee is in place. They are eager to start, and will begin gathering names of volunteers with a Kickoff Event in January. We anticipate that upward of 4,000 English- and Spanish-speaking volunteers will be welcoming Convention goers to San Antonio.

All of this information will be communicated on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, in Box 4-5-9, and in special Convention mailings. In August, we will be mailing out the Registration Forms for the 2010 International Convention to all Conference members, to the G.S.R.s of all active groups and to others in the service structure, as well as to Intergroups, Central Offices and General Service Offices around the world.

Registration and housing will open in September. Because of the large number of hotel rooms in downtown San Antonio, we will be making rooms available on a first-come, first-served basis. No hotel lottery this year! As in the past, members will be able to register by mail or online. Once you have registered, you will be able to book your hotel room.

So, one day at a time, we are preparing for an international celebration of A.A.'s 75th Birthday. We know this Convention will be a powerful example of the joy of living. And amid the festive crowds, I hope each of us is reminded that "In spite of the great increase in the size and the span of this Fellowship, at its core it remains simple and personal. Each day, somewhere in the world, recovery begins when one alcoholic talks with another alcoholic, sharing experience, strength, and hope." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. xxii)

*Rick Walker, G.S.O. Staff*

## INTERNATIONAL

*The final presentation/discussion session was the first thing on the agenda Friday morning. Dorothy Wilson, trustee-at-large/U.S. was the moderator.*

### 20th A.A. World Service Meeting

Good morning. My name is Julio, I am an alcoholic and currently serve on the International desk at the General Service Office. During this past year of my rotation on this assignment I have continued to receive many gifts and opportunities to witness what is so well expressed in the theme of this 59th General Service Conference, "Our Commitment to Carry A.A.'s Message—Enthusiasm and Gratitude in Action."

However, the unmistakable highlight was coordinating the 20th World Service Meeting in New York, where 59 delegates, representing over 40 countries, gathered under the theme "Service—Gratitude in Action." You will hear more about this wonderful gathering from Jo-Anne, but what I would like to share with you is the process and continuous thread that goes from one World Service Meeting to the next.

While the World Service Meeting (WSM) is not a policy making body, and their decisions only pertain to the functioning of the World Service Meeting itself, the sharing of experience, the sponsorship, and the bonds created at these meetings are invaluable in our common purpose of reaching the suffering alcoholics anywhere in the world. The process for the 20th WSM began immediately after the last Serenity Prayer at the closing of the 19th WSM in Ireland. A meeting following the 19th World Service Meeting reviewed what worked and what needed reconsideration, and together with the responses to a survey from the WSM delegates, we had the stepping stone for the upcoming meeting. We then began to gather information for the 2nd and 1st term WSM delegates, but most importantly the connections made are nurtured through on-going communications, new translation projects and sponsorship.

During the year between the World Service Meetings some of the personal connections and commitments to carrying A.A.'s message are rekindled at the zonal meetings, which take place throughout the world. Zonal meetings bring together the A.A. service structures in different zones or regions of the world. They also serve as a first step for emerging A.A. structures. While participation in their zonal meeting is a requirement for countries interested in attending the World Service Meeting, their attendance at zonal meetings provides new structures with a greater wealth of A.A. experience, greater confidence in their participation, and the support of other A.A. service structures in their region.

Participation and the support of the A.A. Fellowship in their region was of crucial value for Latvia and Belarus, the two countries that participated in the World Service Meeting for the first time in 2008. While Latvia had participated in previous European Service Meetings, the 2007 European Service Meeting was the first for Belarus and provided the spark of enthusiasm and interest in a broader A.A. experience that encouraged them to apply for participation at the 20th World Service Meeting.

In what may be considered the off year for the World Service Meeting, all these mechanics are going on, but when we begin to get closer to the meeting, the activity really intensifies. We begin with the final list of delegates and the assignment of new delegates to their WSM committees. We then continue with our own process of assembling the support team that will work on the organization and realization of the World Service Meeting. One of the most exciting parts of the process is when we begin to receive the country reports and highlights, and the world of Alcoholics Anonymous begins to materialize in front of us.

We hear from the countries requesting to participate for the first time, and we work with them step by step. We rejoice when new countries participate, and are saddened when unforeseen circumstances prevent other countries from participating, as was the case of Turkey and Ukraine last year. While we may be saddened by the unforeseen, we know that it will be only a matter of time before they too will bring their experience and love for A.A. to a World Service Meeting.

We heard from those emerging structures experiencing financial challenges who asked for support and were grateful to hear from even more service structures willing to provide it. The excitement continued when we started to hear from countries bidding to host the next WSM. In total we received 11 bids to host the 21st World Service Meeting, ranging from large and well-established

lished service structures, like Mexico, to newer and smaller structures like Malta. In each bid presentation we could sense the love for A.A. and the willingness to participate and share the experience with local members of our Fellowship.

For the 20th World Service Meeting I organized, improvised, hoped and prayed, but nothing really prepared me for the joy, gratitude and love reflected in the faces of each and every WSM delegate. We are already in the process of preparing for the 21st World Service Meeting, which will be in Mexico City in 2010, and I know that it will continue to fulfill its mission and foster the growth of A.A. wherever the hand of a suffering alcoholic reaches out for help.

*Julio Espallat, G.S.O. Staff*

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My name is Jo-Anne and I am an alcoholic, and have the honor of serving Alcoholics Anonymous as trustee-at-large/Canada.

The first World Service Meeting (WSM) was held in 1969 in New York. The attending countries were chosen on the basis of A.A. population and the existence of service centers in their areas. This meeting brought together 27 delegates representing some 20 countries worldwide.

After this inaugural meeting ended, all the delegates were invited to join the 3,580 guests at the New York Hilton for Bill W.'s 35th anniversary dinner hosted by New York Intergroup. The delegates to the World Service Meeting were seated on a special dais, and one from each country represented spoke briefly in his native tongue, and the delegate from New Zealand shared his recovery story.

At previous anniversary dinners, there had been a beautiful ceremony in which the lights of the ballroom were dimmed, and the small individual flames of matches or lighters at every table symbolize the light that A.A. brought into the "dark world of alcoholics." That year, the World Service delegates took part in an added variation. Bill W. lit a candle and handed it to one of the delegates, who passed it along to his companions. From the single flame, each lit another candle, until the dais was lined with lights to match those glimmering all over the huge room. Just as the message of A.A. had gone from one alcoholic to another, in 1969 the row of candles lit by the World Service Meeting delegates symbolized the worldwide spread of A.A.

Here, in 2009, we are gathered together for the 59th General Service Conference, with the theme "Our Commitment to Carry A.A.'s Message—Enthusiasm and Gratitude in Action," and the light of A.A. is still shining brightly. Look around you; we have been given the huge responsibility to be the keepers of the flame, one watch at a time.

The second World Service Meeting was held in 1972, also in New York, and since then it convenes every two years, alternating between New York City and somewhere else in the world.

The primary purpose of the World Service Meeting is the same as all A.A. activity—to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers, wherever in the world he or she may be, whatever language they speak. The World Service Meeting seeks ways and means of accomplishing this goal by serving as a forum for sharing the experience, strength and hope of delegates from all parts of the world. It can also represent an expression of the group conscience worldwide.

To participate in this service meeting, it is recommended that a country have an operating general service board and/or literature distribution center and, in addition, have attended zonal meetings. Attendance can be up to two delegates from a country or zone; both may be members of A.A., or one may be a member of A.A.

and the other a nonalcoholic member of the general service board, committee or G.S.O., or equivalent in that country.

We were blessed last October 26-30 to host the 20th World Service Meeting right here in New York, with the theme "Service—Gratitude in Action." There were 59 delegates representing more than 40 countries, with Belarus and Latvia being first-time attendees.

Leonard Blumenthal in his welcoming talk said "All of us have witnessed that the seed of A.A., when planted and carefully tended, results in a flourishing movement embodying hope, recovery, and general well-being. This it achieves, in spite of language, culture, politics and geography."

The keynote address was given by Gonzalo P., delegate from Venezuela. Gonzalo shared from his grateful heart how he had found service and what it had done in his own life. He said; "I proceeded not knowing for sure what I was doing, but I was moved by a great desire to serve the Fellowship. It not only saved my life, but has given me, for the first time, a sense of responsibility and freedom as a human being."

The next few days were full of wonderful presentations, country highlights, service highlights, workshops, and some very interesting and provocative sharing sessions. Some of the questions were concerns regarding: "Young People in A.A.," "Women in A.A.," "The Internet," "Translations," "Sponsorship" and "International Literature Fund." The reports from the zonal meetings were astonishing. Our structure has been spared some of the anguish it takes just to have a meeting in some places. I learned that the Class A trustee is still not a part of every structure, but there is much interest in learning about this nonalcoholic person, and how they could help A.A. grow stronger in their country.

The established four working committees of the World Service Meeting are Agenda, Literature/Publishing, Policy/Admissions/Finance, and Working with Others. Dorothy served on Working with Others and my committee was Literature/Publishing. These committees meet to discuss their countries' experience on many issues, as well as to share ideas relating to the World Service Meeting. All committees and workshop leaders were grateful to the staff members from G.S.O. who served as secretaries to these committees and workshops, and were available for the whole process.

The Site-selection Committee listened to eleven presentations from delegates from countries willing to host the next World Service Meeting. After hearing and reading all bids, the committee recommended to the delegates that Mexico City host the 21st World Service Meeting, October 17-21, 2010; the alternate site would be Honduras. This selection was unanimously accepted by the delegates by jubilant clapping and a show of hands.

All the main sessions were in English, with simultaneous translation in Spanish. All second-term delegates had an opportunity to say goodbye and to let us know what they would be taking away with them. There were tears, laughter, love and unity, and every farewell was filled with enthusiasm and gratitude for A.A. and this service meeting.

Leonard Blumenthal gave a very inspiring closing talk that included many moments that made this meeting a special time where the language of the heart had been spoken, and we went home with a sense of those first lighted candles of 1969.

The 20th World Service Meeting was officially closed with the Serenity Prayer in all the languages represented by the delegates present.

The theme of the 21st World Service Meeting in Mexico City will be "Sponsorship: Our Responsibility." God Bless A.A.

*Jo-Anne Lowenberger, Trustee-at-Large/Canada*

# Reports from the General Service Board, and A.A.W.S., and Grapevine Corporate Boards

## GENERAL SERVICE BOARD REPORT

**Trustees' report:** In our theme this year, I would ask that you focus on three key words — Commitment, Enthusiasm, and Gratitude. The A.A. message, imparted by each member of this 59th General Service Conference using this theme, is the best form of attraction to those still searching for personal recovery from alcoholism. This has been an extremely busy year for your General Service Board with much spirited discussion on every item reported.

I would like to welcome Phyllis A. Halliday to her first Conference as general manager of the General Service Office. Phyllis began working at G.S.O. in January of this year, succeeding Greg Muth. She served as the Panel 47 delegate from Area 72, Western Washington, and as Pacific region trustee from 2002-2006. Phyllis' professional background brings extensive management and human resources experience to the General Service Office.

A Search Committee reviewed all resumes submitted by candidates for the position of General Service Office general manager. A professional management consultant was engaged and worked with the committee to narrow the field to three well-qualified applicants. After extensive deliberations and discussion, the Search Committee unanimously recommended Phyllis A. Halliday to the General Service Board, and the board offered Phyllis the position.

Subsequently the board met in executive session to discuss the general manager search and hiring process and issues in the selection process that were of concern to some board members and members of the Fellowship. The board received a number of communications regarding the hiring process and regional trustees responded to these communications on behalf of the General Service Board.

I would also like to thank Greg Muth for his ten years of service as general manager. Greg's extraordinary dedication and diligent work in carrying our service experience to other countries has extended the hand of Alcoholics Anonymous to alcoholics around the world.

In July, we said goodbye to Tom Jasper and Amy Filiatreau. As services director, Tom, over 23 years, assisted five general managers with responsibilities for management of the General Service Office. Before coming to G.S.O., Tom served as an A.A.W.S. director and a general service trustee. His many valuable contributions to G.S.O. are deeply appreciated. Amy Filiatreau, Archives director, tendered her resignation indicating her desire to relocate closer to her family in Kentucky. We are grateful for Amy's substantial contributions to the General Service Office Archives. We are also indebted to Michelle Mirza, senior archivist, for her incredible efforts at providing wide-ranging archival services while the position of Archivist remains temporarily vacant.

Since the 58th Conference, the board has hosted three Regional Forums. In addition, a Special "Remote" Forum, with 69 registered attendees, was held at Moose Factory, Ontario, Canada, marking the end of the Special Forums era. This was a February event as there is a very limited time each year when Moose Factory is accessible by "ice roads." At the Saturday night A.A. meeting, we heard the recovery stories of two A.A. members from the Cree First Nations community in Kuujuaq, who had flown south for four hours to join us. The first Local Forum was held at the International Conference of Young People in Alcoholics Anonymous (I.C.Y.P.A.A.) in Oklahoma City, over the 4th of July weekend.

This year we welcomed one new Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee, Terry Bedient, and two new Class B trustees, Ken Brueggemann,

West Central region trustee and Vic Phillips, Western Canada region trustee, to the General Service Board. Next year the General Service Board will be welcoming: a new board chair, two new Class A trustees, two new regional trustees, two new general service trustees, and new nontrustee directors on both the A.A.W.S. and the A.A. Grapevine corporate boards. At the close of this Conference, we will have the opportunity to thank the following rotating trustees: Paul Cleary, Herb Goodman, Howard Lowery, Ray Massey, Bob Mayer and Dorothy Wilson, for their example of dedicated service to the Fellowship.

Since the last Conference, the board and board subcommittees have addressed many aspects of inventories at all levels with the following results:

- An inventory report from the board, with responses to the inventory questions raised at the March 2007 board Inventory meetings, and suggestions for continuing G.S.B., A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine Board inventories and for reviewing the G.S.B.'s committee system, will be distributed to all Conference members at the 59th Conference.
- A summary of board discussions, which pertained to regional composition and structure, was forwarded to the 2009 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.
- A board recommendation to consider undertaking a comprehensive inventory of the General Service Conference itself was forwarded to the 2009 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.

To follow up on the 58th General Service Conference's Advisory Action delegating responsibility for the General Service Conference Site-Selection to G.S.O. management (subject to approval of the General Service Board), the board accepted the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference's recommendation that, based on an estimated savings analysis by G.S.O. management, the 2010 General Service Conference be held at the Rye Town Hilton, Rye, New York.

During the past year, I was invited to attend the World Health Organization Round Table Meeting in Geneva, Switzerland, and a United Nations Special Session, "Beyond 2008," in my role as a professional and as a resource for information about recovery from alcoholism through the program of Alcoholics Anonymous. I am grateful to report that, since the last Conference, some trustees, various staff members and Greg Muth, past G.S.O. general manager, were invited to travel to Croatia, Finland, Greece, Hungary, India, Lithuania and Turkey to assist others in carrying the A.A. message.

I had the privilege of welcoming 59 delegates representing over 40 countries to the 20th World Service Meeting (WSM) of Alcoholics Anonymous, which was sponsored by this board. Held in New York City, October 26-30, 2008, the theme of the meeting was "Service—Gratitude in Action." The WSM delegates were also invited to join the November 1-3 board weekend as observer guests. We received many expressions of gratitude to the board from our international A.A. brothers and sisters for the opportunity to participate in both these incredibly informative events.

As this is my final report prior to rotation, I would like to express my gratitude to Alcoholics Anonymous for the rare and inspirational opportunity I was given these past four years. I had the privilege to witness this program in action in many different settings and to share its potential at significant international meetings. As we move ever closer to 2035, A.A.'s Centennial, let us never lose our commitment to carry A.A.'s message with enthusiasm and joy and, by our actions, show our gratitude.

*Leonard Blumenthal, L.L.D., chairman*



## ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.

**Directors' report:** Let us take a moment to remember John Skilton, who died the first week of April. A Panel 47 delegate from Area 13, District of Columbia, John served as a general service trustee from 2007 and was chairman of the A.A.W.S. Board from May 2008 to his death. He also served as a nontrustee director on the A.A. Grapevine Board from 2003 to 2007. Phyllis Halliday, G.S.O. general manager, joined John's family and friends for services on April 10th to honor John's life and work. His dedication and service to Alcoholics Anonymous will be remembered by all who knew him.

Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a not-for-profit corporation, composed of nine directors. Members of A.A.W.S., Inc. are the 21 trustees of the General Service Board, who elect directors responsible for oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.), group services, and the printing and distribution of Conference-approved literature and service material. A.A.W.S. owns copyrights on A.A. literature, and is responsible for translations of A.A. literature, including titles licensed to A.A. boards or committees in other countries. The structure, composition and responsibilities of Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. are described in Chapter 10 of *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*.

A.A.W.S. directors include two general service trustees and two regional trustees; three nontrustee directors; G.S.O.'s general manager and staff coordinator. Essential nonvoting support personnel attend each board meeting: G.S.O. staff, chief financial officer, publications director, human resources director, archivist, board secretary, and one or more representatives of the A.A. Grapevine.

Each year directors serving on Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. report to the General Service Conference on A.A. publications, group services provided by the General Service Office, and other activities linked directly to A.A.'s primary purpose. I am privileged to present this report on behalf of John Skilton and my fellow directors.

The board receives reports from G.S.O. management and staff, reviews updates on group services activity, tracks progress on implementation of Conference and board recommendations related to A.A.W.S., reviews financial reports, considers new budgets, prices new and revised publications, considers publishing operations and G.S.O. administrative matters, discusses requests from A.A. members and non-A.A.s seeking permission to reprint A.A. copyrighted literature, and addresses other pertinent matters.

Committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Services (considers the needs of all service assignments); Publishing (reviews reprints, foreign literature and publications matters); Finance (oversees budgeting and financial results); and Nominating (suggests candidates for nontrustee director and general service trustee vacancies).

### *Visitors and Special Guests*

— In 2008 G.S.O. welcomed 1,315 visitors, including several groups of 15 - 50 members. Many A.A. members have traveled great distances to visit G.S.O. and to express their gratitude, in many languages, for their sobriety.

*New Groups:* A net total of 1,458 new A.A. groups were listed at G.S.O. last year.

*Regional and Special Forums* — Since the 58th General Service

Conference, A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff have participated in three Regional Forums: Eastern Canada Region in Truro, Nova Scotia, June 20-22; Pacific Region in Spokane, Washington, August 29-31; and Southeast Region in Knoxville, Tennessee, November 21-23. The first Local Forum, was held in conjunction with the 50th I.C.Y.P.A.A. (International Conference of Young People in A.A.) Convention in Oklahoma City, Oklahoma, over the 4th of July weekend, 2008, and the last Special Forum was held in February in Moose Factory, Ontario.

*23rd Annual Intergroup/Central Office Seminar* — was held in Edmonton, Alberta, September 25-28.

*Other Activities*—Rick Walker, International Convention coordinator, is in the midst of planning for our 13th International Convention, in San Antonio, which will celebrate A.A.'s 75th Anniversary, July 1-4, 2010. A 400,000 piece mailing of registration forms will be sent to G.S.R.s, Conference members and others in the service structure, international G.S.O.s, and U.S./Canada and international Central Offices and Intergroups in August.

Also, G.S.O. staff members were invited to attend and participate in many area service events, conferences and conventions. Staff members shared with trusted servants as far away as Surrey, British Columbia; San Juan, Puerto Rico; Carlsbad, New Mexico; and as close as Washington, DC and Ossining, New York.

*G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site* — The board approved the Quarterly and Annual Web site Activity Reports, and forwarded them to the trustees' Committee on Public Information. We also approved the revised Composition, Scope and Procedure of G.S.O.'s "Intra-Office Committee on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site," and approved revised wording for the page break between [www.aa.org](http://www.aa.org) and [www.aa-grapevine.org](http://www.aa-grapevine.org).

*International* — Trustees and G.S.O. staff members accepted invitations from A.A. in other countries to share experience with A.A. groups and trusted servants in local service structures. Some of these events were: Annual Conventions of Croatia and Greece; A.A.'s 20th Anniversary in Lithuania; the "Beyond 2008" International Non-Governmental Organization Forum in Vienna; the 14th National A.A. Convention celebrating 20 years of A.A. in Hungary; A.A.'s 60th Anniversary in Finland; a World Health Organization Roundtable in Geneva; a convention celebrating 50 years of A.A. in the region of Karnataka, India.

*Financial* — (See details in Report of the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee.) A.A.W.S. approved the 2009 General Service Office Budget and forwarded it to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee for review. The 2009 budget was crafted with the goal that the Reserve Fund would be at the nine-month range at the end of three years; the 2009 budget includes price increases for most books and booklets. Based on the board's responsibility to maintain our Prudent Reserve at an acceptable level, and, based on increases in costs for operations, warehousing and shipping, the possibility of this price increase was discussed over two years.

After several meetings and thoughtful consideration of options, the board approved increasing book prices,





while continuing our shipping and handling charge practices and the current discount structure. Effective July 1, 2009, the price for the Big Book will increase \$2.00, the price of other books will increase \$1.00, and the price of booklets will increase \$.50. The increases apply to English, French, Spanish and foreign literature. The 2009 literature catalog, which will contain the new prices, will be available in June.

In addition, in keeping with prudent financial planning, and recognizing that A.A. is not immune to current economic conditions, G.S.O. has initiated wide-ranging cost saving measures. This includes delaying the Archives expansion/remodel at G.S.O. and deferring our ceiling and lighting project. For the first time in memory, we have put on hold for later consideration annual increases in salaries usually effective in March. In addition, hiring freezes are in place on certain permanent positions. Box 4-5-9 has been reduced to a quarterly publication and, along with other newsletters and bulletins, is offered through digital delivery. This results in substantial savings in printing, postage and mailing costs.

And now a look at last year's financial picture: For the year ended December 31, 2008, G.S.O.'s gross sales of \$12,778,000 were approximately \$78,000 (.6%) greater than budgeted and \$47,300 (.4%) greater than the year 2007. Net Sales of \$12,430,000 were \$80,000 (.6%) greater than budgeted, and \$36,000 (.3%) greater than the year 2007. Gross Profit from literature of \$6,948,350 was 55.9% of net sales. Gross profit has declined from 56.9% achieved in 2007, or 1 percentage point. Contributions for the year of \$6,462,760 were \$212,000 (3.2%) less than budgeted and \$63,200 or 1% less than last year. Total Revenue (gross profit from literature plus contributions) was \$13,416,900; \$90,600 or .7% less than budgeted and \$165,200 or 1.1% less than 2007. Total expenses for the period of \$13,692,200 were approximately \$365,500 (2.7%) more than budgeted and \$1,128,800 (9%) greater than 2007. A net loss for the year 2008 of \$275,300 was incurred.

*Mid-year Budget Considerations (2008)* — The board approved adding the following items to the 2008 annual budget, noting that these projects/items resulting from 2008 Conference Advisory Actions, were approved by the General Service Board at the board's meeting on Saturday after the Conference:

| Item                                      | Line Item           | Amount          |
|-------------------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------|
| C.P.C. streaming videos (changes)         | Writers' Fees       | \$10,000        |
| Track & distribution PSA "I thought"      | Contracted Services | \$35,000        |
| P.I.—update radio script PSA R-10         | Writers' Fees       | \$ 5,000        |
| P.I.—Develop wall poster for young people | Writers' Fees       | \$ 5,000        |
| Treatment—Revision of Hope                | Writers' Fees       | \$ 5,000        |
| <b>Total</b>                              |                     | <b>\$60,000</b> |

*Transfer of Fund Balance* — The A.A.W.S. Board approved a transfer of A.A.W.S. Fund Balance to the General Service Board General Fund in the amount of \$3,058,558.24. This transfer will cover the G.S.B. loss of \$2,982,294.24 and the La Viña loss of \$76,264.00 and will restore the General Fund balance to \$57,012.90.

*Publications* — In 2008 we distributed 45,748 copies of the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, which was published February 2008. Total distribution of all books for the year 2008 was 2,113,574, up slightly from the 2,105,628 total in 2007. In 2008, total A.A. purchases amount to 1,715,780 units, while non-A.A. purchases accounted for 397,794 units, or 19%. In 2008 we distributed 1,111,906 units, compared to 1,127,310 in 2007.

All audio and video products, with the exception of the American Sign Language Big Book and Twelve and Twelve, have been

successfully converted to digital format and are available in the appropriate CD or DVD format.

*Translation Projects Completed in 2008: Kyrgyz (Kyrgyzstan):* "44 Questions"; "A Brief Guide to A.A."; "A Newcomer Asks"; "A.A. Fact Sheet"; "Is A.A. for You?"; "This is A.A." *Vietnamese:* "A.A. Fact Sheet." *Russian:* *As Bill Sees It.* *Croatian:* *Living Sober.* *Macedonian:* *The Twelve Steps.*

*Kindle Reader:* We reached agreement with Amazon.com and they will be making the Big Book and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* available for sale to their Kindle Reader customers. At the present, the Big Book and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* are available for reading only on [www.aa.org](http://www.aa.org).

*G.S.O. Archives* — We regretted having to announce that Archives director, Amy Filiatreau, tendered her resignation effective July 3, 2008. Everyone here acknowledges Amy's contributions to our services and wishes her well in her new endeavors.

In 2007 the A.A.W.S. Board authorized the purchase of Laserfiche software, a document management product that stores, shares and organizes electronic documents. The software has a powerful indexing, as well as intuitive search options, that effectively promotes information retrieval. Test software was installed last year for use by Archives staff and five G.S.O. staff members. The Laserfiche repository now holds thousands of electronic records, including a complete collection of minutes from A.A.W.S. and General Service Board meetings, group records, Conference Reports, A.A. Conference-approved literature, G.S.O. newsletters and other vital documents. Archives staff continues to populate the repository with A.A. records and now all eleven G.S.O. staff members have been fully trained to utilize its search functions.

Archives staff gathered all literature and special products produced by the Grapevine. The staff also completed processing, preserving or cataloging the Domestic and International area files; created a zonal meeting collection; created an index for foreign language and international pamphlets that compiles information such as language, location of publication, publishing dates and publication codes; processed and consolidated Regional Forum files; created a finding aid for the Creating a Sober World collection, which consists of material describing trips to the former U.S.S.R., intended to introduce Soviet alcoholics to Alcoholics Anonymous; and completed preserving and scanning the entire collection of General Service Board and A.A.W.S. minutes.

As directed by the trustees' Archives Committee, a digital video surveillance was installed in the Archives exhibit area. There are four-color cameras monitoring every public space in the Archives. The Archives staff created a new self-guided tour of the Archives, which also serves as a keepsake for visitors as it includes historical photographs as well as a brief narrative for each photograph in the permanent photographic exhibit. Two new exhibit cases were installed, showcasing a rotating display of A.A.-related artifacts.

*G.S.O. and Staff Operations* — At year-end 2008, G.S.O. had 85 full-time employees, and 5 part-time employees.

The *Fellowship New Vision* (FNV) System is fully integrated and is proving to be a great asset and benefit to area registrars who are able to share A.A. group information and updates with G.S.O.'s Records Department.

The general manager and the staff member on the C.P.C. desk, attended the October 9th Annual Day of Sharing hosted by Al-Anon at their Virginia Beach office. The purpose of this Day of Sharing between Al-Anon (AFG), the National Council on Alcoholism and Drug Dependence (NCADD) and A.A. is to share experience, strength and hope in a spirit of cooperation so that participants may discover ways in which shared experience can be beneficial, keeping in mind our tradition of cooperation without affiliation.

*John Kane, A.A.W.S. treasurer*

# Literature Distributed — 2008

## ENGLISH

### Books

|                                                  |                  |
|--------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Alcoholics Anonymous                             | 521,727          |
| Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover)                | 391,557          |
| Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)               | 46,553           |
| Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)           | 154,350          |
| Daily Reflections                                | 169,604          |
| Daily Reflections (large print)                  | 13,214           |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)    | 177,922          |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)    | 9,976            |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)  | 183,909          |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print) | 21,809           |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)  | 62,156           |
| A.A. Comes of Age                                | 10,864           |
| As Bill Sees It                                  | 34,840           |
| As Bill Sees It (soft cover)                     | 30,923           |
| As Bill Sees It (large print)                    | 5,680            |
| Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers                   | 10,977           |
| "Pass It On"                                     | 9,265            |
| Experience, Strength & Hope                      | 12,844           |
| <b>Total</b>                                     | <b>1,868,170</b> |

### Booklets

|                                                               |                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| The A.A. Service Manual/<br>Twelve Concepts for World Service | 30,358         |
| Living Sober                                                  | 155,951        |
| Living Sober (large print)                                    | 7,848          |
| Came to Believe                                               | 60,992         |
| Came to Believe (large print)                                 | 2,966          |
| A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate                             | 22,645         |
| <b>Total</b>                                                  | <b>280,760</b> |

### Pamphlets

|                                                     |         |
|-----------------------------------------------------|---------|
| A.A. and the Armed Services                         | 11,457  |
| A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic                  | 26,159  |
| A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional | 33,331  |
| A.A. for the Native North American                  | 16,032  |
| A.A. for the Woman                                  | 113,993 |
| The A.A. Group                                      | 100,344 |
| A.A. in Your Community                              | 46,521  |
| A.A. in Correctional Facilities                     | 23,541  |
| A.A. in Treatment Facilities                        | 26,733  |
| The A.A. Membership Survey                          | 43,695  |
| The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs         | 108,415 |
| A.A. Tradition—How It Developed                     | 31,286  |
| A.A.'s Legacy of Service                            | 15,166  |
| A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous               | 132,504 |
| Circles of Love and Service                         | 49,361  |
| Bridging the Gap                                    | 29,326  |
| Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.                | 21,208  |
| The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous             | 15,477  |
| Do You Think You're Different?                      | 125,545 |
| 44 Questions                                        | 247,858 |
| 44 Questions (large print)                          | 5,298   |
| G.S.R.                                              | 43,046  |
| Grapevine—Our Meeting in Print                      | 19,727  |
| How A.A. Members Cooperate                          | 16,918  |
| How It Works                                        | 72,271  |
| If You Are a Professional                           | 35,977  |
| Inside A.A.                                         | 48,934  |
| A.A. for the Black and African American Alcoholic   | 28,801  |
| Is A.A. for You?                                    | 390,650 |
| Is A.A. for Me?                                     | 104,953 |

|                                                     |         |
|-----------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?             | 19,912  |
| Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?                 | 99,445  |
| It Happened to Alice                                | 45,588  |
| It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell                     | 49,038  |
| The Jack Alexander Article                          | 24,221  |
| Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends                  | 13,940  |
| A Member's-Eye View of A.A.                         | 52,019  |
| Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic           | 37,916  |
| A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators | 11,717  |
| A Newcomer Asks                                     | 354,800 |
| Problems Other Than Alcohol                         | 127,999 |
| Questions and Answers on Sponsorship                | 299,626 |
| Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings                       | 17,614  |
| The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated   | 32,009  |
| The Twelve Steps Illustrated                        | 73,912  |
| Twelve Tradition Flyer                              | 7,118   |
| The Twelve Traditions Illustrated                   | 58,916  |
| This Is A.A.                                        | 295,144 |
| This Is A.A. (large print)                          | 6,318   |
| Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.         | 17,692  |
| AA for the Older Alcoholic (Lrg Print)              | 57,262  |
| Too Young?                                          | 82,656  |
| Understanding Anonymity                             | 61,647  |
| What Happened to Joe                                | 50,134  |
| Young People and A.A.                               | 118,903 |

**Total 4,000,073**

### Miscellaneous

|                                                     |         |
|-----------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Wallet cards-two-fold                               | 351,801 |
| Wallet cards-I Am Responsible                       | 53,790  |
| Wallet cards-Anonymity                              | 29,439  |
| Anonymity Display Card                              | 2,734   |
| Parchment-scrolls                                   | 2,022   |
| Placards                                            | 525     |
| C.P.C. Workbook                                     | 1,604   |
| Archives Workbook                                   | 664     |
| Correctional Facilities Workbook                    | 1094    |
| P.I. Workbook                                       | 2,158   |
| Treatment Facilities Workbook                       | 1,703   |
| Treatment Facility Kit                              | 399     |
| Big Book on CD ROM                                  | 132     |
| Twelve and Twelve on Computer Disk38                |         |
| A.A. Guidelines                                     | 72,829  |
| Group Handbook                                      | 2,677   |
| Wire Racks                                          | 1,993   |
| Cassettes (tape cassettes)                          | 211     |
| Audio CD's                                          | 779     |
| Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)               | 608     |
| Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed cassette album)        | 53      |
| Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed cd album)              | 2,219   |
| A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)                  | 19      |
| A.A. Comes of Age (cd album)                        | 311     |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album) | 245     |
| Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cd album)       | 1,676   |
| TV Public Service Announcement                      | 475     |
| Radio Public Service Announcements                  | 218     |
| Twelve Steps Shade displays                         | 2,084   |
| Twelve Traditions Shade displays                    | 1,932   |
| Fact File                                           | 2,408   |
| Table Top Display 12 & 12                           | 535     |
| Pioneers of AA (cassette album)                     | 17      |
| Pioneers of AA (cd album)                           | 208     |
| Living Sober (cassette album)                       | 37      |
| Living Sober (cd album)                             | 481     |

**Total 540,118**  
**Grand Total 6,689,121**

## SPANISH

### Books & Booklets

|                                                                                                                     |                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Alcohólicos Anónimos<br>(Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)                                                           | 19,135         |
| Alcohólicos Anónimos<br>(Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)                                                            | 21,987         |
| Alcohólicos Anónimos<br>(Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)                                                 | 7,955          |
| Alcohólicos Anónimos<br>(Alcoholics Anonymous Large Print)                                                          | 4,787          |
| Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)                                                                                   | 5,741          |
| A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)                                                                 | 3,623          |
| El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos<br>(Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)                                               | 2,932          |
| Transmitelo (Pass it On)                                                                                            | 4,042          |
| Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)                                                                             | 12,069         |
| Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)                                                                                      | 15,104         |
| El Manual de Servicios de A.A./<br>Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial<br>(A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts) | 5,266          |
| Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones<br>(Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)                                               | 22,812         |
| Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)                                                                                  | 7,108          |
| A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso<br>(Inmate to Inmate)                                                            | 5,867          |
| Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)                                                                          | 5,381          |
| Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (large print)                                                                         | 4,452          |
| De las tinieblas hacia la luz                                                                                       | 5,259          |
| <b>Total</b>                                                                                                        | <b>153,520</b> |

### Pamphlets

|                                                                                                     |        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)                                                       | 6,620  |
| 44 Preguntas (44 Questions)                                                                         | 27,559 |
| Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)                                                                         | 28,420 |
| Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)                                                              | 67,297 |
| Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida?<br>(Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)                              | 6,755  |
| Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico<br>(Memo to an Inmate)                                 | 4,329  |
| El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A.<br>(A Member's-Eye View)                                    | 4,971  |
| Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander<br>(Jack Alexander Article)                                 | 5,780  |
| Seamos amistosos con nuestros amigos<br>(Let's be Friendly with our Friends)                        | 1,676  |
| Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W.<br>(Three Talks to Medical Societies)                 | 3,948  |
| Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)                                                          | 15,740 |
| Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)                                                             | 8,298  |
| Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)                                                     | 5,891  |
| Comprendiendo el Anonimato<br>(Understanding Anonymity)                                             | 5,025  |
| El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)                                                                   | 13,007 |
| Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento<br>(Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)            | 11,292 |
| El Miembro de A.A.—Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas<br>(The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs) | 4,392  |
| Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas<br>(The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)                              | 6,274  |
| A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento<br>(A.A. in Treatment Centers)                                       | 3,865  |
| Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)                                                          | 14,268 |
| La Tradición de A.A.—¿Cómo se Desarrolló?<br>(A.A. Tradition—How It Developed)                      | 5,328  |

|                                                                                                               |                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)                                                                 | 11,762         |
| A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales<br>(A.A. in Correctional Facilities)                                 | 4,082          |
| Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol<br>(Problems Other Than Alcohol)                                             | 8,350          |
| Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda<br>(It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)                                  | 7,369          |
| ¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.?<br>(How A.A. Members Cooperate)                                          | 2,000          |
| Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)                                                                                  | 2,754          |
| A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud<br>(A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional) | 1,998          |
| Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A.<br>(The Clergy Asks)                                            | 1,610          |
| R.S.G. (G.S.R.)                                                                                               | 4,905          |
| ¿Se Cree Usted Diferente?<br>(Do You Think Your Different?)                                                   | 8,945          |
| Le Sucedió a Alicia<br>(It Happened to Alice)                                                                 | 4,337          |
| Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A.<br>Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings                                                | 2,417          |
| A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)                                                                       | 10,806         |
| Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A.<br>(A.A. Membership Survey)                                               | 2,868          |
| ¿Hay un alcohólico en el lugar de trabajo?<br>(Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)                       | 1,877          |
| Es A.A. Para Mí? (Is A.A. for Me?)                                                                            | 15,105         |
| A.A. para el alcohólico de edad avanzada<br>(A.A. for the older alcoholic)                                    | 4,120          |
| Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados<br>(The Twelve Steps Illustrated)                                                   | 10,060         |
| Círculos de Amor y Servicio<br>(Circles of Love & Service)                                                    | 3,616          |
| Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)                                                                        | 1,682          |
| Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados<br>(Twelve Concepts Illustrated)                                                | 2,618          |
| A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas<br>(A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)                          | 1,972          |
| El Legado de Servicio de A.A. (A.A. Legacy of Service)                                                        | 1,227          |
| Si Usted es un Profesional (If you are a Professional)                                                        | 2,804          |
| El Grapevine y La Viña de A.A.<br>(Grapevine...Our Meeting in Print)                                          | 1,069          |
| ¿Demasiado Joven?<br>(Too Young?)                                                                             | 1,027          |
| <b>Total</b>                                                                                                  | <b>372,115</b> |

### Miscellaneous

|                                                                 |                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Guías (Guidelines)                                              | 9,258          |
| Parchments, Spanish                                             | 354            |
| Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)                        | 13,158         |
| Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album)<br>(Big Book on cassette) | 198            |
| Los Doce Pasos (cassette album)<br>(Twelve Steps on cassette)   | 78             |
| Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (cd album)                        | 1,485          |
| <b>Total</b>                                                    | <b>24,531</b>  |
| <b>Grand Total</b>                                              | <b>550,166</b> |

## FRENCH

### Livres (Books)

|                                                                  |       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| Les Alcooliques Anonymes<br>(Alcoholics Anonymous—format relie)  | 5,083 |
| Les Alcooliques Anonymes<br>(Alcoholics Anonymous—format souple) | 1,692 |

|                                                                             |               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Les Alcooliques Anonymes<br>(Alcoholics Anonymous—format poche)             | 710           |
| Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions<br>(Twelve & Twelve—format relie)  | 1,688         |
| Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions<br>(Twelve & Twelve—format souple) | 891           |
| Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions<br>(Twelve & Twelve—format poche)  | 1,243         |
| Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte<br>(A.A. Comes of Age)                 | 526           |
| Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)                                        | 2,184         |
| Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)                                 | 4,853         |
| Dr Bob et les pionniers<br>(Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)                 | 573           |
| (Expérience, Strength and Hope)                                             |               |
| (Experience, Strength and Hope)                                             | 723           |
| Transmets-Le                                                                |               |
| (Pass It On)                                                                | 967           |
| <b>Total</b>                                                                | <b>21,133</b> |

### **Plaquettes (Booklets)**

|                                                 |              |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Nous en sommes venus à croire (Came to Believe) | 1,497        |
| Vivre ... sans alcool! (Living Sober)           | 3,062        |
| Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts      | 1,663        |
| <b>Total</b>                                    | <b>6,222</b> |

### **Brochures (Pamphlets)**

|                                                                                                       |        |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)                                                                         | 8,807  |
| Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)                                                                 | 3,376  |
| Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)                                                      | 13,066 |
| Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)                                                           | 2,087  |
| Collaboration des membres des A.A.<br>(How A.A. Members Cooperate)                                    | 770    |
| Y a-t-il un Alcoolique dans Votre Milieu de travail?<br>(Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)     | 702    |
| Le membre des A.A. face aux médicaments et à la drogue<br>(The A.A. Member—Medications & Other Drugs) | 2,605  |
| Les A.A.—Article du Saturday Evening Post<br>(The Jack Alexander Article)                             | 268    |
| Collaborons avec nos amis<br>(Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)                                     | 193    |
| Questions et réponses sur le parrainage<br>(Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)                     | 2,211  |
| Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les médecins<br>(A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)    | 1,203  |
| Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement<br>(A.A. in Treatment Facilities)                             | 673    |
| La Tradition des A.A. et son développement<br>(A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)                       | 518    |
| Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme?<br>(If You Are a Professional)                                  | 605    |
| L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)                                                           | 1,025  |
| Jean face à son problème d'alcool<br>(What Happened to Joe)                                           | 815    |
| Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)                                                   | 1,516  |
| Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme<br>(Problems Other Than Alcohol)                                    | 2,024  |
| Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A.<br>(A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)                                | 1,712  |
| Les Douze Traditions illustrées<br>(The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)                                | 1,001  |
| Les A.A. dans les établissements correctionnels<br>(A.A. in Correctional Facilities)                  | 1,052  |
| Ça vaut mieux que de languir en prison<br>(It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)                           | 1,230  |

|                                                                                                 |               |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Petit guide pratique sur les A.A.<br>(A Brief Guide to A.A.)                                    | 1,226         |
| Les membres du clergé se renseignent<br>(Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)                  | 259           |
| Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)                                            | 284           |
| Message à l'intention d'un détenu<br>(Memo to an Inmate)                                        | 1,776         |
| Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels<br>(Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators) | 291           |
| Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)                                                             | 2,904         |
| Les Douze Concepts illustrés<br>(Twelve Concepts Illustrated)                                   | 1,419         |
| Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)                                                 | 2,469         |
| Trois causeries à des sociétés médicales<br>(Three Talks to Medical Societies)                  | 531           |
| Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie?<br>(Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)                 | 1,252         |
| Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)                                                                          | 1,379         |
| Causeries à l'extérieur des A.A.<br>(Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)                             | 518           |
| Trop jeune? (Too Young?)                                                                        | 1,971         |
| La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)                                            | 1,132         |
| L'Héritage des Services des A.A.<br>(A.A.'s Legacy of Service)                                  | 679           |
| Cercles d'amour et de service<br>(Circles of Love & Service)                                    | 1,097         |
| Vous croyez-vous différent?<br>(Do You Think You're Different?)                                 | 936           |
| Sondage sur les membres des A.A.<br>(The A.A. Membership Survey)                                | 2,046         |
| Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)                                                    | 1,092         |
| Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)                                                                      | 2,471         |
| AA pour l'alcoolique plus âgé<br>(AA for the older alcoholic)                                   | 1,024         |
| Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)                                                        | 3,722         |
| Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)                                                   | 1,897         |
| Favoriser le rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)                                                   | 268           |
| Les Douze Etapes illustrées (Twelve Steps Illustrated)                                          | 1,769         |
| Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques<br>(A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)      | 601           |
| Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amérique du Nord<br>(A.A. and the Native North American)          | 569           |
| Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)                                                            | 3,577         |
| <b>Total</b>                                                                                    | <b>86,618</b> |

### **Divers (Miscellaneous)**

|                                                                         |                |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| 12 & 12 (cassette album)                                                | 11             |
| 12 & 12 (cd album)                                                      | 608            |
| Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions<br>(Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions) | 2,660          |
| Carte anonymat (Français/anglais)<br>(Anonymity wallet card)            | 1151           |
| Carte Je Suis Responsable<br>(I am responsible wallet card)             | 955            |
| Video Cassettes                                                         | 19             |
| Notre Méthode (How It Works)                                            | 9,955          |
| Manuel de Groupe                                                        | 49             |
| Pochette de l'Information Publique                                      | 26             |
| Pochette des Centres de Detention                                       | 17             |
| Pochette de la CMP                                                      | 3              |
| Prière de la Sérénité (12x16)<br>(Parchment Serenity Prayer)            | 38             |
| Pochette des Centres de Traitement                                      | 18             |
| Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (Fact File)                          | 188            |
| <b>Total</b>                                                            | <b>15,698</b>  |
| <b>Grand Total</b>                                                      | <b>129,671</b> |

## A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

**Director's report:** One of the operating arms of the General Service Board, A.A. Grapevine, Inc. publishes the international journal of Alcoholics Anonymous in print and in audio, along with collections of Grapevine magazine articles in books, CDs, and on its Web site. With the financial support of the General Service Board, A.A. Grapevine, Inc. also publishes *La Viña*, the Spanish-language journal of Alcoholics Anonymous, and collections of *La Viña* stories in CDs and other formats. Describing the experience, strength and hope of current members and their friends, the magazines carry the A.A. message to more than half a million people a month. Average monthly Grapevine circulation, in print and audio, was 106,588 in FY2008. Each copy of the magazine is passed on to an estimated four readers. Average bimonthly circulation of *La Viña* was 10,404. In addition, A.A. Grapevine distributed 125,097 Grapevine and *La Viña* books, CDs, and other items. This included a new collection of stories for beginners and six CDs.

**Board Structure** — A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, has nine directors: two general service trustees; a Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee; two regional trustees; three nontrustee directors; and the executive editor. Most of this year, the board operated with seven, because the Class A trustee position was not filled last year, and because nontrustee director Andy Talbert died in August, 2008, a loss we still mourn. With his passion for A.A. and enthusiasm for service, Andy has made significant contributions to the board and the Fellowship over the years. The board voted to leave his position vacant for the remainder of the year.

This year, the slate of Grapevine directors includes four new candidates: general service trustee Don Miller, nominated to fill the position left vacant when general service trustee Ray Massey rotates after eight years of service; West Central regional trustee Ken Brueggeman, to replace Madeleine Parmley, Pacific regional trustee; and two nontrustee directors, Albin Zezula and Nancy Haynes, to fill the positions left vacant by Jim Branscome's rotation after four years of service, and by Andy's death. The Class A general service position will remain open another year.

The Grapevine's directors met seven times since the last Conference—three times as a Corporate Board; three times as a Planning Committee; and once at a joint dinner meeting with the Grapevine Editorial Advisory Board to discuss the magazine's redesign. The directors will hold their fourth Planning Committee and fourth quarterly board meetings during the Conference. Grapevine directors review the corporation's finances and operations, establish corporate policies, and take formal actions during

quarterly board meetings; they discuss matters of broad policy and develop plans for the corporation's future at Planning Committee meetings.

The directors also meet in committees appointed by the chair to oversee the work of A.A. Grapevine, Inc. The nominating committee facilitated the selection of candidates for openings on the board. The finance and budget committee reviewed the corporation's financial standing each quarter, developed the Grapevine and *La Viña*'s 2009 budgets, and discussed proposed price increases. The *La Viña* committee, oversaw the re-establishment of a *La Viña* Editorial Advisory Board, reviewed the plan for recruiting a new editor, and discussed the importance of asking for more stories from Spanish-speaking A.A. members. The Risk Management committee, reviewed a report on the subscription price increase; recommended revisions to *The A.A. Service Manual*; tracked all Advisory Actions recommended by the General Service Conference and their disposition; and reviewed status reports on Grapevine copyrights, a leadership development plan, a personnel handbook, and disaster plan. The Board Development Committee recommended holding three Planning Committee meetings in tandem with General Service Board weekends to reduce costs; developed a vision statement; reviewed the executive editor's job description and evaluation process; and facilitated the Grapevine Board's inventory and discussion of items of the G.S.B. priority list. The Publishing Operations committee reviewed the Grapevine and *La Viña*'s 2009 editorial calendars, the continued publication of 50-packs, the need for staple-free magazines, and the status of the carry-the-message account. It also drafted revisions of a pamphlet and service piece on finance, forwarded requests that general service committees discuss the use of Grapevine publications in Twelfth Step work, and reviewed publications proposed for 2009, which included collections of Grapevine stories by oldtimers and of Grapevine cartoons and jokes.

**Editorial Advisory Boards** — Grapevine Board and staff are supported by two editorial advisory boards, groups of A.A. members from publishing, public relations, or related fields who share their professional experience. This year the Grapevine Editorial Advisory Board reviewed different stages of the redesign, new publications, and the Web site. *La Viña*'s Editorial Advisory Board discussed how to encourage more A.A.s to write for the magazine, critiqued the magazine, and talked about the search for a new editor.

**Grapevine Financial Report** — The Grapevine realized a loss of \$138,456 in comparison to a budgeted net income of \$3,204 for FY 2008. This was behind budget by \$141,660. Total A.A.



Grapevine income, including cash flow interest and interest from the Reserve Fund, was \$1,806,617, which was \$92,122 behind budget. Total expenses of \$1,945,073 were \$49,532 higher than budgeted.

Total magazine income of \$2,076,062 was \$13,399 below budget and \$125,829 ahead of 2007. Direct costs of the magazine of \$826,840 were \$36,759 higher than budget, resulting in a gross profit on the magazine of \$1,249,220. Grapevine items yielded income of \$759,259, which was \$53,457 behind budget and \$10,983 less than last year. Gross profit on related items was \$491,197. Total gross profit was \$1,740,417, which was \$85,549 behind budget and \$73,022 ahead of 2007. Editorial costs of \$600,218 were under budget by \$21,041. Circulation and business expenses of \$1,070,393 were under budget by \$19,172. General and administrative expenses of \$274,462 were \$89,745 over budget, mainly due to professional fees. Total editorial, business, and administrative costs and expenses were \$1,945,073.

*La Viña — Financial Report* — *La Viña* is published by the A.A. Grapevine at the request of the General Service Conference and funded by the General Service Board. Bimonthly circulation of *La Viña* averaged 10,404 for FY 2008. Magazine income was \$94,627, which was under budget by \$7,524. Direct costs of \$72,016 were \$4,723 over budget. Gross profit on the magazine was \$22,611. This was \$12,247 below budget and \$12,623 behind the same period in 2007. Income from *La Viña* items was \$30,008, which was \$10,792 behind budget. Gross profit on related items was \$22,279, which was \$8,021 behind budget. Net loss for the year was \$76,264. This was \$8,893 behind budget. Costs and expenses for the year were \$121,154. This was \$11,375 below budget.

Designed to be financially and editorially independent, A.A. Grapevine, Inc., has an unusual business model. The Grapevine does not receive revenue from ads or contributions from groups or individual members. It supports its operation through the sale of subscriptions, books, and other items. Nor does it promote or sell its publications in stores, other magazines, or non-A.A. outlets. Historically, the Grapevine has tried to absorb rising costs of production and inflation by cutting expenses rather than raising prices. Since 2000, it has cut staff from 27 to 12 by outsourcing services and reduced office space 25%. Since 1996, it has raised the subscription price of the Grapevine only twice (\$3.00 in 2002 and \$2.00 in 2007) and of *La Viña* once (\$1.50 in 2007). As a result, its subscription prices have not kept pace with inflation. (In 1946, the one-year subscription price for an 8-page Grapevine was \$2.50. If the Grapevine had kept pace with that rate, and not increased pages, in 2008, a subscription would have been \$27.60.) As a result, fixed costs keep outpacing income and the Grapevine keeps falling into deficit.

To break that cycle, the board adopted a pricing policy in 2007, that keeps pace with increasing costs, which is being implemented this year. In February, the price of most books was raised \$2.00. As of July 1, a one-year subscription to the Grapevine will go up to \$27 to help catch up with inflation. *La Viña* will go up to \$12.00. Barring unforeseen events or changes in the economy, this should help A.A. Grapevine, Inc., break even in 2011. That is because it



takes about 16 months to fully realize income from subscriptions, which are renewed on a rolling basis.

*Plan for 2008-2010* — Implementing this pricing policy is part of the Grapevine's goal of maintaining prudent financial management and financial independence set in its plan for 2008-2010. Other goals of the plan are to:

- Reflect the current membership of A.A. and the power of the program.
- Expand and broaden the audience across all platforms.
- Foster the Fellowship's sense of ownership of A.A. Grapevine, Inc.
- Optimize the organization's resources and operations.

Updating the look of A.A.'s flagship magazine was a major step toward the first two goals. Color-full and staple-free, it reflects the vitality and stature of A.A. today and welcomes young people and newcomers of all ages. It also makes the Grapevine a more effective Twelfth Step tool accessible to anyone, anywhere who reaches out for help, including alcoholics in institutions that don't permit stapled material. Other steps taken to meet these goals include:

- Calling for more stories for Grapevine and *La Viña*.
- Sustaining a circulation program that increases communication with intergroups and Grapevine and *La Viña* reps, and encourages the use of the magazines at all levels of service.
- Reviewing office policies and procedures.
- Reorganizing the editorial department, and bringing *La Viña* and the Web together under the supervision of a managing editor.
- Developing the editorial content of the Web.

Many of the initiatives in the Grapevine's 2008-2010 plan also address items on the General Service Board's 2005 inventory of the Grapevine. Among them are conducting surveys to understand the needs of subscribers, encouraging more communication between the Grapevine and A.A.W.S. Boards; and developing ways to support Grapevine and *La Viña* reps. The Grapevine looks forward to updating the look of *La Viña*, enriching the Web site, and continued strategic planning in the months ahead.

The A.A. Grapevine has served the Fellowship for 65 years now. "A mirror of A.A. in action," as Bill W. called it, the Grapevine has changed with the times, and stayed true to its mission, carrying the message of A.A. to alcoholics the world over and uniting us in recovery and service to the program that has given us new life and the desire to share it with others.

*Madeleine Parmley, chairperson*

# AA Grapevine Literature Distributed — 2008

## Books and Booklets

|                                               |               |
|-----------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Best of Bill (Hard Cover)                     | 3,565         |
| Best of Bill (Soft Cover)                     | 9,019         |
| Best of Bill—Large Print (Soft Cover)         | 1,503         |
| Best of Bill—French (Soft Cover)              | 1,761         |
| The Home Group—French (Soft Cover)            | 516           |
| Le Langage du Coeur                           | 618           |
| Best Of The Grapevine I (Soft Cover)          | 1,152         |
| Best Of The Grapevine II (Soft Cover)         | 908           |
| The Language of the Heart (Hard Cover)        | 4,972         |
| El Lenguaje del Corazón                       | 2,521         |
| Best of the Grapevine III (Soft Cover)        | 954           |
| A.A. Around the World                         | 923           |
| The Language of the Heart (Soft Cover)        | 3,230         |
| Thank You For Sharing                         | 1,543         |
| Spiritual Awakening                           | 6,209         |
| The Home Group Revised (Soft Cover)           | 2,905         |
| I Am Responsible: The Hand of AA (Soft Cover) | 2,897         |
| Emotional Sobriety (Soft Cover)               | 12,973        |
| The Language of the Heart (Large Print)       | 714           |
| In Our Own Words                              | 5,527         |
| Beginner's Book                               | 7,451         |
| Best Of Bill—Spanish                          | 2,775         |
| Lo Mejor de la Viña                           | 2,049         |
| El Grupo Base                                 | 2,349         |
| <b>Total:</b>                                 | <b>70,034</b> |

## Cassette Tapes

**Total: 466**

## CDs - English

|                                 |               |
|---------------------------------|---------------|
| Pathways to Spirituality CD     | 825           |
| Classic Grapevine CD, Vol 1     | 297           |
| Classic Grapevine CD, Vol 2     | 184           |
| Classic Grapevine CD, Vol 3     | 183           |
| Not for Newcomers Only CD       | 509           |
| Partners on the Journey CD      | 402           |
| Story of AA                     | 554           |
| What It Was Like                | 437           |
| The Twelve Traditions           | 534           |
| It Works if We Work It          | 594           |
| Best Of Bill CD                 | 854           |
| A Lifetime of AA                | 616           |
| Attitude Adjustment             | 1,195         |
| Powers of Example               | 1,120         |
| Emotional Sobriety CD Vol. I    | 1,164         |
| Emotional Sobriety CD Vol. II   | 1,071         |
| Spiritual Awakenings CD Vol. I  | 810           |
| Spiritual Awakenings CD Vol. II | 709           |
| <b>Sub-Total:</b>               | <b>12,058</b> |

## CDs - Spanish

|                                   |               |
|-----------------------------------|---------------|
| Historia de La Viña CD            | 402           |
| Historia de La Viña II CD         | 493           |
| Historia de La Viña III CD        | 409           |
| Lo Mejor de Bill                  | 1,002         |
| La Historia de AA                 | 969           |
| Despaertares Espirituales Vol. I  | 457           |
| Despaertares Espirituales Vol. II | 414           |
| Spanish Cd's Sub Total:           | 4,146         |
| <b>Total:</b>                     | <b>16,204</b> |

## Miscellaneous

|                              |               |
|------------------------------|---------------|
| Facsimile of First Grapevine | 613           |
| Slogans—French               | 171           |
| Aa Preamble                  | 507           |
| Grapevine Binder             | 348           |
| Man on the Bed               | 1,541         |
| Slogans                      | 1,219         |
| Serenity Prayer              | 2,432         |
| Victor E. Poster—English     | 141           |
| Wall Calendar                | 6,935         |
| Pocket Planner               | 10,885        |
| Co-Founder's Memorial Issue  | 1,234         |
| Traditions Checklist         | 544           |
| Victor E. Poster—Spanish     | 74            |
| Spanish—Preamble             | 291           |
| Spanish—Slogans              | 418           |
| Spanish—Serenity Prayer      | 1,160         |
| Spanish—Tradition Checklist  | 880           |
| <b>Total:</b>                | <b>29,393</b> |

**Grand Total: 125,097**

## GRAPEVINE SUBSCRIPTIONS\* — GEOGRAPHICAL BREAKDOWN

|                                        | APRIL 2009          | APRIL 2008          | INCREASE/<br>DECREASE |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|
| <b>UNITED STATES*</b>                  |                     |                     |                       |
| Alabama                                | 813                 | 927                 | -114                  |
| Alaska                                 | 497                 | 513                 | -16                   |
| Arizona                                | 1,726               | 1,744               | -18                   |
| Arkansas                               | 568                 | 577                 | -9                    |
| California                             | 8,930               | 9,297               | -367                  |
| Colorado                               | 1,808               | 1,840               | -32                   |
| Connecticut                            | 1,448               | 1,518               | -70                   |
| Delaware                               | 392                 | 441                 | -49                   |
| District of Columbia                   | 171                 | 190                 | -19                   |
| Florida                                | 4,949               | 5,378               | -429                  |
| Georgia                                | 2,377               | 2,330               | 47                    |
| Hawaii                                 | 520                 | 518                 | 2                     |
| Idaho                                  | 676                 | 618                 | 58                    |
| Illinois                               | 3,348               | 3,690               | -342                  |
| Indiana                                | 1,417               | 1,471               | -54                   |
| Iowa                                   | 1,006               | 1,065               | -59                   |
| Kansas                                 | 1,080               | 1,105               | -25                   |
| Kentucky                               | 865                 | 936                 | -71                   |
| Louisiana                              | 763                 | 813                 | -50                   |
| Maine                                  | 590                 | 624                 | -34                   |
| Maryland                               | 1,314               | 1,467               | -153                  |
| Massachusetts                          | 2,494               | 2,494               | -                     |
| Michigan                               | 3,088               | 3,291               | -203                  |
| Minnesota                              | 2,410               | 2,555               | -145                  |
| Mississippi                            | 456                 | 501                 | -45                   |
| Missouri                               | 1,510               | 1,566               | -56                   |
| Montana                                | 632                 | 659                 | -27                   |
| Nebraska                               | 836                 | 868                 | -32                   |
| Nevada                                 | 644                 | 730                 | -86                   |
| New Hampshire                          | 738                 | 743                 | -5                    |
| New Jersey                             | 2,810               | 2,932               | -122                  |
| New Mexico                             | 683                 | 682                 | 1                     |
| New York                               | 5,501               | 5,714               | -213                  |
| North Carolina                         | 2,273               | 2,365               | -92                   |
| North Dakota                           | 348                 | 364                 | -16                   |
| Ohio                                   | 2,577               | 2,692               | -115                  |
| Oklahoma                               | 819                 | 868                 | -49                   |
| Oregon                                 | 1,413               | 1,531               | -118                  |
| Pennsylvania                           | 4,941               | 5,131               | -190                  |
| Rhode Island                           | 380                 | 361                 | 19                    |
| South Carolina                         | 917                 | 1,006               | -89                   |
| South Dakota                           | 383                 | 391                 | -8                    |
| Tennessee                              | 1,210               | 1,317               | -107                  |
| Texas                                  | 3,958               | 4,281               | -323                  |
| Utah                                   | 571                 | 559                 | 12                    |
| Vermont                                | 356                 | 350                 | 6                     |
| Virginia                               | 2,228               | 2,172               | 56                    |
| Washington                             | 3,065               | 3,061               | 4                     |
| West Virginia                          | 483                 | 508                 | -25                   |
| Wisconsin                              | 2,471               | 2,591               | -120                  |
| Wyoming                                | 306                 | 315                 | -9                    |
| Puerto Rico                            | 31                  | 34                  | -3                    |
| U.S. Possessions/APO                   | 100                 | 105                 | -5                    |
| Virgin Islands                         | 42                  | 43                  | -1                    |
| <b>Subtotal U.S.</b>                   | <b>85,932</b>       | <b>89,842</b>       | <b>-3,910</b>         |
| <b>CANADA</b>                          |                     |                     |                       |
| Alberta/NWT                            | 880                 | 798                 | 82                    |
| British Columbia/Ykn                   | 1,102               | 1,062               | 40                    |
| Manitoba                               | 429                 | 424                 | 5                     |
| New Brunswick/PEI                      | 346                 | 263                 | 83                    |
| Nova Scotia/<br>New Foundland/Labrador | 400                 | 431                 | -31                   |
| Ontario                                | 3,358               | 3,141               | 217                   |
| Quebec                                 | 250                 | 249                 | 1                     |
| Saskatchewan                           | 384                 | 380                 | 4                     |
| <b>Subtotal Canada</b>                 | <b>7,149</b>        | <b>6,748</b>        | <b>401</b>            |
| <b>FOREIGN</b>                         | <b>1,248</b>        | <b>1,253</b>        | <b>-5</b>             |
| <b>Grand Total*</b>                    | <b>94,329</b>       | <b>97,843</b>       | <b>-3,514</b>         |
| <b>LA VIÑA SUBSCRIPTIONS*</b>          |                     |                     |                       |
|                                        | <b>Mar./Apr. 09</b> | <b>Mar./Apr. 08</b> |                       |
|                                        | 7,037               | 7,495               | -458                  |

(\* does not include monthly orders)



# Trustees' Committees, G.S.O. and Grapevine Reports

## ARCHIVES

**Trustees' report:** The committee reviews the G.S.O. Archives policies, procedures and budget and undertakes and maintains final responsibility and authority for the use of the Archives. The Archives aims to ensure that vital records are preserved by applying preservation procedures to prolong the usable life of the records entrusted to its care. The digitization project, envisaged to scan and preserve thousands of paper-based records from the early Alcoholic Foundation, continues. The electronic records facilitate access, which makes it possible to increase productivity and improve service for the future.

The committee approved additions and revisions to the Archives Workbook and incorporated suggestions by the 2008 Conference Committee on Archives.

Many A.A. archivists have asked us how best to use the forms in the Archives Workbook and other service pieces. Therefore, the committee considered ways to make the Workbook more flexible and user-friendly.

The committee continues to support G.S.O. Archives' responsibility in supporting academic and scholarly research and encourages meaningful discussions on ways to make A.A. Archives and history more available to the Fellowship.

*Conley Bird, chairperson*

**Staff report:** The G.S.O. Archives seeks to permanently preserve valuable historical records relating to the origin and development of Alcoholics Anonymous. The Archives serves the Fellowship by providing resource material and service to A.A. members and researchers about A.A. history, responds to world-wide information requests, and offers professional support to local A.A.s interested in researching their group or area's history.

In 2005 the Archives initiated a new preservation project of restoring and digitizing some of the 122 oldest films held in our care. Of these, 60 tapes and film reels were professionally digitized and fully cataloged to meet professional standards.

We also continue in our relentless efforts to assure the physical safety and integrity of our corporate records. We recently preserved and digitized all the meeting minutes from A.A.W.S., Inc., beginning with 1940, when the corporation was then named Works Publishing, Inc. The original documents are now permanently preserved in a secure, temperature-controlled underground vault. We have also digitized over 700 group records, initially

scanned on microfiche cards that are now deteriorating.

As a way of encouraging groups to capture and maintain a history of their existence, the Archives created a Service Piece to aid in this effort. Hopefully, this might encourage group members to record how their meetings got started, as well as record any controversies and growing pains. These group histories, as stories of the past, can be saved and shared for a long time.

We warmly thank those who have helped in our mission to permanently document the work of Alcoholics Anonymous. This year, 56 archival items and collections were generously donated by A.A. members and friends. These new acquisitions have greatly enriched our archives collection and it is our honor to accept these materials.

*Michelle Mirza, senior archivist*

## AUDIT COMMITTEE

**Trustees' report:** This committee was created as a proactive measure to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance. It is composed of a minimum of three and a maximum of five trustees who are appointed by the chairman of the General Service Board.

The committee meets with the outside auditor and G.S.O. and Grapevine management; separately with the auditor; and in executive session without the auditor. The Audit Committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews such items as audit process, audit results, internal controls, best accounting practices, and management integrity. The committee also recommends appointment of the auditor to the board.

*Howard Lowery, chairperson*

## COMPENSATION COMMITTEE

**Trustees' report:** This committee was created as a proactive measure to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance. Its membership is composed of at least four trustees.

The Compensation Committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews and advises A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. on such items as overall compensation philosophies and policies, annual salary increase process, best compensation practices, and executive compensation.

*Herb Goodman, chairperson*



## CONFERENCE

**Trustees' report:** The committee reviewed the Advisory Actions pertaining to the Conference, including the theme chosen for the 59th General Service Conference, "Our Commitment to Carry A.A.'s Message—Enthusiasm and Gratitude in Action."

The committee also developed and approved the schedule for the updated 2009 Conference week, and approved the workshop questions for distribution in the Communications Kit that was mailed in December. In addition, we reviewed the list of suggestions for the theme and presentations for the 2010 Conference.

The committee reviewed a list of topics submitted to the Conference assignment at G.S.O. for consideration as agenda items in 2009. Sixty-eight items were forwarded to trustees' and Conference Committees, or to the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Corporate Boards. This total does not include any items that may have been submitted directly to committee secretaries or to the two corporate boards.

The committee discussed the Conference Agenda Committee's Additional Consideration regarding the suggestion to add a category evaluating the individual Conference members' committee experience and a category to allow Conference members to rate their overall Conference experience to the Conference Evaluation Forms and agreed to take no action, noting that the purpose of the Evaluation Form is to provide information for possible improvements or changes to the Conference and that both suggested additions did not elicit any new or essential information not already included in the current form.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the 2010 General Service Conference be held at the Rye Town Hilton, Rye, New York.

We agreed that G.S.O. would compile a list of items tabled or upon which "no action" was taken by the trustees' committees, similar to the List of Final Conference Agenda Items, and send it out after the board's 2009 Winter Quarterly Meeting, with the List of Final Agenda Items, to all Conference members, and to include an explanation as to why no action was taken on an item or why it was tabled.

We accepted the Final Report of the Subcommittee on Forwarding Minority Reports and Presentations to the General Service Conference and asked the committee secretary to distribute the report to the members of the General Service Board. Subsequently, the committee agreed to forward to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee a submitted request to formulate a procedure for filing a minority appeal directly with the General Service Conference, as described in Bill W.'s commentary on Concept V.

A subcommittee was formed to review the processing of Floor Actions at the General Service Conference. Based on the subcommittee's report, the committee made a recommendation to the General Service Board for an alteration in the process. The full board then recommitted the recommendation to the committee for further consideration. Subsequently, the committee agreed to table this item until their 2009 Summer Quarterly Meeting, following the 59th General Service Conference.

The committee discussed a request that the chairing of the General Service Conference, in all sessions, be performed by the chairman of the General Service Board, the first vice-chair, second vice-chair or the delegate chair and agreed that the chair of the trustees' Committee on the Conference ask the chair of the General Service Board to place on the agenda of the next General Service Board Executive Session the discussion topic: "Who should chair sessions of the General Service Conference?" The committee also agreed that the committee secretary contact pre-

vious G.S.O. general managers and the trustees emeriti for their input on this topic. This was done and background was forwarded to the General Service Board. At its 2009 Winter Quarterly Executive Session, the board discussed this matter and agreed to make no changes at this time.

We accepted and agreed to forward to the 2009 Conference Agenda Committee the "Subcommittee on Coordination of Agenda Items Final Report," with appropriate background. The report includes a request that the Conference Agenda Committee seek input from Conference members at the 2010 General Service Conference on the agenda selection process of the Conference through a workshop topic, presentations, or other means; and recommends further that the Conference agenda items' selection process be a topic of a General Sharing Session of the General Service Board prior to the 2010 Conference.

The committee agreed that the Conference coordinator would develop language that would clarify that personal electronic devices, such as cell phones, Blackberries, laptops, etc., not be used during the Conference for communication about Conference business. The limitation applies to communication with Conference members or others inside or outside the Conference session and committee rooms.

A.A. Colombia and A.A. Brazil requested that trusted servants of their respective service structures attend the 2009 General Service Conference as observers. The committee approved the requests and forwarded them to the 2009 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

*Bill Clark, chairperson*

**Staff report:** The Conference coordinator is the G.S.O. contact for General Service Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year and the coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates. The coordinator of the Conference is also the contact for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 93 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

The annual meeting of the General Service Conference is the closest thing A.A. has to a group conscience in the U.S. and Canada. A.A. members are encouraged to submit topics through their area structures for consideration by the Conference. Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration and, where appropriate, referred directly to a Conference committee. Occasionally topics are submitted that are more appropriately under the purview of either the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Boards. These items are accordingly forwarded for their attention.

The Conference coordinator is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual; and, with the guidance of the Publications Department, the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.

*Doug Richardson*

## COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/TREATMENT FACILITIES

**Trustees' report:** *Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.)* — A primary committee focus is assisting local C.P.C. committees to provide A.A. information to professionals who, through their work, may come in contact with the still-suffering alcoholic.

The committee reviewed the 2008 list of 44 exhibits at national professional conferences, as well as the exhibit evaluations. Offers to exhibit at professional conferences are considered based on expanding the range of professions who may be interested in A.A. as a resource and on new geographical locations.

We finalized changes to the sample C.P.C. PowerPoint presentation and agreed that a printed copy of this sample C.P.C. PowerPoint be included in the C.P.C. Kit and available upon request from the C.P.C. desk.

We worked with the Publications Department on the video segment directed to professionals in the employment/human relations fields to be streamed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, with changes suggested by the 2008 Conference Committee. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the draft video segment be forwarded *only* to the members of the 2009 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community prior to the 2009 General Service Conference for their consideration.

Throughout the year the committee discussed ways that A.A. can continue to be a resource to professionals in the judicial system and that a one-page informational sheet directed towards drug/alcohol court professionals would be helpful. A draft service piece will be reviewed at the next meeting.

**Treatment Facilities** — The committee's interest in treatment facilities, rehabilitation centers and similar centers is reflected through local A.A. committees on Treatment Facilities, Hospitals & Institutions (H&I) and Bridging the Gap (BTG). Shared experience about this facet of Twelfth Step work is conveyed in literature, by written communications, and by articles in *Box 4-5-9* and *The A.A. Grapevine*. The committee considers the need for changes in related literature and service material, such as the *Treatment Facilities Workbook* and *Kit*.

Responding to a 2008 Conference Advisory Action "that the revised video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* be completed with minor changes and brought back to the 2009 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities for review," the committee recommended to the General Service Board that a final version of the revised video, with minor revisions, be forwarded to the 2009 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities.

We also recommended that the proposal to include literature in TF information that would assist area/district Treatment Facilities committees with their effort to carry the A.A. message to treatment professionals and patients in out-patient treatment programs be forwarded to the 2009 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2009 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities a proposal requesting that the committee expand its scope to include service to Special Needs Committees, including an annual review of the *Special Needs/Accessibilities Workbook* and changing the title of the committee to the "Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities/Special Needs."

*Bob Mayer, chairperson*

### Staff report:

*Cooperation With the Professional Community* — The staff member on the C.P.C. assignment, provides information about A.A. and facilitates communication with those outside A.A. who may have

direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work.

The C.P.C. desk responds daily to numerous inquiries from professionals. In 2008, 328 professional requests for information on A.A. were associated with visits to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. Other requests arrived by letter, e-mail, fax and phone. Many of these professionals were put in touch with local C.P.C. committees.

Two issues of *About A.A.*, the newsletter for professionals, were published in 2008. Currently, more than 22,300 professionals receive *About A.A.*

Professional exhibits continue to result in requests for additional A.A. information, as well as personal contacts with local committee members. The C.P.C. assignment arranged for displays at 44 national or international conferences of professionals in 2008. At these exhibits, G.S.O. provides the booth space and literature; local C.P.C. committees coordinate A.A. volunteers who staff the booth to answer questions and provide literature and contacts.

New C.P.C. chairpersons at the area and district levels are sent welcome letters and C.P.C. background material. C.P.C. committees are encouraged to send minutes and to share their experiences for possible inclusion in future *Box 4-5-9* articles.

The C.P.C. staff member greets students from Cornell University Medical Center who visit G.S.O. throughout the year. These future physicians are helped to see that A.A. can be a valuable resource when they encounter the still-suffering alcoholic.

The staff member also serves informally as a liaison representative to several national meetings, such as the National Institute for Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.) and Recovery Month planning meetings.

*Mary Dargan*

**Treatment Facilities** — The primary purpose of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to share experience and information with committees that carry the A.A. message into a variety of treatment settings. The General Service Office currently lists 90 Area Treatment Facilities (T.F.) committee chairpersons, plus 451 district and other T.F. chairpersons, as well as 28 Area Bridging the Gap (BTG) and 18 Area Hospitals and Institutions (H&I) committee chairpersons; 185 BTG and H&I district and other chairpersons are also listed. The total list comprises 772 T.F. related trusted servants. Each is involved in one or more facets of providing A.A. service and/or information in treatment settings.

Each committee chair is sent a welcome letter along with the *Treatment Facilities Kit* and/or *Workbook*, A.A. Guidelines and related material. They also receive *Box 4-5-9* and *About A.A.*

Requests from professionals, clients and/or patients in treatment centers are given careful attention. Each professional is sent literature, and in most cases a contact with members of the local Treatment Facilities or C.P.C. committee is arranged. Requests from clients receive a response from staff along with A.A. literature.

Additionally, this assignment provides a central point for shared experience about Remote Communities work in A.A., and the staff member serves as the G.S.O. liaison to A.A. members involved in this service, and works with the elected chairs of the pre-Conference Remote Communities Meeting. Remote Communities resource materials housed at G.S.O. include pieces of A.A. literature (*Serenity Prayer*, *Steps*, and *Traditions*) that have been translated locally in a variety of Native North American/Aboriginal languages. The staff member on this assignment has also been working with Archives on assembling a history of Native North American A.A. meetings.

*Warren Stafford*

## CORRECTIONS

**Trustees' report:** The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Corrections is to recommend to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings.

In response to Additional Considerations from the 2008 Conference Committee, we reviewed costs associated with adding the DVD "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" and one copy of the Grapevine or La Viña magazines to the Corrections Kit, and requested that these additions be implemented.

We also discussed the request from the 2008 Conference Committee that we consider developing a CD of "The A.A. Group Handbook for Groups That Meet in Correctional Facilities" (CF-36). After discussing the limitations of putting the material on a CD (e.g., having to update the CD each time the service piece contents were updated), we requested that an electronic copy of the Handbook be posted on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site in the section containing service material for Corrections Committees. It can then be printed directly from the site. Placing it on the Web site also allows for easy staff/publications access to make necessary updates as changes occur in the contents.

We agreed to forward two items to the 2009 Conference Committee on Corrections: a request to consider updating the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell"; and a request to discuss issues that may be involved in A.A. members complying with the rules of correctional facilities, for example: signing "sponsorship agreements" or legally binding documents. While recognizing that, as guests in correctional facilities, A.A. members must abide by the rules of the facilities, the committee expressed a need for more widespread sharing about what solutions A.A. members may use to resolve perceived conflicts between facility rules and what A.A. is and isn't.

*Jeanne Woodford, Chair*

**Staff report:** The Corrections assignment is responsible for helping A.A. members and local committees carry the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Around 600 pieces of mail a month arrive from inmates, many requesting free literature, others asking to participate in our Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) or for help in making contact with A.A., either by asking for a meeting in their facility or for a prerelease contact.

When inmates request free literature, they can be sent a Big Book and a selection of pamphlets, and often the booklet *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, with an explanation that the enclosed literature is made possible through the voluntary contributions of A.A. members throughout the United States and Canada. Any additional literature needs are referred to those A.A. members doing this type of Twelfth Step service. This assignment tries to avoid being viewed as the primary source of A.A. literature, since "carrying the A.A. message" in this way is an A.A. service opportunity. This practice is also in keeping with past recommendations of Conference and trustees' Committees on Corrections.

The Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.), coordinated by this assignment, continues to be effective. Many inmates are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support from A.A.s with whom they can share their experience, strength and hope. To fill their requests, this assignment puts out regular pleas to the Fellowship through various channels for new correspondence volunteers—especially males.

One of the most gratifying aspects of the assignment is communicating with area and district Corrections, Hospitals and Institutions, and Bridging the Gap Committees. Two or three times a year, an activity report goes to each of these committee chairs with updated information about new tools or shared experience on how to use those tools. In addition, the redesign of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site brought about a special section where several pieces of Corrections service material can be found, including current and past issues of *Sharing From Behind the Walls* (SFBTW), which contains excerpts of sharing from inmate letters sent to G.S.O.

A frequent question asked by A.A. members involved in corrections service is how to get their fellow members on the "outside" to commit to speaking or sponsoring a meeting in a correctional facility. *Carrying the Message Behind These Walls*, a video created to encourage A.A. members to participate in corrections service, addresses many of the concerns that may hold members back from this rewarding Twelfth Step work.

*Gayle Solheim Riese*

## FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

**Trustees' report:** At last year's Conference we reviewed the proposed budget for 2008 and reported that the G.S.O. expected a profit from operations of approximately \$240,800, which after Conference actions resulting in mid-year budget adjustments, was



reduced by \$60,000 to \$180,800. For the year 2008, however, G.S.O. incurred a loss from operations of \$275,365. While expenses for the year were approximately \$365,000 (2.74%) over budget, total revenue was approximately \$90,000 less than budgeted. The most noteworthy deviation from budget and a change in trend was that contributions for the year finished \$212,000 less than budget.

For 2008 the Grapevine proposed a positive result of \$3,304 and anticipated an excess of expense over revenue from La Viña of \$67,371. In actuality, the Grapevine incurred a loss of \$138,456 and La Viña's loss was \$76,264. At the end of 2008, the Reserve Fund balance represented approximately 9.3 months of operating expenses.

*General Service Office* — Our revenue essentially comes from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions from members. For the first time in ten years, contributions received for 2008 were less than budgeted and less than the prior year as well. As with the rest of the country, we were hard hit in the 4th quarter of the year when contribution revenue was approximately \$224,000 less than budgeted. We were hopeful that this was just a short-term situation. Contributions for January were slightly ahead of January 2008, but February of 2009 trailed February 2008. Contributions of \$6,325,180 received from groups and members were \$203,200, or 3%, less than budgeted, and \$56,400 (slightly less than 1%) less than in 2007. The \$6,325,180 in contributions came from 26,519 groups, individuals, and service entities. That, for comparison, represents 44.1% of the 60,093 groups listed with G.S.O., just slightly lower than the 45.2% reported last year. Total contributions of \$6,462,760, reflected in our 2008 financial statements, include \$137,580 received to help carry the message worldwide from countries and service structures that participate in the World Service Meeting. Funds received on behalf of the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund are recorded as Contributions to G.S.O. The comparable comparisons for prior years were: 2007, \$144,400; 2006, \$145,000; 2005, \$135,000; 2004, \$128,357; 2003, \$102,900; and 2002, \$108,000. While total contribution dollars were slower this year, the number of groups listed at G.S.O. was 60,093 (1,753 more groups), and as noted above the percent of groups contributing declined slightly as well (1.1% of total groups). It is important to remember, however, that the statistics we discuss concerning number of groups, membership and averages are only a reflection of the information we capture on "our systems." We report to you what you report to us.

Turning to the other major component of our income, net sales of literature were \$12,430,000, which was \$80,000 (.65%) greater than budgeted, and \$36,000 higher than 2007 as well. During 2008, while the number of books and booklets sold was approximately the same as 2007, there was a mix of both increases and decreases in the sales of the different formats of the individual titles. (During 2008, the total number of Big Books sold was approximately 1,110,000 compared with 1,120,000 in 2007. This is still a lot of Big Books.) In total, printing and other manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were less than budgeted by approximately \$46,000. Better than anticipated manufacturing costs were offset by higher shipping and warehousing costs (the effect of inflation and pass along of fuel surcharges by the trucking industry hit hard in the first half of the year). Gross profit of \$6,948,350 was \$125,850 greater than budgeted.

The combination of contributions and net literature sales resulted in total G.S.O. revenue of \$13,416,868, some \$90,000 less than budgeted. Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 2008 were \$13,692,233, approximately \$365,529 greater than budgeted. One significant part of this increase is the travel and meetings category. Costs are higher due to higher hotel costs in New York and generally higher costs of travel during most of the year.

When compared with budget, the lower revenues combined with higher expenses resulted in a 2008 operating loss of \$275,365.

Expanding a bit on the use of the Fellowship's money in providing services back to the Fellowship—in 2008, \$9,447,300 was spent on services to the Fellowship, approximately \$920,000 more than spent in 2007. This compares with \$8,528,100 in 2007, \$8,272,000 in 2006, \$7,443,300 in 2005, and \$7,622,288 in 2004.

The 2008 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services, 31% (which includes the Group Services assignment; Box 4-5-9; A.A. Directories; records and files; contributions processing; and French services); the General Service Conference, 13.5%; Loners, Internationalists, and Overseas Services, 8.4%; trustees' and directors' activities, 7%; Regional Forums, 7.1%; Archives, 8.8%; C.P.C., 5.2%; Public Information, 4.6%; Correctional Facilities, 4.6%; World Service Meeting, 3.6%; Treatment Facilities, 2.3%; Special Needs, 1.5%; Nominating, 1.5%; other various, 0.9%.

Contributions provided 68.1% and 31.9% came from the profit from literature sales. (This compares with 76.5% and 23.5% in 2007, 73% and 27% in 2006 and 2005; 68% and 32% in 2004; 72% and 28% in 2003; 71% and 29% in 2002; 70% and 30% in 2001; and 73% and 27% for 2000.)

*2009 G.S.O. Budget* — Turning to 2009, the G.S.O. budget anticipates approximately level sales when compared with the prior year. Even though Contribution revenue had seen favorable upward trends during the past several years, the 4th quarter 2008 decline in contributions reinforced the discussion that a restoration of the overall revenue stream was appropriate.

The 2009 G.S.O. budget reflects the approval of across-the-board price increases in books and booklets. For example, there will be an increase in the price of a hardcover Big Book from \$6.00 to \$8.00. Management continues to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations, as well as assess the services supplied. It should be recognized that as we continue to strive to have literature available throughout our Service Conference, in Spanish and French as well as English, lower print runs in non-English languages usually result in higher production cost. We strive to have the same selling prices regardless of the manufacturing cost; therefore lower overall gross profit margins for low volume items affect the overall gross profit percentages and make price increases necessary from time to time. In 1997 the price of a hardcover Big Book was increased from \$5.00 to \$6.00. The price has not changed since that time with the exception of a two-year period during the introduction of the Fourth Edition. Anticipating a large volume of sales, the price of the Fourth Edition was set at \$5.00 (a \$1.00 per book reduction from \$6.00), thus reducing the expected Gross Profit and with a goal of reducing the Reserve Fund. Projections at that time anticipated that, depending on contributions, the price would be restored in a few years.

In keeping with our Seventh Tradition of self-support, this year's budget anticipates slightly less than a 1% increase in contributions. The budget envisions approximately a 2.6% decrease in costs when compared with 2008 actual results, and is even when compared with the 2008 budget.

The 2009 budget anticipates approximately \$360,500 less operating expenses than 2008. A major factor in this reduction is that 2008 was a World Service Meeting year and the net costs of that meeting not covered by participating countries falls to G.S.O. (approximately \$225,000).

Based on these preliminary assumptions—approximately even unit sales with a mid-year price increase, a very slight increase in contributions, and a slight decrease in total operating expenses—the 2009 budget as approved reflects an excess of revenue over expenses of approximately \$900,000. For the 2009 budget,

management was charged with producing a budget that would allow the General Service Board's Reserve Fund to maintain a minimum nine-month balance at the end of three years. With 2009 Contributions and sales off to a rocky start, management continues to assess expenses and has taken steps to reduce costs.

*The Reserve Fund (and Historic Reference for price adjustments)* — In 1994, G.S.O. lowered certain prices and increased discounts on literature. These changes were undertaken to lower the Reserve Fund, which was at that time approaching the upper limit of 12 months of combined operating expenses established by the General Service Conference. In subsequent years, it became necessary to restore the revenue stream with pricing adjustments. As noted previously, G.S.O. management was charged with presenting a 2009 budget with sufficient revenue that, with all things being equal, would maintain the Reserve Fund at a minimum nine-month level of operating expenses after three years. The adjusted balance (calculated as assets minus liability for Grapevine subscribers), used for the calculation at December 31 of \$12,270,746, amounts to about \$204 per listed A.A. group. The balance used for the Reserve Fund calculation has increased approximately \$1,360,900 from last year following the 2008 transfer from A.A.W.S. as well as an increase in value of the treasury portfolio because of the decline in the stock market and its effect on interest rates. Dividing total Contributions received (\$6,462,760) by the 60,093 groups registered gives us an average of about \$108, while expenses to support services to those groups amounted to approximately \$157.

*The Grapevine* — At the Grapevine, magazine income was approximately \$125,000 greater than the prior year and the average paid circulation of 104,993 for 2008 was approximately 1,000 copies lower than 2007. The average paid circulation of 104,993 compares with 106,099 for 2007, 103,878 for 2006, 104,356 for 2005, 108,426 for 2004, 112,614 for 2003, 115,753 for 2002, 115,000 in 2001, 115,700 in 2000, 115,900 for 1999, 117,300 for 1998, 120,679 for 1997, and 128,360 during 1996. Gross profit on the magazine of \$1,249,220 was \$66,000 greater than last year, but \$50,000 less than budgeted. Other publishing income was \$53,000 less than budgeted and \$11,000 less than 2007 as well. Gross profit on Magazine related items was approximately \$35,000 less than budgeted, but it was \$6,600 greater than 2007. Total income, including interest earned, was \$1,806,600, \$66,400 greater than 2007, but \$92,000 less than budgeted.

Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation and business, and administration were \$1,945,073. Costs and expenses were \$179,852 more than 2007, and \$49,500 higher than budget. Excluding La Viña, the Grapevine reported a loss from operations of \$138,456, which was approximately \$113,400 greater than the 2007 loss of \$25,047, and \$141,662 greater than the budgeted profit of \$3,200.

The Grapevine's 2009 budget, excluding La Viña, anticipates magazine income of \$2,003,734 (approximately \$72,000 less than the \$2,076,062 realized in 2008), an increase in magazine direct costs of \$105,100, and a gross profit of \$1,071,759, (a decrease of \$177,500 from 2008). Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to increase \$142,800, while interest income is estimated the same as 2008. A loss for 2009 of \$167,400 is anticipated, compared with the \$138,456 loss for 2008. The 2009 Grapevine budget anticipates an increase of prices of other items, January 1, 2009, and the Magazine, July 1, 2009.

*La Viña* — La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 2008 average circulation of 10,404. This compared with a 2007 average circulation of 10,979, a 2006 average of 10,223, a 2005 average of 9,453, a 2004 average of 9,316, a 2003 average of 9,222,

and 2002 circulation of 9,000, 8,600 in 2001, 8,500 in 2000, 8,000 in 1999, and 8,400 in 1997. La Viña appears to be a first-rate product. Our hope is that it will increasingly fulfill the needs of our Spanish-speaking members and we will see a growth in circulation. To date, the project has incurred losses each of the past twelve and one-half years. During 2008, subscription income was \$94,631 and direct costs of publishing were \$72,017, resulting in a \$22,615 gross profit. During 2008, La Viña realized approximately \$22,279 from the sales of CDs, net of costs. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$121,154. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to La Viña. Therefore, the overall loss on La Viña for the year was \$76,260, compared with a loss for 2007 of \$67,047. In 2001, the General Service Board recommended that La Viña continue to be published and agreed to provide the necessary funding.

The Grapevine Board and management have worked hard to put out a quality product that is responsive to the needs of the Spanish-speaking members of the Fellowship on a cost-effective basis. For 2009, the loss on the La Viña magazine is budgeted to be approximately \$95,776, (approximately \$19,500 greater than 2008), with circulation being projected to decrease slightly to 10,000 copies. The 2009 La Viña budget anticipates an increase in the price of the magazine effective July 1, 2009 as well. The Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee continue to monitor progress and report results to the Conference. Since the inception of the magazine, approximately \$1,210,000 has been invested in La Viña in excess of revenues generated.

*Other Items* — As noted in prior reports, the A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine Corporate Boards, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee, continue to receive information and recommendations from the Retirement Plan's actuaries concerning funding requirements as a result of 2007 pension legislation enacted by the U.S. Congress. This legislation called for accelerated funding of pensions, which is a departure from the previously accepted method of long-term funding of pensions over the employee's working life.

The government issued additional guidance during 2008 on calculating funding costs. Still uncertain at this point is actual final costs for pension funding for 2009. We will not know until later this year, when the Actuaries have completed their work, how much additional may be required.

In summary, while your trusted servants continue to monitor financial affairs, steps taken over the past several years to enhance the revenue side of the equation, reductions in the expense side and consideration of long-term obligations help insure that the Fellowship's finances remain in good condition. While the outlook for 2009 may be uncertain as the economy unfolds, we will continue to monitor events with our goal to insure the financial wherewithal to carry our message.

*Terrance Bedient, treasurer*

## GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Since the 58th General Service Conference, the board has held three General Sharing Sessions. Following is a summary of each session.

*July 2008 — "A Loving God as He May Express Himself in Our Group Conscience"* — Conley Byrd, Southwest regional trustee, spoke on "Conviction and Compromise." He noted that in the April 1959 issue of the A.A. Grapevine that is reprinted in Concept IX, Bill states that one of the qualifications for leadership is "give and take," the ability to compromise cheerfully when a proper compromise can cause a situation to progress in what appears to be the right direction. Conley observed that compromise comes hard to us "all or nothing drunks." Nevertheless, we must never lose sight



of the fact that progress is nearly always characterized by a series of improving compromises. However, now and then it is necessary to stick flat-footed to one's conviction about an issue until it is settled. These are situations for keen timing and careful discrimination as to which course to take.

In Concept IV, he learned that he had to encourage the participation of others, whether he wanted them to participate or not, and especially when he knew that they would disagree with him. In applying the Fifth Concept, he found a new level of trusting God, even if it meant being in the minority and needing to draw on courage to express the certainties of his convictions.

Conley shared his experience that not every group conscience will be the best expression of a loving God. Some will be the good (His permissive will for us) rather than the best (His perfect will), and some may even be less than good. But he noted that it is our responsibility to apply the principles as we understand them. We can be supported in this by the Tenth Step and by the knowledge that God has chosen us to be a part of this process.

Jo-Anne Lowenberger, trustee-at-large/Canada, spoke on "Trusted Servant Leadership." Joanne shared that over time, the word "trust" has become one of the most important words in her A.A. recovery. She described coming to A.A. lost, without real purpose in her life and unable to trust. Gradually, as sobriety took hold, trust took root, and with that trust came a sense of responsibility. She observed that in her first group conscience meeting how trusted servant leaders in her home group trusted the decisions of the informed group conscience. She learned from them that an open mind is part of being a leader and that she would always have to listen to learn.

Before coming to A.A., Jo-Anne had never heard the term trusted servant. She surmised that everyone in the room was sober and wonderful, and it took a few wrong decisions and rude awakenings for her to understand that "trusted servant leadership" is about being an example of love and mutual respect, letting delegated trusted servants do the job they were assigned.

Jo-Anne closed with this excerpt from a 1995 General Service Conference presentation: "Not one of us is given a torch big enough to lead the drunks of the world out of the darkness and into the light. Instead, each of us has been given a candle that burns for a short while with a flickering flame. If we stand together, the light will outshine the greatest torch. If we argue and bicker and blow out each other's candle so that each of us starts shielding our own little flame, then the alcoholics of the world will continue to suffer in darkness, and so will we."

George Martin, nontrustee director of A.A. World Services, Inc., spoke on "Seeking Our Ultimate Authority." He noted that the phrase "ultimate authority" is referenced both in our Second Tradition, which states that "For our group purpose there is but one ultimate authority—a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience. Our leaders are but trusted servants; they do not govern"; and in Concept I, which states "The final responsibility and the ultimate authority for A.A. world services should always reside in the collective conscience of our whole Fellowship."

Back when the idea of establishing a General Service Conference took form, there were many opposed to it. They perceived a great risk that politics, confusion, expense, and fruitless strife would result. Bill W. acknowledged the legitimacy of these concerns, but believed there was a greater danger of not moving forward, that danger being that the General Service Board would be isolated from the Fellowship it served. George asserted that we must never be reluctant to take a hard look at the critical question, "Is the Conference effectively fulfilling its Second Tradition responsibility?"

When disputes over the extent or use of authority within our

Fellowship do arise, as they inevitably will, a solution will be found only by open and honest discussion among the parties, and by maintaining a deep sense of the importance of the unity of our Fellowship that has been passed on to us by those who came before.

October 2008 — "*Communication in Alcoholics Anonymous: The Language of the Heart*" — Jane Tolar, an A.A.W.S. nontrustee director, shared how each of us in A.A. has a unique story, and we tell them in different ways. But whatever our differences, however broad the variety of our stories, our goal as members of Alcoholics Anonymous is to reach the alcoholic who still suffers. On a Twelfth Step call, said Jane, a member helps the prospect relate to her by telling her own story. At the lectern in an open meeting, the speaker shares his experience, strength and hope so listening alcoholics may relate and so nonalcoholics may better understand our problem and our solution. In a closed meeting, someone relates how applying a Step resulted in a big change in her life. A one-on-one session between sponsor and sponsee can be the intense sharing of a Fifth Step, or a quick exchange of ideas. In a sharing session, "each person offers an opinion and never needs to defend it" (*The A.A. Service Manual*, 2008-2009, p. S40). In a business meeting, we reach an informed group conscience by talking, listening, debating and thinking, not necessarily in that order. Outside the Fellowship, the audience and message may change, but the goal remains to help other alcoholics achieve sobriety.

Jane referred to a book titled *Storytelling in Alcoholics Anonymous — A Rhetorical Analysis* (Southern Illinois University Press, 2000). The author found that "members go through a long process of learning how to tell one's story.... There is no right or wrong way to tell one's story, but... members do not grow without changing how they speak, and they cannot really change how they speak without experiencing growth." (pp. 129-130). Jane observed that the author is not a member of A.A., but he clearly understands why we tell our stories—to record the changes in our own lives and to help change the lives of others.

Rogelio Flores, Class A trustee, the second speaker, began by noting how interesting it was to him that we begin a sharing session with a moment of silence! Rogelio said that while he was spending the past 22 years serving the residents of Santa Barbara County, California, as a judicial officer, he had no inkling that his career path would lead him to serve as a Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee of the A.A. General Service Board.

It became clear to him early on in his career that most persons who appeared in his court suffered from alcohol dependency. He could see how lost they were, how they and their loved ones suffered from the ravages of alcoholism, and how much they needed to be spoken to with clarity and strength. Though "justice is blind," Rogelio never stopped loving those who appeared before him. Because of this love for his fellow man, he strives to speak in this A.A. language of love, clarity, sanity, and understanding. As hard as he tries and no matter how many books he reads about alcoholism, or as many seminars, board meetings, Conferences and Regional Forums he goes to, he still relies on A.A.s to carry the message to those who he sends our way from the judicial bench.

Rogelio said that when he has been asked about why he agreed to serve as a Class A trustee, he likes to tell people that being a public servant requires service. When he attends a meeting and hears how A.A.s share their life stories, it is a clear reminder to him that we are all small cogs in a much bigger machine, we all need each other, working together and communicating in this language of love, the Language of the Heart.

February 2009 — "*A.A. Unity—Love and Tolerance of Others is Our Code*" — Ken Brueggemann, West Central regional trustee, shared



that when our co-founder Bill W. wrote that "love and tolerance of others is our code," he was speaking A.A. Ken noted that there probably was no better place than a Board Weekend to contemplate this topic, since everyone arrives as appointed committee members, nontrustee directors, staff, and trustees of various stripes. He was particularly pleased to be addressing this topic during the weekend when Conference committee chairs are in town. Ken shared that, while trying to be tolerant, he finds that hearing anyone extol the wonders of the spiritual experience of the General Service Conference diminishes the actual spiritual awakenings we have all undergone through the Steps. "Rubbing shoulders with the big kids in New York is more ego inflation than of advancing the purpose of A.A."

Ken explained that a code of love and tolerance does not mean we embrace mediocrity in service. As Concept IX indicates, "Good service leaders...are at all levels indispensable...." Claiming personal satisfaction at never having gone to the microphone or spending more time exchanging mementos than in communicating with others who have experience or insight on a given topic is not acting within our code at this level. Scheduling theater or baseball outings that become a priority over Conference commitment shows little love for A.A. Celebrating how many committees are chaired by any given region, rather than insuring that the best leadership available is selected, certainly has no positive effect on Unity.

Unity within the board, unity within the lower one-third of the triangle, and ultimately unity within the whole service structure requires of us that we maintain as a code the qualities of love and tolerance. Without those, Ken concluded, we might rise to our own personal pinnacles of service, while the service structure of A.A. becomes tarnished.

The second presenter, A.A.W.S. nontrustee director Roberta Lindeman, recalled complaining to her first sponsor about a man in their home group she did not like, and her sponsor advised her that we might not *like* everyone in A.A. but we must love and tolerate them because they, like us, were seeking release from alcoholism. The sponsor also said Roberta would be surprised at what these individuals who annoyed her might teach her. Roberta noted that her sponsor was right. This man, who is now deceased, never was a person Roberta wanted to be close friends with, and she couldn't say she ever really *liked* him, but she did develop a loving tolerance toward him, and this helped Roberta learn to keep a more open mind to the sharing of others.

The loving heart that develops as we recover in the service of A.A. brings us tolerance and assures unity in Alcoholics Anonymous. A desire to give back for what she has received overrides the character defects that might otherwise have free rein. Roberta shared that love and tolerance help her forget to be petty, envious or critical when she is helping another woman, reading the background for a meeting, or carrying out a committee assignment or any other A.A. responsibility. She explained that what she may have to offer in the way of experience, education and expertise would be negated if there was a shortage of love in her heart and tolerance in her head: "I am here to responsibly do the best job I can. My spiritual fitness will determine how well I do that and the fun I have doing it. When I experience the joy of service, it is a direct result of a loving heart. That, to my way of thinking, is the most important quality any of us can bring to the table."

Roberta's experience has been that our code of love and tolerance of others assures sobriety for individuals in A.A., or at least guarantees the opportunity for sobriety, while protecting and preserving the Fellowship from our character defects. Respect for each other, a byproduct of tolerance, and the acceptance generated by love for each other provide cornerstones of stability that have withstood many tests over 73 years.

## A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

**Office report:** Since the last Conference, 18 issues of the Grapevine and La Viña have been produced, plus the *Beginners' Book*; 2009 wall calendar and pocket planner; *Spiritual Awakenings* audiobook, 2 CDs (Spanish); Co-founders' Memorial Issues (French); *Voices of Long-term Sobriety*; and 12 issues of the e-newsletter, "Heard It Through the Grapevine." In addition, the office has maintained a robust circulation program, redesigned the Grapevine magazine and elements of the Web site, and begun implementing the pricing policy set forth in the A.A. Grapevine, Inc.'s 2008-2010 strategic plan.

The A.A. Grapevine staff currently consists of 11 full-time and 3 part-time employees, who work on the production of the publications, circulation and public information, finance and shipping, and customer service. This summer, those working on the production of La Viña, the Grapevine, the Web site and other items were brought together under the supervision of a newly hired managing editor, Amber Eden, who has extensive experience in both print and online magazine publishing. The team's first priority has been updating the look of the Grapevine and other publications, so they better reflect the current Fellowship and are more useful and attractive to newcomers and long-term members.

To increase awareness of the Grapevine and La Viña, the circulation director has maintained steady communication with readers, Grapevine/La Viña reps (GvR/RLVs), intergroup/central offices, and Conference members with letters, press releases, postcards and other materials highlighting the audioGrapevine and other publications. Working together, the office manager and circulation director do all they can to support GvRs and RLVs (who now number approximately 4,000 GvRs and 450 RLVs), and support the workshops and presentations at conventions and assemblies that have proved to be an important means of increasing awareness of Spanish-language publications. To celebrate the A.A. Grapevine's 65th anniversary, in March the circulation and editorial departments launched the "Grapevine is..." contest, inviting readers and web visitors to share, in a word, what A.A.'s meeting in print means to them.

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.'s chief financial officer, the controller, drafts Grapevine and La Viña budgets in collaboration with the board's finance committee, reports on GV and LV financial standing each quarter and keeps a close watch on company expenditures and cash flow. In addition, the controller supervises in-house shipping and customer service, serves as chair of two trustees' retirement committees and plays a key role in strategic planning. He and the rest of the Grapevine team also help the Fellowship understand that the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. strives to be self-supporting and does not receive group contributions to cover the cost of its operation. Its mission is to carry the A.A. message, and break even, with the help of the Fellowship.

*Robin Bromley, executive editor*

## GROUP SERVICES

**Staff report:** The group services coordinator responds to all inquiries and concerns of A.A. members and other individuals regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, manages G.S.O.'s Intra-Office Web site committee, and serves as secretary to the A.A.W.S. Board Services Committee. Responsibilities also include serving as G.S.O.'s liaison to 500 Intergroups/Central Offices throughout the U.S. and Canada and supervising the development and updating of service material. Examples of service material include: Group Handbooks; G.S.R. and D.C.M. Kits; and A.A. Guidelines.

Ongoing projects: Works closely with the Digital Media Manager to continually update and improve G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site; collaborates

rates with the Support Services manager regarding A.A. Directories (Canada, Western U.S., and Eastern U.S.) and is a resource to the executive editor regarding the updating of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

The staff member on Group Services also serves as secretary of the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, and as the regional correspondent for the southeast region of the United States.

*Mary Clare Lynch*

## INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE

**Trustees' report:** This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature in other languages, and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal meetings. The committee is the primary link between the international A.A. community and the U.S./Canada General Service Board of Trustees.

**World Service Meeting** — The 20th World Service Meeting (WSM) was held October 26-30 in New York City, with the theme "Service-Gratitude in Action." There were 59 delegates representing over 40 countries or zones in attendance. Jo-Anne Lowenberger, trustee-at-large/Canada, was the first-term delegate, and Dorothy Wilson, trustee-at-large/U.S., was the second-term delegate representing the General Service Board. G.S.O. general manager, Greg Muth, presided at the event and staff member, Julio Espallat, served as WSM coordinator. The next WSM will take place in Mexico City, October 17-21, 2010, with the theme "Sponsorship: Our Responsibility."

**Literature Assistance** — The 2009 Literature Assistance budget of \$150,000 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of foreign-language books, pamphlets and reprints. A portion of this expense will be drawn from the International Literature Fund, representing contributions from A.A. groups and structures around the world. A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all foreign-language versions of our Conference-approved material and issues licensing agreements for publication and distribution to those countries which have an established general service office, board, conference or structure. When necessary, we translate and publish the material, subject to scheduling by the Publications Department and approval of the A.A.W.S. Board. In 2008, 17 translations were completed.

**Interim Zonal Meetings** — The United States and Canada will be represented at four zonal service meetings in 2009, which are held in the year when the World Service Meeting does not meet. In May 2009, Julio Espallat will attend, as an observer, the 4th Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting being held in Johannesburg, South Africa. The new G.S.O. staff member on the International Desk will attend, as an observer, the 8th Asia-Oceania Service Meeting in Bangkok, Thailand in July and the 15th European Service Meeting in Frankfurt, Germany in October. Jo-Anne Lowenberger, trustee-at-large/Canada, and the new trustee-at-large, U.S. will be delegates to the 16th Meeting of the Americas (REDELA) in Arequipa, Peru, in October 2009.

**International Trips** — The General Service Board and General Service Office responded to many invitations from other countries to attend events ranging from conventions, anniversary celebrations, conferences, board meetings, office visits, regional assemblies, and other events. Trustees and staff members visited many countries, including Cuba, Ukraine, Costa Rica, Germany, Great Britain, Trinidad and Tobago, Greece, Lithuania, Hungary and Finland.

*Dorothy Wilson, chairperson*

**Staff report:** The International desk receives correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries outside of the U.S. and Canada. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 60 international general service offices and/or literature distribution centers.

Other responsibilities on the assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting (WSM) and maintaining contact with WSM delegates and their offices throughout the year.

- Maintaining close communications with our Publications Department on requests for new translations of literature, and the beginnings of new general service or information offices that may be able to distribute literature to local members and groups.

- Translation of A.A. literature: Each year, the A.A. World Services Board receives offers to translate our literature into foreign languages. Primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message. To that end, the Publications Department has the responsibility of having each translation checked against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish or distribute A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available. The Big Book has been translated into 57 languages, and additional translations are in progress.

- Communications related to overseas trips, including Interim Zonal Service Meetings, held biennially in the year between each World Service Meeting. In addition, our office sends one or two observers to the Asia-Oceania, European, Eastern European and Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meetings. Our trustees-at-large (U.S. and Canada) are our delegates to the Meeting of the Americas (REDELA).

*Julio Espallat*

## INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS

**Trustees' report:**

**International Conventions** — The purpose of the trustees' committee as it relates to International Conventions is to work on plans for each forthcoming International Convention. The objectives of the 2010 International Convention, with its theme "A Vision for You," are: To provide opportunities for a rededication of attendees to the primary purpose of A.A.; to enable attendees to witness the success and growth of A.A. around the world; and to let the world know that A.A. is alive, flourishing and available as a community resource, locally and internationally.

The committee acts and makes recommendations in order to fulfill the broad purposes of the General Service Board, as those purposes relate to the strengthening of the Fellowship and the advancement of its message, through well-planned International Conventions. The detailed work inherent in putting on the Convention is executed by the Convention Coordinator and a professional Convention Consultant.

Based on the recommendation of a site-inspection team, which visited the four cities, the committee recommended to the General Service Board that Detroit, Michigan, be the site of the 2020 Alcoholics Anonymous International Convention.

The committee forwarded a request to the 2009 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums that up to 21 non-A.A. speakers be invited to participate in the 2010 Convention at A.A.'s expense, and the Conference approved the recommendation. The committee agreed to forward discussion of an anonymity-protected photo of the flag ceremony to be

taken at the 2010 International Convention to the 2009 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums. The committee also agreed to forward to the 2009 Conference Committee the idea of a broadcast, similar to that of the 2005 Flag Ceremony, for the 2010 International Convention.

At the committee's recommendation, the General Service Board approved Jim Burke as the local Volunteer Host Committee Chair for the 2010 Convention, and the committee welcomed him at their fall meeting.

We reviewed the General Service Board policy on discounts and subsidies that has been in effect since it was adopted in 1989, and noted that as the G.S.O. staff moves forward with contracting for facilities and services for the 2010 International Convention, this is the policy that they will follow. This policy reads: "Whenever a discount or subsidy is that which would be offered to any other organization of similar size requiring a purchased service or product of similar character and magnitude, for example, convention rates at hotels, it may be accepted. Whenever a discount or subsidy is partly or in total offered because we are Alcoholics Anonymous, it must be declined."

**Regional Forums** — Since the 2008 General Service Conference, Regional Forums have been held in the Eastern Canada, Pacific, and Southeast Regions. Each Forum was viewed as an opportunity to present information about the three corporate boards, G.S.O., and the Grapevine. Equally important was the opportunity to hear sharing of experience, strength and hope, as well as challenges and successes of A.A. members on the front lines of service. The Special "Remote" Forum at Moose Factory, Ontario, February 14-15, marked the end of the Special Forums era. A.A. members from the Cree First Nations community and interested A.A.s from throughout the region made up the gathering. Also, the first Local Forum was held at the International Conference of Young People in Alcoholics Anonymous (I.C.Y.P.A.A.) in Oklahoma City, over the Fourth of July weekend, 2008.

The cost for Regional Forums is borne by the General Service Board, so there is no registration fee. The organizing committee is responsible for the costs of Local Forums and the committee may charge a registration fee to cover these expenses. The General Service Board approved the committee's recommendation for the second Local Forum, to be hosted by the Spanish districts of Area 49, Southeast New York, in September 2009. It was noted that this will be a primarily Spanish-speaking event, and any costs for translation are the responsibility of the Local Forum committee. The trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums is reviewing the implementation of the five-year experimental Local Forums plan annually.

The committee reviewed and accepted the schedule of board and staff participation at 2009 Forums. This year, the first Additional Regional Forum is scheduled to take place in Eastern Canada in Thunder Bay, Ontario, in August 2009. (The second is planned for Rapid City in the West Central Region in the fall of 2010.) The following Regional Forums are scheduled prior to the 2010 General Service Conference:

| 2009            |                |                      |
|-----------------|----------------|----------------------|
| June 26-28      | Northeast      | Somerset, New Jersey |
| August 14-16    | Eastern Canada |                      |
|                 | "Additional"   | Thunder Bay, Ontario |
| September 11-13 | West Central   | St. Cloud, Minnesota |
| October 9-11    | Southwest      | Dallas, Texas        |
| November 13-15  | East Central   | Kalamazoo, Michigan  |

*Herb Goodman, chairperson*

## Staff reports:

**International Convention** — This assignment entails coordinating every aspect of the many processes and plans that go to make up the A.A. International Conventions, held every five years. Working with four committees—Trustees, Conference, G.S.O. Planning, and Host—the International Convention coordinator is responsible for making sure that the Convention comes together as a wonderful opportunity for A.A. members to celebrate gratitude and sobriety. In addition, the coordinator and the alternate International Convention coordinator coordinated A.A. meetings during Al-Anon's International Convention over the 4th of July weekend in Pittsburgh.

Plans proceed apace for the 2010 International Convention, which will be held in the wonderful city of San Antonio July 1—4, 2010. The Convention theme, chosen from suggestions sent in by the Fellowship, is "A Vision for You." Throughout the Convention week, more than 4,000 local A.A.s, coordinated by the San Antonio Volunteer Host Committee, will welcome visitors from all over the globe. The 2010 International Convention will kick-off with a "Party in the Park" and dances in the Henry B. Gonzalez Convention Center and out the back door of the Convention Center in Hemisfair Park.

During the day on Friday and Saturday the Convention Center will be packed with Workshops, Panels, Regional Meetings, Topic Meetings and Marathons. Approximately 750 speakers will participate in over 200 meetings. Friday night, Saturday night and Sunday morning all attendees will come together for the Big Meetings in the Alamodome, conveniently located a couple of blocks from the Convention Center. The traditional flag ceremony of nations in attendance will take place at the Friday night meeting in the Alamodome stadium, and Saturday night oldtimers, chosen from the hat, will share about their years of experience, strength and hope in Alcoholics Anonymous.

Information about the Convention is available on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, and will be updated as we move ahead. Registration and housing will be mailed to groups and trusted servants around the world this summer. Registration will open in September, both on paper and online. Excitement is plentiful as this 75th Anniversary celebratory event draws nearer.

*Rick Walker*

**Regional/Local Forums** — The staff member handling Regional Forums is responsible for coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums and Local Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. members and service workers in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., the Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and General Service Office staffs. Regional Forums are organized by the General Service Board and regularly scheduled at the invitation of a particular region every two years. With the implementation of Additional Regional Forums, there is currently the opportunity for five Regional Forums annually.

The location and agenda for a Regional Forum are decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O. The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes registration forms to groups and service workers throughout the region and, working with the host contact and regional trustee, coordinates Forum details: hotel arrangements, program, hospitality and displays.

In October 2006, the concept of Local Forums (LF) was approved by the General Service Board on a five-year trial basis. The purpose of Local Forums is to bring Forum information to A.A. members in remote, sparsely populated areas, urban neighborhoods or underserved A.A. communities. Any A.A. community or service entity may request a one-and-a-half or two-day Local Forum. Unlike Regional Fo-

rooms, the responsibility for Forum expenses, such as meeting room rental and miscellaneous expenses, are assumed by the Local Forum Committee. At their expense, the General Service Board will send two participants, one from the board and one from the General Service Office or Grapevine office, and will provide literature for display. To stimulate interest in Local Forums, information about them was sent to all delegates and intergroup/central offices last year.

Rick Walker

## LITERATURE

**Trustees' report:** This report offers a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Literature Committee since the 2008 General Service Conference.

- *Composition, Scope and Procedure* — The Committee expanded the scope of the committee to include review of the annual updates and/or revisions to *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* following the annual General Service Conference.
- *"The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs"* — At the August meeting, the trustees' Literature Committee discussed the draft of the revised pamphlet, *"The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs"* prepared by Publications. A subcommittee was appointed to review the draft of the revised pamphlet and report back to the full committee at the November meeting, where the committee recommended that the draft of the revised pamphlet be forwarded to the members of the 2009 Conference Committee on Literature.
- *"A.A. for the Native North American"* — At the August meeting, the trustees' Literature Committee suggested that a reference to Canada's First Nation peoples be included in the introduction of the revised pamphlet. At the November meeting, a subcommittee was appointed to review the draft, taking into consideration the suggestions from the trustees' and 2008 Conference Committee on Literature, and report back to the full committee at the January 2009 meeting. In January, the trustees' Literature Committee recommended that the revised draft of *"A.A. for the Native North American"* be forwarded to the members of the 2009 Conference Committee on Literature.

### Projects Ongoing:

- At the next printing, and in keeping with the 2006 Advisory Action, the word "largely" be added to the second sentence in the first paragraph in the Introduction to the book *Experience, Strength and Hope* on page ix, so that the sentence reads: "In all four editions, the first 164 pages have remained largely unchanged, preserving A.A.'s message just as it was originally recorded by the founding members." **Note:** Since April 2006, there have been no new printings.

### Projects Completed:

- *"The G.S.R."* pamphlet — In keeping with a 2007 Advisory Action, the text "Financial Support: Current experience indicates that many groups provide financial support for their general service representatives to attend service functions." has been added to *"The G.S.R."* pamphlet.

### Projects forwarded to the 2009 Conference Literature Committee:

- Revised draft pamphlet *"A.A. For the Native North American."*
- Revised draft pamphlet *"The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs."*

### Requests discussed and forwarded to the 2009 Conference Literature Committee:

- Request that the pamphlet *"Questions and Answers on Sponsorship"* be reviewed toward eliminating or revising outmoded ethnic, cultural and vocational references.

- Request to develop a new Special Needs recovery pamphlet for newcomers or prospective members.
- Request to add a sentence to the pamphlet *"A Newcomer Asks"* that encourages newcomers to obtain and study the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*.
- Request to change the title of the pamphlet *"44 Questions"* to *"Frequently Asked Questions About A.A."*
- Request to publish a book of stories from members living in remote communities.
- Request to develop a second volume of *Daily Reflections*.
- Request to develop a video on the General Service Representative (G.S.R.).
- Note: Following discussion on the request for a video on the G.S.R., the trustees' Literature Committee suggested that the 2009 Conference Committee on Literature consider updating the video, *"Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine, and the General Service Structure,"* and consider adding one episode on G.S.R., and one episode on D.C.M. to the video.

### Discussion topic forwarded to the 2009 Conference Literature Committee:

- Discuss whether there is a need to develop Conference-approved literature that focuses on the topics of spirituality and agnostics or atheists/nonbelievers in A.A.

**Note:** The committee discussed a request to develop a pamphlet that includes stories from members of A.A. who describe themselves as atheist or agnostics, and a request to explore the creation of a video addressing the spiritual vs. religious nature of A.A. A subcommittee was appointed to review the requests and broader aspects. At the January meeting the trustees' Literature Committee agreed on the subcommittee's recommendation to forward to the 2009 Conference Committee on Literature the discussion topic on whether there is a need to develop A.A. Conference-approved literature that focuses on the topics of spirituality and agnostics or atheists/nonbelievers in A.A.

Dorothy Hurley, chairperson

**Staff report:** As secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees, the Literature coordinator works closely with the editors, writers and illustrators on reviewing all new recovery pamphlets, books and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. Along with the Publications Department, the coordinator follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all existing recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department.

The Literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about A.A. literature. Many of these inquiries are passed along to our Order Entry Department, Customer Service representatives, Publications staff and Archives staff. Contact is also maintained with all current area, district, intergroup/central offices and A.A. group literature chairpersons. There are currently 80 area, 420 district and 300 intergroup/central office/other literature chairpersons listed with G.S.O.

The Literature staff member also gathers sharing for *Box 4-5-9*, published in English, French and Spanish with the following bi-monthly distribution: 70,000 copies in English, 3,000 copies in French and 7,000 copies in Spanish. The staff member works closely with the Publications Department editor and the G.S.O. editorial committee to continue to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O. in *Box 4-5-9*. G.S.O. always welcomes committee sharing on service from the Fellowship, which may be included in articles so that *Box 4-5-9* can be an accurate reflection of both Fellowship and G.S.O. activities.

Eva Sanchez

## LONERS/INTERNATIONALISTS MEETING-BY-MAIL (LIM)

**Staff report:** The Loners/Internationalists Correspondence Service is a valuable means of sharing for about 116 Loners in 58 countries, plus 37 Internationalists, and 114 Homers. Loners are members who are unable to attend A.A. meetings because there are no A.A. groups within a reasonable distance. Internationalists are members working or serving on a seagoing vessel for lengthy periods, and Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to illness or physical incapacity. LIM is a valuable service coordinated by the General Service Office that enables member to stay sober by sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters, tapes and/or e-mail, in addition to reading A.A. literature.

LIM includes 393 Loner Sponsors, who are not "Sponsors" or "Loners" in the traditional sense. Instead, these members share their A.A. group experience and activities with Loners, Homers and Internationalists through correspondence. We also list 40 Port Contacts who are valuable resources when Internationalists are briefly onshore. These members also share experience and hope via correspondence.

Warren Stafford

## NOMINATING

**Trustees' report:** The responsibilities of the trustees' Committee on Nominating grew over time to encompass criteria for all vacancies, whether in the ranks of trustees, or among key service directors and staff members. At each meeting for over 60 years, the committee has worked to fulfill the task outlined for it. In *Twelve Concepts for World Service*, developed in 1962, that task included: "The recommendations of this committee to a large extent will determine the continuous success of our services. Its members will have the primary voice in choosing our future Trustees and non-Trustee workers. Careful deliberation, painstaking investigation and interviewing, refusal to accept casual recommendations, preparation well in advance of lists of suitable candidates—these will need to be the principal attitudes and activities of this committee. All temptation to haste or snap judgment will need to be faithfully and constantly resisted." (Page 49)

Activities of this committee in the past year:

**Follow Up to 2008 General Service Conference:** The committee accepted the November 2008 Final Report of the subcommittee reviewing the 2008 General Service Board Bylaws re: Class B trustee successor terms in the event of an unexpected vacancy in response to an Additional Committee Consideration of the 2008 Conference Committee on Trustees and agreed to forward the report to the 2009 Conference Committee on Trustees.

The committee discussed two 2008 Floor Actions that were "recommitted to committee," took no action, and forwarded an explanation of these committee decisions to the makers of the Floor Actions.

**Selection of General Service Board (GSB) Chairperson:** In keeping with the 2007 General Service Conference Advisory Action, "In accordance with the Bylaws of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., the General Service Board consider all eligible Class A (nonalcoholic) and Class B (alcoholic) trustees when selecting the chairperson of the General Service Board," 105 current and past Class A and Class B trustees were notified of the search for the chairperson of the General Service Board to succeed Leonard M. Blumenthal, L.L.D. when he rotates in May 2009. The notification letter included a reference to the 2007 Conference Advisory Action.

The committee reviewed 12 responses from General Service

## Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 2009<sup>1</sup>

|                                      | Groups            | Members        |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------|----------------|
| United States                        | 55,244            | 1,248,394      |
| Canada                               | <u>4,849</u>      | <u>93,986</u>  |
| Sub-Total                            | 60,093            | 1,342,380      |
| Correctional facilities <sup>2</sup> | 1,585             | 39,964         |
| Internationalists                    | 3                 | 36             |
| Lone Members                         | <u>          </u> | <u>235</u>     |
| Total                                | 61,681            | 1,382,615      |
| Outside U.S. & Canada <sup>3</sup>   | <u>55,092</u>     | <u>702,510</u> |
| Grand Total                          | 116,773           | 2,085,125      |

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups listed with G.S.O., and does not represent and actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in more than 180 countries, including 60 autonomous general service offices in other lands. Annually we attempt to contact those G.S.O.s and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use an earlier year's figure.

Board chairperson applicants and agreed to interview five applicants (three current and past Class A trustees and two past Class B trustees).

In October 2008 the General Service Board approved the committee's recommendation which was forwarded to the board with substantial unanimity, that The Very Rev. Ward B. Ewing, D.D. be elected to serve as chairperson of the General Service Board at the May 2009 annual meeting of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous. It was noted that, as a member of this committee, Ward Ewing absented himself during executive sessions when the General Service Board chairperson search process was discussed.

• **Class A Trustee Election:** The committee reviewed the resumes, curriculum vitae, and other background material of 43 applicants who had made themselves available to serve as Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees. The committee chose five applicants to interview in January 2009.

Following the interviews, the committee unanimously recommended to the General Service Board that Frances L. Brisbane, Ph.D. and Corliss R. Burke be invited to serve as Class A trustees to succeed Herbert I. Goodman and Leonard M. Blumenthal, L.L.D. following the 2009 General Service Conference.

• **Regional and At-Large Trustee Elections:** The committee recommended to the General Service Board, as eligible for election in April 2009, all candidates submitted for East Central and Southeast regional trustees, as well as all candidates submitted for the trustee-at-large/U.S. election.

• **Board Slates:** The committee reviewed and recommended proposed slates of General Service Board members, officers of the board, and A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine directors to the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in May 2009, following presentation at the 2009 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any.

• **Committee's Composition, Scope and Procedures:** The General Service Board approved the following recommendations to revise

the language in the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedures: to update and clarify the committee's Composition and Scope, to clarify the service term for Appointed Committee Members, to clarify information to be communicated in the Class A trustee interview process, to emphasize time commitments in Procedures related to trustee and Appointed Committee Members' service, and to add consistent language related to service time commitments.

- *2009 Conference Report & Charter Committee:* The committee forwarded the following suggested changes to *The A.A. Service Manual* to the 2009 Conference Report & Charter Committee for consideration: revise the description of the term of service of Appointed Committee Members; and, clarify language regarding nominating a regional trustee candidate in the same year when nominating a trustee-at-large candidate.

*Paul Cleary, chairperson*

**Staff report:** This assignment's staff member is responsible to the trustees' Nominating Committee, and to the Conference Committee on Trustees, serving as secretary to these committees as well as to trustees' subcommittees. Since the last Conference, the staff member prepared background, minutes and reports for three quarterly trustees' committee meetings, as well as for eleven conference calls. The staff member worked with the trustees' committee on vacancy announcements and the interview scheduling processes for a search for a chairman of the General Service Board to succeed Leonard M. Blumenthal, L.L.D. and for a search for a Class A trustee to succeed Herbert I. Goodman. The staff member gathered background material for a subcommittee dealing with successor terms for unexpected vacancies on the General Service Board and for a subcommittee responding to the board's inventory suggestions. The staff member also coordinated the transcription and review of resumes for 77 trustee candidates who made their names available to participate in this year's Conference elections procedures.

The staff member also serves as a resource for Special Needs/Accessibilities Committees within the Fellowship, sending out welcome letters, Special Needs Kits and shared experience to area, district and group committee chairs in addition to responding to Special Needs correspondence and inquiries. Special Needs Kits include twelve *Box 4-5-9* articles sharing Special Needs Twelfth Step experience, as well as lists of suggested activities for Special Needs Accessibilities Committees and Cooperation With the Elder Community (CEC) Committees. This assignment acknowledges that there are no "special" A.A. members but that there are A.A. members with special needs.

In October 2008, Special Needs' collected sharing was published for the first time in a Special Needs/Accessibilities Workbook to help support the service of a growing number of area, district and group Special Needs Committees. This Workbook (downloadable) was also added to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site in the new Special Needs Service section. Another service opportunity—an 18-page booklet "Collected Sharing—Cooperation With the Elder Community Committees" was added to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site in January of this year.

*Valerie O'Neill*

## PUBLIC INFORMATION

**Trustees' report:** The trustees' Committee on Public Information is charged with the responsibility of helping the membership carry the A.A. message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suf-

fers. We do this by recommending and coordinating activities which include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing television and radio public service announcements (P.S.A.s); preparing and posting press releases on AA.org; coordinating health fairs and other community and school exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the triennial A.A. Membership Survey; and carrying A.A.'s message through electronic as well as print media. Projects over the past year have included:

*Television P.S.A.s* — The A.A. Conference-approved 2008 TV P.S.A., "I Thought," was finalized and is available for purchase. The committee continues to oversee the centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation phases of the project. A subcommittee was formed to review all current A.A. TV P.S.A.s for relevance and usefulness and to consider if there is a need for a new A.A. TV P.S.A.

*Radio P.S.A.s* — The committee updated and forwarded the revised text of Combination Radio P.S.A.s on CD to the 2009 Conference P.I. Committee.

*Poster for Young People* — The committee developed a wall poster for young people with information about Alcoholics Anonymous. A draft was forwarded to the 2009 Conference P.I. Committee.

*"A Message to Teenagers"* — The committee oversaw the updating of text and graphics for the pamphlet "A Message to Teenagers...", utilizing the text and graphics of the current "Too Young?" pamphlet. A draft was forwarded to the 2009 Conference P.I. Committee.

*Communications with the Media* — The committee reviewed the text and format of the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media and suggested that this year's letter be sent by e-mail and snail mail, and that requests for further information and feedback be evaluated.

*Utilizing New Media Platforms* — The committee discussed and requested placement of A.A. television P.S.A.s on YouTube and will continue to explore possible placement of P.S.A.s on other social networking Web sites.

*Cooperation with taping companies* — The committee asked the staff secretary to send a memo to all known taping companies that distribute or sell A.A. speaker talks—whether by catalog, onsite at conventions, or on the Internet—asking for cooperation main-





taining A.A. members' anonymity at the public level.

**Membership Survey** — The results of the Alcoholics Anonymous 2007 Membership Survey were placed into pamphlet and tabletop display formats.

**Young People's Videos** — The committee requested and received video submissions from young people in the Fellowship. The committee spent considerable time discussing the project guidelines and reviewing submissions, and forwarded a draft video to the 2009 Conference Public Information Committee.

**Oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site** — The committee reviewed quarterly reports from the A.A.W.S. Board regarding changes to aa.org, updates on Web site activity, a summary of requests from the Fellowship regarding the Web site, and a summary of actions taken by the A.A.W.S. Board in response to those requests. An annual report by the A.A.W.S. Board was forwarded to the 2009 Conference Public Information Committee.

**Film projects** — In the past, the committee has participated in film projects about A.A., other than TV P.S.A.s, but no current film projects are slated at this time.

The committee remains committed to do all they can to assist the membership in their service of carrying the message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers, and welcomes suggestions from delegate areas as to what more can be done.

*Ray Massey, chairperson*

**Staff report:** This assignment is charged with assisting the A.A. members who carry our message to the suffering alcoholic through the public—schools, health fairs, libraries, and all forms of the media. Below are some of the ways that this task is carried out:

- Communicate with over 950 P.I. committee chairpersons at the area, district and intergroup/central office or group level to provide them with Workbooks, Guidelines, and current shared information on Public Information activity.
- Provide literature to supplement the efforts of local Public Information committees which are serving as a resource about Alcoholics Anonymous at local health and community fairs.
- Provide P.I. committees with information regarding the production and distribution of television and radio Public Service Announcements (P.S.A.s), in order to enhance their efforts on the local level, and refer all media requests for P.S.A.s to local committees.
- Respond to all inquiries that come to the office from the media, providing them with accurate information about Alcoholics Anonymous.
- Read and process a number of newspaper, magazine and Internet feature stories that mention Alcoholics Anonymous, and receive information from members regarding anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio, films, television and the Internet.
- Pass along instances of anonymity breaks in the media to the delegate in the area in which the break occurred, and provide them with an opportunity to contact the member and share experience regarding our Eleventh Tradition.
- Send out the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media. In March 2009 it was e-mailed and mailed to over 9,000 media outlets in the U.S. and Canada. This included daily and weekly newspapers, wire services, radio stations, and TV networks, stations and cable services.



- Coordinate the triennial A.A. Membership Survey. The results of triennial surveys are published in pamphlet form and as a table display for visual information about Alcoholics Anonymous at public events.

*Irene Kontje*

## STAFF COORDINATOR

**Staff report:** Eleven A.A. members comprise the "G.S.O. Staff" with each person responsible for a functional assignment in addition to responding to requests from a specific region in Canada and the U.S., or from other countries. In 2008, the staff received 38,435 such requests by mail, e-mail and fax, plus many phone calls daily. The staff coordinator helps to assure that letters are answered when staff members are involved in large projects or away from the office to attend A.A. events, or at times of illness or vacation. All mail, e-mail, faxes, etc. are responded to within ten business days.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff trips to area assemblies, conventions, Regional Forums, and other large A.A. events, making sure that the office is adequately covered at all times. Weekly staff meetings provide a forum for sharing ideas on how to improve services to A.A. groups and members or how to provide the most complete answers to Fellowship inquiries. The staff coordinator chairs these weekly meetings.

In 2008, G.S.O. welcomed a total of 1,291 individual visitors, in addition to English and Spanish-speaking groups ranging in size from 10 to 50. Each visitor had an opportunity to see and hear "how G.S.O. works" during a tour of both G.S.O. and the Grapevine offices. Often visiting members and guests attend the "open" A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays. This is an opportunity for the G.S.O. staff to welcome A.A. members from all over the world or from around the corner.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance material, preparing the minutes of board meetings and gathering information on board activities that appears in the *Quarterly Report*. The staff coordinator has the privilege of serving as a director on A.A. World Services, Inc. in accordance with Concept IV, and also serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. The staff coordinator is also secretary to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

*Adriene Brown*



# Area Service Highlights—Panel 59 Delegates

(Only first-term delegates give Area Highlights)

**Alabama/Northwest Florida:** Area 1 includes all of Alabama and the panhandle of NW Florida. There are 430 active groups within 24 districts, one is a linguistic district, serving 10 Spanish groups located across the two states. Assemblies are held quarterly in Montgomery, for two days. Usually, 350+ members participate, of whom 135 are G.S.R.s. We also have translation equipment and a translator provided by the linguistic district. Our second quarterly is a pre-Conference assembly to discuss agenda items where all members are encouraged to attend. We have found this to be a useful tool for our delegate. The CPC Committee hosts a booth at the annual professional health fair in North Alabama, and other committees travel to districts when requested. Our annual convention is usually held in September. However, this year Area 1 will host the S.E. Conference in conjunction with our annual Convention August 13-16 in Mobile. This past year we experienced the loss of Jim Wright, Panel 25, and Warren Kelly, Panel 27. Both will be missed. I thank our members in Area 1 for the honor and privilege to serve as their Panel 59 delegate.—*Lisa Wilson*

**Arkansas:** Area 4 has 12 districts with 248 registered groups. We hold four two-day assemblies each year in a central location. Our archives committee continues to trace A.A.'s origins in our area and we are proud of their restoration work. Our treatment committee has a Bridging the Gap program, and also contributes ideas towards how we can better adapt our A.A. service literature to reach the still-suffering alcoholic in outpatient treatment programs. The Old Granddad State Convention Committee (the oldest A.A. convention west of the Mississippi) is working diligently to prepare for their third year back in Hot Springs. The corrections committee is busy carrying meetings "behind the walls." Grapevine encourages new subscriptions. Our Web site committee has developed an efficient, user friendly, service-oriented Web-site. C.P.C. and P.I. committees cooperate frequently as they inform our professional friends and the public about A.A. Our past delegates are present and active. Serving as the area's trusted servant to the Conference is truly a humbling experience.—*J.G. Regnier*

**British Columbia/Yukon:** Area 79 is approximately 900,000 square miles. Washington State plays a role in our geographic composition, which makes us an international area. From Vancouver to Prince Rupert is approximately 500 miles. Actual road travel comes in at twice this length due to detours around vast mountains ranges, rivers and lakes. This extends the trip to approximately 20 hrs. and 950 miles. We have 47 districts and 720 groups, many are only serviceable by ferry, small plane, boat or ski-doo. Many of our members face the challenges of distance, terrain and sparse population, so a standing committee on Remote Communities was struck four years ago to assess the needs and keep a dialogue open into the remote corners of our vast area. We have two quarterlies and two assemblies annually and have an average of 90% participation of all districts, this continues to climb with the aide of our district travel subsidies offered by the area to help off-set costs of districts in need. Area 79 participates and hosts Forums and Western Regional A.A. Service Assemblies.—*Marty Watters*

**Central California (Central):** Area 93 has 27 districts—20 English-speaking, seven Spanish-speaking. We hold five assemblies, five committee meetings and one pre-Conference workshop each year. On the second year we add an assembly to elect our next panel of officers. We granted our Accessibility commit-

tee (aka Special Needs) initial funding to produce "Pilot Project," a video of stories from the Big Book in American Sign Language. During 2008, we had representation in every district for New Parolee Orientation. While I believe the Conference is important to groups in our area, it is my perception that local activities provide a more tangible, "hands on" interest by groups who participate and stay informed. Recent round table discussions addressed "Working with Wet Drunks" and "Gathering Input for the Trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee." We have steady participation by our past delegates. In the neighborhood of 900 groups, our area is quite diverse. Across cultural lines and many languages, we seek to be of service wherever possible.—*Jeff Johnson*

**California (Northern Coastal):** Area 6 encompasses more than 1,800 groups, around 56,000 members, and spans from south of Monterey north to the Oregon border. We hold four assemblies each year, and our area committee meets every month. Between our eight area officers, we visit each of our 18 geographic and four linguistic districts every month. Some of our less-populated districts sometimes have trouble maintaining enthusiasm for general service. Our newest standing committee, Interpretation and Translation, or I&T, has done a fantastic job of procuring the infrastructure we need to truly participate with our Spanish-speaking members. We have simultaneous interpretation at each of our assemblies and area committee meetings. The work that the I&T committee did also led to some interesting discussions about budgets and the spending authority of our committees. The discussion prompted our Finance Committee to document some new recommendations for our budget process. It is truly an honor to be allowed to serve such a vibrant, diverse and committed area.—*David Noll*

**California (Southern):** Area 5 covers about 400 square miles. As a result of our membership's vast array of cultures and languages, communication is as much our challenge as anywhere else. Over one-fifth of participation in our area is conveyed in



Spanish. Paid interpreters are utilized for simultaneous interpretation at our nine annual primary meetings, quarterly assemblies, quarterly business meetings, and the Spanish Forum. On any given night one may choose between at least three different meetings within 20 minutes from just about wherever you are. Our Panel 59 is dedicated to raising the consciousness of the groups to the issues of A.A. as a whole, as serviced through the General Service Conference. Our recent participation in the request for input from the trustees' Finance Committee regarding voluntary self-support of G.S.O. has proven that once so tasked, we rise to the occasion. We make time at our group meetings to discuss the issues, carry it through our service structure, and fully participate in the service of He who presides over us all, doing what we know best—one alcoholic carrying the message to another.—*Mike Peery*

**Colorado:** Area 10 is a sunny, dry rectangle of mountains and plains. We are 751 groups, meeting in 34 districts, with 46 current D.C.M.s. We have changed, between 2000 and now, growing steadily overall at about 2% a year; during this time-frame our explosive growth is around 300% for our Spanish-speaking groups. Assemblies meet three times per year. The percentage of involved G.S.R.s is low, with a few perennial "dark" districts. The area is committed to revitalizing our service structure, working with D.C.M.s to involve them more fully. We always have solid attendance from our 10 past delegates and standing committees. High fuel costs and the need to minimize travel difficulties in the winter have spurred a greater acceptance of new communications technologies. Some districts are holding on-line meetings and others are making tele-conferencing phone calls to stay connected, especially during the difficult travel months. We know that this e-communication style augments but does not replace our need for the understanding that comes from one alcoholic talking with another. Yet to come, in 2010—The International Conference is in our SW Region, and the Regional Service Assembly will be held in Area 10—we are privileged to be firmly planted in Alcoholics Anonymous!—*Judy Lavezzi*

**Connecticut:** Area 11 celebrated its 50th Area State Convention with a record turnout, and we will be celebrating our 35th Area Roundup, which is our yearly Area Service event. Our area also hosted NECYPAA, New England Conference of Young People in A.A., in Waterbury, which had a refreshing record turnout of young people, with over a thousand people for the weekend. Our P.I. committee started a new era of passing the message to our younger crowd in schools; it is called the Sobriety Squad and it is getting great reviews with all the younger people involved. With a past five-year down-turn in contributions, our whole area worked hard in becoming a 501c3, State Tax exempt. We changed over to Quick Book Filing and on line banking. With the help of the groups, district and area, we had contributions up 39% with 14% new groups participating this past year. We reached our prudent reserve for the first time, and have been able to lower our yearly budget. We also voted in a new area officer positions of alternate treasurer to help with the duties.—*Ken Bird*

**District of Columbia:** Area 13 encompasses groups in Washington, D.C., Prince George's and Montgomery counties in Maryland, along with three linguistic, nongeographic districts in Washington, D.C., Maryland and Northern Virginia. Beginning with the first General Service Conference in 1951, we have grown from six groups with a membership of 625, to 456 registered groups with over 14,000 members. Our area assembly meets three times a year and we have an annual mini-Conference, which gives the delegate the conscience of the area.

G.S.R.s hold group conscience meetings and bring the conscience to the mini-Conference. An annual Gratitude Breakfast is hosted in November, and the Seventh Tradition contribution is sent to G.S.O. We have eleven living past delegates who often serve as advisors to our committee chairs. In November 2008, our three linguistic districts held a Spanish Forum. Area 13 continues to grow; and at times experiences the pains of growing, but we will always remain humbly committed to carrying the message of Alcoholics Anonymous.—*Elaine Gaisey*

**Florida (North):** Area 14 has over 800 active registered groups, in 29 districts and an area-wide Spanish-linguistic district. Six of our districts have divided into local districts, A and B, with a D.C.M. from each. Our assembly meets four times a year. We have four administrative committees: Finance, Growth, Site and Agenda, and Web Site. At our April Assembly all committees and workshops focus on the upcoming Conference agenda items. Then the delegate is informed of their findings at the Saturday night meeting and input from the entire assembly is encouraged. As a result, our delegate is well-informed of the group conscience of the area. We have an Internet Web site where information about upcoming assemblies and district events may be accessed. This past year we made our Web site Workshop a full administrative committee with assigned D.C.M.s and a past delegate as members. We are now in a trial period of a password-protected site where minutes and other documents can be viewed with security and anonymity protections.—*Chet Parker*

**Florida (South):** Area 15 extends from just south of Orlando, across the middle of the state to north of Tampa, and down to Key West. To our southeast are the Bahama Islands and the U.S. & British Virgin Islands. We have 17 districts, two are Spanish-linguistic districts, 19 intergroups or central offices, serving 39,110 members, and 1,845 registered groups. D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s meet at quarterly weekend, and attendance varies from 500–700. The assemblies are interpreted in Spanish. ASL interpretation is provided when requested. We are blessed with the financial generosity of our groups and members, which allows us to send an annual contribution to G.S.O. The Florida State Convention rotates between the North and South Florida Areas. The 52nd Florida State Convention, in Ft. Lauderdale last summer, was attended by 3,888. We are looking forward to North Florida hosting the 53rd in Jacksonville this summer. A.A. is alive, well and enthusiastically represented in South Florida. I am blessed and privileged to serve.—*Ken Clark*

**Hawaii:** Covering all the Hawaiian Islands, Area 17 includes 317 groups in 14 districts. We have 11 standing committees, the newest of which is our Web site Committee. Last year a motion passed to assign new G.S.R.s to assist with a standing committee at our Orientation Assembly. We implemented this in January, and the results have been positive. We hold four week-end-long assemblies in even years and three in odd years. The geographic nature of our state makes our gatherings logistically challenging. To facilitate participation and unity, each assembly and committee meeting takes place in a different district, often on a different island. Airfare cost is a subject that we repeatedly have had loving discussion about over the years, but the group conscience of the Hawaii area concludes again and again that fostering unity outweighs the cost of travel. Love for A.A., enthusiasm for service and, above all, supporting our Primary Purpose always remains our goal.—*Elizabeth Martin*

**Illinois (Chicago):** On September 20, 1939, Earl T. held Chicago's first group meeting in his apartment in Evanston; there were

eight attendees present. From these humble beginnings we now have an estimated 80,000 members attending 2,500 meetings a week. In 1941, Chicago opened its first full-time office. Our current office manager, Laura G., is the first Hispanic to hold this position. On September 20, 2008 we held our 69th All Chicago Open, where we were fully self-supporting by our Seventh Tradition contributions. This allowed Area 19 to ensure that our yearly budget be met. It is our hope to see our area fully self-supporting in the future. With our new rotation of officers, D.C.M.s and committee chairpersons, the younger population of our Fellowship has stepped up to fill critical roles in our service structure. Of our six elected officers, four are below the age of 40—one of which is below the age of 30. We have three D.C.M.s and one committee chairperson also below the age of 30.  
—*Ruben Gonzalez*

**Illinois (Southern):** Area 21 is composed of the southern two-thirds of Illinois. Northern Illinois, Area 20, is our neighbor to the north. There are 416 active groups in 17 districts; two districts are dark and a challenge. We have four quarterly assemblies, each standing committee has a sharing session and presents a report during the business meeting. There is continuing cooperation with Areas 19 and 20 to reach the large corrections population in southern Illinois during a time of a welcoming Illinois Dept. of Corrections administration. Our last annual Corrections Conference was held in Bloomington, with Areas 19 and 20 participating. We have an annual spring service conference, with the last held in Champaign. We hosted the 36th East Central Region Conference of Delegates Past and Present in Springfield, this past February. In August we will host the 29th East Central Regional Conference in conjunction with the 36th Illinois State Conference in Peoria.—*Dean Strassner*

**Indiana (Northern):** Area 22 has 48 districts, 540 registered groups, and 10 standing committees. We hold four assemblies a year, and the May weekend assembly is dedicated to the delegate report, along with service workshops, presentations and speakers. We have two D.C.M. conferences a year; the March conference focus is on the Conference agenda items. We also reach out to our dark districts by taking the area to them in Informational Forums. We have held four since this has been instituted, with old districts becoming active again. Our Web site has been completed, [www.area22indiana.org](http://www.area22indiana.org), with a wide range of information pertaining to Area 22 service events. Each D.C.M. has access to the site, and to list their groups' time and location. In March 2009 we hosted the 56th Indiana State Convention, our theme, "Spiritual Progress, Enjoy the Journey." Area 22 is continuing to move forward to carry the message. Thank you Northern Indiana for the opportunity to serve. Take care and God bless.—*Barbara Simington*

**Iowa:** Area 24 has about 620 groups that make up 22 districts. All of our service committees are active. Our corrections committee hosts a biannual workshop, the last two of which have been held "inside" the walls of the Mt. Pleasant Correctional Facility, a medium security prison. We have active groups in cities like Des Moines (pop. 197, 000) and towns like Littleport (pop. 25). Our membership is made up of doctors and lawyers as well as welders, waiters and of course, farmers. In January we welcomed our 22nd district, a linguistic district, representing seven Spanish-speaking groups from across Iowa, and a motion was made to purchase small radio-like transmitters and receivers to aid in translation. It was described that without the equipment, District 22's D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s would sit in a corner in the back of our assemblies with their translator,

being physically separated from us. The vote was unanimous, and the equipment will be purchased. That is a "highlight." To see that committee come together to literally make it possible for the Third Tradition to come alive, was both humbling and empowering. Rest assured A.A. is alive and well in Iowa.—*Rick Carter*

**Louisiana:** Area 27 has 365 groups in 30 districts. And we don't stop meeting even for hurricanes or Mardi Gras. There are three central offices and two multi-district service committees. Our area assembly continually evolves to meet the realities of service and the economy. One area of note is that several dark and limping districts are coming back to life with area support. These revivals are the result of home-grown reconstitution efforts led by the A.A.s who live there. One district was slowly being absorbed by the districts around it because it had been dormant for so long. One D.C.M. halted the decay and brought the groups back into action within their own geographical area. Based on our biennial area-assembly inventories, we are seeing an increase in district and group inventories as they try to find better ways to serve and operate. Unity and Service are necessary and organic to becoming truly recovered alcoholics and A.A.s in Louisiana are taking these paths because they can see that deeper sobriety lies along them.—*Bob Williams*

**Massachusetts (Eastern):** Area 30 has over 2,200 meetings spread over 26 geographical districts and two nongeographical Spanish districts. We hold five assemblies yearly, hosted by different districts. Our pre-Conference assembly is where the delegate listens, and the post-Conference assembly, is where delegate reports back on the Conference. We have a Budget Assembly, which we call "The Kickoff Assembly" so we don't scare off any new G.S.R.s. In odd numbered years we have two workshop assemblies that deal with issues affecting the Fellowship and in even numbered years an election assembly. The area committee meets every month, where the seven committees and six standing committees report to the area D.C.M.s and officers. Liaisons from Boston Central Service and the five intergroups in Area 30, and liaisons from young people in A.A. committees report to the area on their activities. With our friends from Area 31, Western Massachusetts, we will be hosting the 46th Annual Massachusetts State Convention this November. It will be a weekend of meetings and fellowship, with an alcathon, an oldtimers meeting, a Dinner and many other activities. Thank you for allowing me to be of service.—*John Howland*

**Michigan (Central):** Area 32 has 14 districts covering the eastern half of the Lower Peninsula of Michigan, except for the Metro-Detroit area and Monroe County in the southeast. We have nearly 675 registered groups and attendance at area assemblies averages between 75 to 125 members. In February we began to hold assemblies every other month instead of monthly. We currently carry a prudent reserve for approximately six months expenses. We meet quarterly with the other two delegate areas of Michigan, 33 and 34, to share ideas and to coordinate activities between the areas. We also hosted the 56th Michigan State Convention last August, which was attended by more than 500. Our convention rotates between the three areas. In March we host the State Mock Conference to prepare our three Michigan delegates for the General Service Conference. A.A.s from the three areas get together to discuss the Conference agenda items. It is a great honor and privilege to have been selected to serve Area 32 and the Fellowship as a delegate to the 59th General Service Conference.—*Mike Kimling*

**Michigan (Southeast):** Area 33 encompasses five counties of Southeastern Michigan and is one of three delegate areas within the state. We have 24 geographic districts, plus one Spanish-language district, 867 registered groups and over 20,000 members. In September then is a Service Fair. Every 3rd year we alternate with Areas 32 and 34 by hosting the Michigan State Convention. Treatment Facilities Committee supports 17 facilities; Corrections has distributed over \$10,000 worth of Conference-approved literature and Grapevines to those incarcerated, thanks to generous proceeds from Group "Jail Pails" and the March Round-Up "Big-Book Jail Sales." "The C.P.C., P.I., Treatment, Corrections, Grapevine and Special Needs Committees held a successful gathering of over 65 professionals to share how A.A. can best assist them. Area 33 is excited to serve the International Convention to be held in Detroit, July 2020. As we move forward in God's grace, we will hopefully attract those who still suffer from alcoholism into recovery, and guide new and old members into service. It is an honor and a privilege to serve as Area 33's delegate. Thank you for allowing me to serve this wonderful Fellowship.—*Derek Daniel*

**Minnesota (Southern):** Area 36 has 27 districts serving approximately 1,200 registered groups. One district is Spanish-speaking. Every January we hold our Recovery, Unity and Service Conference using the theme and presentation topics from that year's General Service Conference. We hold three full-day assemblies, four area committee meetings, a delegate's workshop and a trusted leadership training sponsored by the districts. During the delegate's workshop, the committees meet to discuss the Conference agenda items. In alternate years we hold an area inventory. We have a Temporary Contact Program connecting people coming out of treatment and correctional facilities with A.A. members. Our Remote Communities Committee has been working with the Hmong community in St. Paul and some of our districts have taken on projects working with the elderly communities. I'm proud to be a representative of such an area and eternally grateful for the trust and love they've shown to this alcoholic.—*Scott Ahlgren*

**Missouri (Eastern):** Area 38 has 10,000 members, in 500 registered groups, in 23 districts. That comes to about 22 groups per district, and about 20 members per group. At the present time one of our 23 districts is silent, and one or two others are rarely represented at assemblies. Most district meetings have about 20 regular attendees, and one district averages more than 40. About half of our districts are in the St. Louis metropolitan area, and the other half are in small towns or rural settings. We recently voted to phase out our area office's part-time paid worker, hoping that computers and the Internet will enable our area officers to absorb the workload. In 2008, in St. Louis, we were privileged to host the Southwest Regional Service Assembly, where 300 members from Eastern Missouri met and shared with 300 members from the other ten areas of the Southwest Region. We were pleased that, at our January assembly this year, nearly all of the 180 attendees had been to that assembly.—*Jim Foley*

**Missouri (Western):** Area 39 serves approximately 225 groups in 16 districts, over 34,484 square miles. We have four two-day weekend area assemblies in Sedalia. Our 11 standing committees give reports, as do our G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, and area officers. Our area and district committees are active in providing assistance at various A.A. events. Ten past delegates are available to help out. WAMO Web site had 150,000 hits in 2008 with 15 of 16 districts having Web sites up and running. Our Treatment and Corrections Committees host a rotating Institutions Weekend

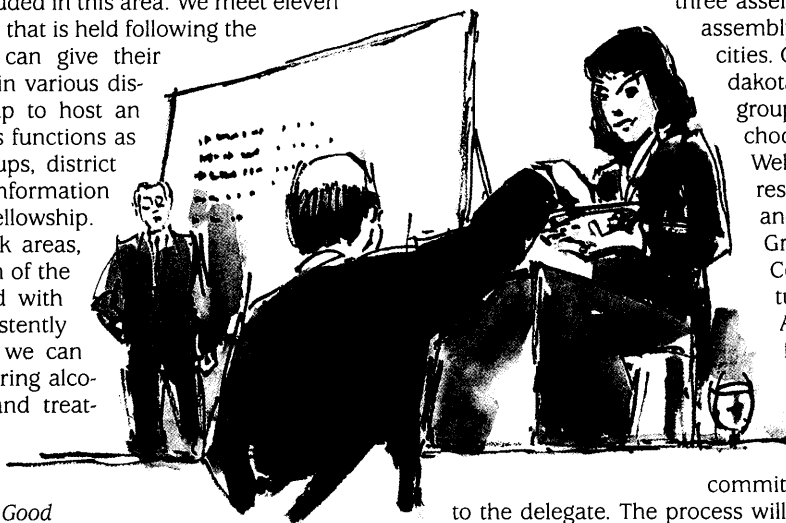
every May involving professionals and A.A.s. Funding is used to purchase A.A. literature. The 2009 Worldwide Bridge the Gap Convention will be held in September. We have two central offices in Kansas City and Springfield. Each July, Western Missouri and Eastern Missouri (Area 38) co-host the State Convention. Western Missouri also has an Area Convention (Colors of Fall) in Branson at the end of October. The hands and hearts of Area 39 continue to reach out to the still-suffering alcoholic, both out there and in here, with hope, love, enthusiasm, and gratitude in action.—*Quinn Grose*

**Montana:** Area 40 covers most of the state of Montana with 14 districts and 268 registered groups. The Hot Springs Book Study and the Plentywood Group are over 800 highway miles apart. The size of the districts varies from District 23 with three groups to District 81 with 40 groups. We hold two 1½ day assemblies, in April and September. We discuss the G.S.C. agenda items at the spring assembly and conduct area business in the fall. Several districts work together to conduct preassembly events to discuss the Conference agenda prior to the spring assembly. In 2007, we implemented a statewide toll-free hotline. Callers can find a meeting or speak to another alcoholic. Calls are received by a professional organization that asks the caller his location. This question then tags the call to a district and the district is then billed for the call. We have accomplished much by working together. In unity, we can do what alone we cannot. Thank you, Area 40, for allowing me to serve.—*Carole Boerner*

**Nevada:** Area 42 includes Nevada and the Eastern Sierra Mountains of California. We have 24 districts, two of which are Spanish-speaking, and 496 registered groups. In the mid-1970s the members of Area 42 voted to create two subcommittees, one in the Northern portion of the area called NAGSC (Northern Area General Service Committee), and one in the south called SAGSC (Southern Area General Service Committee). We meet twice a year as an area and hold a Friday through Sunday assembly. The Northern and Southern Area, meet separately and hold their assemblies four times per year. The latest in area business: should we rotate the location of the assembly? Does the area wish to have past delegates hold a service position(s)? Are we effectively presenting the Conference agenda items to the groups and ably facilitating the emergence of the area conscience? As we ask one another for help, as we willingly help one another to fulfill the responsibilities of our positions, as we trust more deeply in the process, we continue to grow in effectiveness as an area.—*Jason Carter*

**New Jersey (Northern):** Area 44 has 42 districts serving approximately 1,280 groups. The groups are represented by 38 D.C.M.s, with four of our districts being clustered. Districts are grouped into six sections, each with a leader. We have two active Spanish-speaking districts and a permanent committee on Translation. Five of our seven standing committees, and two special committees, are jointly chaired in cooperation with Northern New Jersey Intergroup. We currently have two ad hoc committees, one for joint office space for Area 44 and Intergroup, and the second for hosting a hospitality suite at the International Convention in 2010. We hold six area committee meetings a year, three assemblies and one mini-Conference. We conduct a year-end inventory at our annual three-day Work Weekend. Area highlights include our Mid-Winter Luncheon in February, our annual Convention in September, and committee workshops held throughout the year. We are excited about hosting NERF, 2009. I am humbled to be an active participant and trusted servant of the area and A.A. as a whole.—*Cathie Feenie*

**New York (Central):** Area 47 has over 1,000 groups and approximately 900 are registered. We elect our delegate on the odd year, and the elections are conducted by the past delegates. It is a large area serving cities such as Syracuse, Binghamton, (which borders Pennsylvania), Batavia, Rochester, and Oswego. There are many small towns also included in this area. We meet eleven times a year, with a convention that is held following the Conference, so the delegate can give their report. Area assemblies meet in various districts. Any D.C.M. can sign up to host an assembly. The delegate attends functions as requested by groups, intergroups, district or any A.A. function to share information and knowledge of the A.A. Fellowship. At present we have some dark areas, and are looking to inform them of the advantage of being connected with the whole area. We are consistently looking to improve the ways we can carry the message to the suffering alcoholic inside the corrections and treatment facilities, and in general to the newcomer. This is the primary purpose of Alcoholics Anonymous.—*Vada Good*



**North Dakota:** Area 52 has 12 districts, approximately 130 registered groups and 3,200 members. The area assembly consists of all the G.S.R.s and the area committee, which is made up of the 12 D.C.M.s, delegate, area chair, secretary, treasurer, archivist, institutions chair and PI/CPC chair. We hold three assemblies each year. The June assembly is held in the smaller cities. Our area Web site ([aanorthdakota.org](http://aanorthdakota.org)) lists only registered groups, unless a specific group chooses not to be listed. The Web site also includes Area 52 resources, upcoming events, and links to G.S.O and the Grapevine. The PI/CPC Committee set up a literature booth at the Native American Pow-Wow for the first time in 2008. In March 2009, we will start a new pre-Conference process where the agenda items will be discussed in

committees and suggestions given to the delegate. The process will allow the whole assembly to become more involved and informed of the agenda items. Districts continue to carry the message to inmates at correctional centers and county jails. It is an honor and privilege to serve as Area 52's delegate.—*Lorna O'Connor*

**Nova Scotia Newfoundland/Labrador:** Area 82 is located on the east coast of Canada. We have 16 districts, and roughly 226 groups with about 3,200 members. We have two service weekends held in the spring, and one assembly yearly that is alternated between four cities, two in each province. We are a very large area, which creates a lot of challenges, such as geography and language and the ability to travel throughout the area. Newfoundland and Labrador span 222,500 sq. miles with roughly 550,000 people. Some areas are not accessible during the winter and summer months. Nova Scotia spans 22,000 sq. miles and has roughly 940,000 residents. We have a vast range of languages throughout the area, including English, French, Innu, Inuit and their different dialects, along with Mi'kmag of the First Nations communities. We have active committees, including a Remote Communities targeting the Labrador area, which involves providing literature and conference calls to a few of the small areas. We are looking at getting some of the A.A. literature translated into the Innu and Inuit languages. We have two active intergroup offices in Halifax, and St. John's. In 2008, Area 82 had the privilege of hosting the Eastern Regional Forum in Truro, Nova Scotia. It is a great privilege and honor for me to be here. Thank you all for my sobriety and for the chance to be here and to serve you all.—*Billy Corbett*

**Ohio (Central Southeastern):** Area 53 is the largest geographic area in Ohio, consisting of 38 counties, 42 districts, five groups, and over 1,060 registered groups. We participate in quarterly area assemblies. We have been dissecting our area inventory, raising awareness of our plans for improvement. Our committees are active in reaching out to the community. The Group Services Committee has developed a G.S.R. School that informs our Fellowship and is revitalizing dark districts. Our mini-Conference weekend is instrumental in formulating and defining the area's group conscience for the delegate. This year we are privileged to host the Ohio State Convention, which provides the

**New York (Southeast):** Area 49, SENY, is the twelve counties in the bottom corner of New York State, 240 miles from Montauk to Middletown and a little under 100 miles from Brewster to the south shore of Staten Island. During my drinking I thought I had nothing in common with anyone who lived outside the city. Then I began to do general service, driving all those miles to various area events. I discovered quite a mix of communities and people who spread the message of recovery to those with special needs, to people seeking treatment or confined to institutions, to doctors and professionals. I found a vibrant group of Spanish-speaking members in our Hispanic districts, the energetic young people of NYCYPAA, and all the volunteers who keep our many intergroups and central offices open. Much of A.A. history has been lived here, from Clinton Street in Brooklyn to 24th Street in Manhattan to Stepping Stones in Westchester. And we're home to the General Service Office, A.A.W.S. and The A.A. Grapevine. The A.A. message is carried through our counties and districts to the 1,356 groups scattered throughout the SENY Area and, in turn, whose message we carry right back, that message from our home groups, where A.A. truly lives.—*Richard Sime*

**North Carolina:** Area 51 has 36 geographical and two Spanish linguistic districts. We have 918 English-speaking, 34 Spanish-speaking, and 58 Corrections groups. We have great fun in service and fellowship at our annual Convention in July and Freedom from Bondage Corrections Conference in March. The area committee meets quarterly. We have active C.P.C./P.I., corrections, and treatment coordinators. One of our current challenges is identifying methods of handling translations to support access to service work. This year we are launching Pre-Conference gatherings in the eastern, Piedmont, and western parts of the state in the spring to discuss upcoming Conference items, as a method to inspire and inform. I am awed and honored to be participating in this 59th General Service Conference, to have the opportunity to turn my deep love for A.A. and my desperation for its endurance into action. We invite any and all of you to come visit us in Area 51. We alcoholic aliens enjoy dancing in the Sunlight of the Spirit as we trudge the road of happy destiny.—*Deborah Attix*

opportunity to foster cooperation among the four Ohio areas. We are engaging as many groups, districts, ages and interests as possible. One of our area's initiatives is to extend and widen the path of communication between all our members and increase awareness in the satisfaction found in active service work. I am grateful to have the opportunity to represent Area 53 and honored to be a part of this 59th Conference.—*Jean Smythe*

**Ohio (Northeast):** Area 54 is located in Northeast Ohio, the birthplace of Alcoholics Anonymous. The area has over 1,500 groups, 63 districts, and approximately 20,000 A.A. members served by eight central offices and intergroups. We hold four assemblies and four area committee meetings each year. We have an Open House Picnic in the summer and a Gratitude Sunday Dinner each November. Since 1975 we have held a mini-Conference just prior to the Conference, which allows each attendee to personally experience the committee system and a voting conference. The Founders' Day Celebration is held each June in Akron. If you visit many of the groups in Northeast Ohio you will find a strong emphasis on the use of the "Four Absolutes." They are deeply rooted in sponsorship and can be found on many podiums along with our A.A. slogans. Area 54 has been blessed with trusted servants whose dedication helps carry the message to those who still stumble in the darkness. It is an honor and a pleasure to represent Northeast Ohio as its Panel 59 delegate!—*Dan Fitzgerald*

**Oklahoma:** Area 57 has about 6,800 members in 400 groups. The area is arranged into 8 districts, which range from 18 groups in one rural district to 82 groups in one urban district. Each district has six D.C.M.s. We have an intergroup in Oklahoma City and a central office in Tulsa. We have 11 standing service committees. The last few years have been a period of improved communication and participation. The area meetings have refocused on carrying the message. The Web site has been completely revamped for improved communication. We had a mini-Conference in March. Much work has been done coordinating with the Drug/DUI Courts that are rapidly expanding in Oklahoma. The effect has been much better understanding of A.A. by the courts. Our two largest counties are now doing informational, bridge-the-gap-like sessions with those newly entering the Drug/DUI court system. More and more A.A. members are coming to see the courts as just another source of newcomers we can reach out to and welcome.—*Ross Drinen*

**Ontario (Eastern):** Area 83 has over 580 registered groups, including 20 correctional groups, in 28 districts in the international geographic area which runs from Oakville in the west to the Québec border in the east, north to Algonquin Park and south into New York State. We hold two assemblies and three area committee meetings annually. Our area is active in Remote Communities and as such this function has become part of our alternate delegate position responsibilities. We have an area web master and now have an area Web site with various links to districts and intergroups. At our January Area Committee meeting it was unanimously agreed that Area 83 will submit a bid to host the 2011 National Alcoholics Anonymous Archives Workshop in Toronto. Although extremely nervous and having a sense of being in way over my head, I feel it's truly a privilege to have the honor of serving my area as their delegate.—*Sandy Smith*

**Ontario (Northeastern):** Area 84 has seven districts and approximately 140 groups. Greater Sudbury has two districts and has several French-speaking groups. Our smallest district is located in Lake Huron, an archipelago known as Manitoulin Island. Until

recently the district has only been accessible by ferry or rail. Our four other districts are vast in size with over 30 groups each. One of these districts meets only four times a year as the travel times are often in excess of 10 hours by several modes of transport. The Special Forum in Moose Factory was a spiritual experience for many who attended. Some members came home knowing there is much to be done in our own districts; in correction centres, treatment centres, colleges and universities—even in the evacuation centres when entire communities are moved to safety because of floods or fires. In many districts members are using the Big Book as the basis of their message and I believe this will bring on a new enthusiasm for and understanding of what the A.A. message is.—*Cathie Jones*

**Ontario (Northwest):** Area 85 consists of seven districts, 83 groups and approximately 1,650 members. Although our area is large in distance and mass, many of our groups are located in remote communities, some being 100 miles from each other. Our message is carried over winter roads, some accessible only 2 or 3 months of the year, or by chartered air, when financially feasible, and only when we are invited. Most groups are active and loyal to our primary purpose and are self-supporting, even though that is difficult at times, due to the harsh economic situation of the North Shore and our country in general. Two assemblies are held each year. Area 85, along with other areas in Canada, has agreed to create a Remote Communities Steering Committee consisting of all Canadian areas and Alaska. Also a meeting will be held in the near future to decide on a chair for the Remote Communities in Canada. Area 85 has developed its own Strategic and Action Plan for Remote Communities and it is slowly being activated. Thank you for permitting me to present the highlights for Northwest Ontario.—*JoAnne Taylor*

**Pennsylvania (Eastern):** The Area 59 committee meets quarterly in various locations throughout Eastern Pennsylvania. There are 48 D.C.M.s, including one from a new Spanish district. We have over 1,400 groups and 31,480 members. Each area event is provided with a Spanish interpreter and assisted listening devices. We hold an Assembly/Convention once a year, and in 2008 we had our 50th. We also hold a Pre-Conference Sharing Session to inform the delegate, three mini-assemblies to hear the delegate's report from the Conference, an area Inventory and Area Day. In the spirit of unity and cooperation with our 11 intergroups we have days-of-sharing and one Hispanic Intergroup Bilingual Share-A-Day. The delegate attends the Pennsylvania State Convention and the Pennsylvania young people's convention. Our C.P.C. sub-committee has contacted the Guest Observer from our Assembly/Convention, who is a parole officer, to see how Area 59 can help carry the message in the criminal justice system. We are talking with Area 60 (Western PA) in regards to having a Share-A-Day.—*Lowell Long*

**Pennsylvania (Western):** Area 60 consists of 45 districts and over 850 meetings. Our districts consist of 10 to 40 meetings. Our yearly calendar is a busy one with four quarterly meetings, three to four assemblies and several Days of Sharing hosted by districts. The purpose of the days of sharing is to reach G.S.R.s and members of A.A. and share the experience, strength and hope of area coordinators and officers. Our hope is to stir interest in general service. We have some districts that are dark and we are trying to communicate with them. We also host a Get Away Weekend before the Conference, to share information about the agenda items and to hear our speaker from G.S.O. My goal is to communicate the message from G.S.O. to the area and hope that the message will travel to districts, home groups and



most importantly, the newcomer. An informed group conscience is priceless.—*Bonnie Smith*

**Québec (Northeast):** Area 89 is a vast territory; our travelling expenses are very high, but we manage fairly well, always looking for improvements. The six new committee officers and the seven active service committees of this area make it very pleasant to serve A.A. We have one service committee we like to call the “seminars” committee. These “seminars” are designed to instill in our members an interest in our publications. At meetings of our area committee we have instituted a three-minute limit for every report. At these meetings, we have a joint reunion with all the service committees to allow each D.C.M. to share their experiences and give their opinions. All of these efforts aim to achieve a better unity. My service sponsor always talked to me about the purity of A.A. principles. Today I can confirm that he was right. I thank my greater Power to have allowed me to enjoy these privileged moments with you. A.A. services have given sense to my life.—*Alain Desbiens*

**Québec (Southeast):** Area 88, on the south shore of the St. Lawrence River, covers an area of 800 miles, from the Eastern Townships to the Gaspé Peninsula, and the Magdalen Islands. The area committee has 18 RDR and seven area trusted servants. We have a C.P.C. coordinator and a Webmaster who collaborates with Public information. The area has 193 groups for approximately 3,000 members. We hold four area meetings yearly and one general assembly. We also hold one annual provincial meeting for the members of the four Québec areas. The magazine *La Vigne A.A.*, is our French Edition of the Grapevine. For years we have been restructuring, and to better do so we had an area inventory. Many solutions were brought up and will be tried. When I return from the Conference, there will be two Gratitude Dinners where the delegate makes a presentation of his experience at the General Service Conference. The area recently bought a multimedia system to better serve and inform members. It is an honor to be able to serve as the delegate of Area 88.—*Réal Normandin*

**Saskatchewan:** Area 91 has approximately 300 groups and an estimated 3,500 members. There are 20 districts, many serving rural communities. We hold a committee meeting in January and two assemblies, rotated throughout the province. We generally have 100% representation of D.C.M.s, partly because the area covers the expenses of the D.C.M.s to attend. This year's A.C.M. focused on the role of the D.C.M., increasing participation, working with remote communities and district development. Carrying the message throughout the remote, sparsely populated areas is a challenge. Many of our service people have just completed three years in one position, so that in western Canada we now have two areas with new delegates and two with seasoned delegates in each panel. We have implemented the Bridging the Gap program, and created an area Web site, which provides much requested information, including meeting times and places. The correctional facilities are grateful to receive literature thanks to our pink can fund. I look forward to participating in this year's Conference and carrying the enthusiasm and gratitude from the Conference back to my area.—*Irma Van De Bon*

**Texas (Northeast):** Area 65 has approximately 515 groups and 20,000 sober members served by 24 geographic districts and five Spanish-speaking districts. Our area assembly meets four times a year, twice in the Dallas/Ft. Worth metroplex and twice in outlying districts who bid to host the assembly. The area committee includes eleven service committee chairpersons. Our

Spring Assembly introduces all attendees to the Conference process through participation in mock committees on the Conference final agenda, gathering the area's group conscience, and thus sending the delegate well-informed, but not instructed. We try to help groups understand how vital their participation is for the health and well-being of all A.A., to understand and apply A.A. Traditions, to maintain adherence to our singleness of purpose, and to work together to solve problems. I am honored to serve as a Panel 59 delegate; I remember an oldtimer telling me early in my sobriety that the reward for service is the opportunity to serve again.—*Jimmy Dean*

**Texas (Southeast):** Area 67 encompasses the southeast portion of the state, covering about 30,000 square miles. We have 522 active groups, 51 of which are Spanish, divided into 13 English districts and four Spanish districts. Our annual convention is held in January. This year's Convention, held in Houston, had the theme “Sponsorship...An Experience You Must Not Miss.” There are three other quarterly assemblies during the year. We also have a self-supporting annual Gratitude Dinner and our C.F.C. Committee hosts an annual multilingual C.F.C. Conference. We have been working toward decentralizing our standing service committees by transferring the work to newly formed district committees. We have a newly reorganized Information Technology Committee, which has responsibility for our computer equipment. Like the other areas in Texas, Area 67 stands ready to partner with Area 68 for the International Convention in San Antonio. We anticipate providing strong support as the time draws closer and we show the world that, in Texas, “Gratitude” is an action word.—*Betsy Gerber*

**Utah:** Area 69 has 12 districts, and 263 registered groups serving about 5,000 members who live in metropolitan, rural and remote communities, including Native American Reservations. Service meetings are bid and hosted by districts throughout Utah, which covers 84,000 square miles. We meet eight times a year—three area assemblies, two area committee meetings, and three area workshops. Every other December we conduct an area inventory chaired by a past delegate. The Communications Committee manages our Web site, publishes our newsletter and facilitates Spanish translations of area service material. Our C.P.C. committee participates annually at The Univ. of Utah's School on Alcoholism and other Drug Dependencies. Clyde G., our Panel 1 delegate, helped establish this C.P.C. opportunity in June 1952. June 2009 marks our 65th A.A. Anniversary. We are searching for solutions to increase funding for our ever expanding area Archives. The Utah area is a hive of A.A. service activity and I am honored to be a part of it.—*Monte Stokes*

**Virginia:** Area 71 has over 1,200 groups spread over 44 districts. The area committee has six officers, 12 committee chairs and seven special assignment coordinators. We hold two assemblies a year. At the onset of each assembly, to better help the new G.S.R.s be more aware of the mechanics of the assembly, we hold a workshop called “New G.S.R. Duties and Responsibilities.” At the winter and summer meetings the delegate and chairman meet with the committee chairs while the alternate delegate meets with the D.C.M.s. We have found that by meeting with the G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s in these settings they feel better informed. Virginia hosted the 65th Southeastern Conference in conjunction with our state convention in August; we had almost 900 in attendance. I want to thank the Fellowship for having the faith in me to allow me to serve as your delegate and the God of my understanding for walking beside me on this wonderful journey.—*Tom Zamaria*



**Washington (Western):** Area 72 has over 1,200 groups spread throughout 41 districts, two of which are Spanish-linguistic districts representing our 24 Spanish groups. We also have a fairly good-sized community of deaf alcoholics who are now participating in service, and rumor has it the Russians are coming. To surmount these language hurdles, while maintaining even a semblance of financial sanity, is currently one of the most pressing challenges. To date we have found the written word to be one of the most cost-effective methods of bridging this divide. We are working to complete a Spanish version of all the information on our Area Web site and, on a quarterly basis, have been creating a Spanish translation of our area's monthly newsletter. Area business is transacted in three area committee quarterlies, which also set the agenda items for our annual assembly in October. Attendance at our last assembly was over 750 registered attendees and a rocking 50% of the groups were represented. I am grateful and honored to serve as this Area's 31st delegate to the General Service Conference.—*Dave Tully*

**West Virginia:** Area 73 is the entire state of West Virginia with groups from the bordering states of Ohio, Kentucky, Virginia, Maryland and Pennsylvania. The A.A. Fellowship in Area 73 began in March 1942, when three gentlemen from Charleston registered their group; 67 years later we have 517 meetings and 432 groups in 16 districts. Carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers remains the priority of our area. Our Spring and Fall service assemblies are hosted on a rotation basis. Our State Convention, held each summer, is a weekend highlighted by speakers from both A.A. and Al-Anon. Members of the Fellowship keep the doors open, the coffee pot on and their hands extended to those who reach out for help. We remain grateful to the Fellowship and God's amazing grace for our sobriety that has made the unofficial slogan of the State of West Virginia a realization for many suffering alcoholics... "Mountaineers are always free."—*Kathy O'Shea*

**Wisconsin (Southern):** Area 75 has 31 districts, plus one Spanish-language district-at-large, and 999 active groups. Our area is served by five central/intergroup offices. We have one dark district. In 2010 we will be transitioning to a single area conference per year. We hold four other assemblies per year and a Delegate's Workshop in March. Many districts are hosting more workshops and open meeting events with growing effectiveness. A new "A.A. at the VA Mini-Conference" is a ground-breaking effort at cooperation between us and a large VA Medical Center (and treatment facility). Area 75 has a reformed Milwaukee County Corrections Committee, some new Special Needs efforts, and some active C.P.C. and P.I. initiatives. A challenge is to be sure we are carrying A.A.'s message, not our own opinions, in matters like service, sponsorship, self-support, and singleness of purpose at all levels.—*Stu Elwing*

## Additional Committee Considerations

*Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." All items, listed by committee, are as follows:*

### AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the General Service Conference Evaluation Form and made no changes.

### ARCHIVES\*

- The Conference Committee on Archives wishes to emphasize the importance of G.S.O.'s A.A. Archives as precious to all members of our Fellowship and wishes to express concern over staffing levels at G.S.O.'s A.A. Archives.
- The committee reviewed the Archives Workbook and expressed satisfaction with the contents.
- The committee discussed the following ideas to make A.A.'s archives and history more readily available to the Fellowship:
  - The committee requested that the trustees' Archives Committee create a report to be forwarded to the 2010 Conference Archives Committee on the feasibility of developing a format (e.g., PowerPoint® presentation) for a self-guided tour of G.S.O.'s A.A. Archives to convey the experience of visiting G.S.O. and the Archives, for those who have not yet visited the General Service Office in New York.
  - The committee requested that the trustees' Archives Committee consider a suggestion to add a daily historical reference to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site to create interest and enthusiasm for A.A.'s history and archival collection.
  - The committee received a report from the Senior Archivist on archival activities since the last Conference in response to suggestions from the 2008 Conference Committee on various ideas for creatively making A.A.'s archives and history readily available to the Fellowship.

### COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee suggested that the voiceover of the text regarding anonymity and singleness of purpose in the C.P.C. video segments directed to professionals in the legal/criminal justice and medical fields currently streamed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site be consistent with the C.P.C. video segment directed to professionals in the employment/human relations field.
- The committee suggested that the C.P.C. video segments directed to professionals in the legal/criminal justice, medical and employment/human relations fields be added in DVD format to the C.P.C. Kit and made available for purchase.
- The committee reviewed the current C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and suggested that appropriate references to the A.A. Grapevine in the C.P.C. Workbook be updated to include La Viña and La Vigne.
- The committee discussed specific possible uses of the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne in C.P.C. endeavors and suggested



\*Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

that the following helpful ideas for C.P.C. committee members be added to the C.P.C. Workbook:

- A.A. groups, individuals or committees participate in "Adopt a Professional" efforts and take a single issue to, or purchase a subscription for the professional.
- "Lose a Grapevine" by leaving an issue behind in a professional's office.
- Consider inviting A.A. Grapevine reps to participate in local C.P.C. presentations and exhibits.
- The committee requested that the staff and trustees consider creating a survey-style follow up letter to be completed by the professional after a C.P.C. contact to assess the effectiveness of the C.P.C. effort. This letter could address items such as the effectiveness of A.A. literature (including the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne), C.P.C. presentations and contact by A.A. members. This letter would be included in the Guide Letter Section of the C.P.C. Workbook.

### CORRECTIONS

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Corrections Kit and Workbook and made the following suggestions:
  - That the list of contents be corrected to indicate that both the Corrections Correspondence Service flyer for the outside A.A. member (F-26) and the Corrections Correspondence request form for inmates (CCS-2) are included in the Kit.
  - That the Spanish-language and the French-language Corrections Kit contents be updated to match as closely as possible the English-language Kit. The committee heard a report from the Publications director that *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* will be completed in Spanish by fall of 2009, and the DVD *A.A. in Correctional Facilities* will be available in a compilation of all three languages by the end of 2009.
  - That a copy of the booklet *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* (in the appropriate language) be included in the Kits.
  - That the list of Corrections Kit Contents be placed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site in the Corrections 'bucket' with the appropriate links to each service piece, pamphlet or book, where available.
- The committee considered alternatives to a biennial mailing to corrections professionals, and made the following suggestions:
  - That the automatic biennial mailing begun by an additional committee consideration of the Conference Committee on Corrections in 1999 be suspended indefinitely.
  - That the American Correctional Association Directory of Adult and Juvenile Correctional Departments, Institutions, Agencies and Probation and Parole continue to be purchased on a biennial basis and the contact information therein be sent to the relevant area corrections committee chair.
- The committee discussed issues that may be involved in A.A. members complying with the rules of correctional facilities, such as signing 'sponsorship agreements' or legally binding documents, and requested sharing from the A.A. Fellowship regarding this topic to be gathered by the staff member and the trustees' Committee on Corrections and that this sharing be sent to the 2010 Conference Committee on Corrections.

### FINANCE

- The committee acknowledges that roughly half of all the A.A. groups contributing is not enough to support our services, yet agreed that funding services through voluntary contributions is our ideal. The committee affirms the General Service Board Policy previously adopted which reads as follows: "Self-Support of the World Services of Alcoholics Anonymous: The A.A. spiritual principle of self-support enables us to pursue our primary purpose of carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic with a shared sense of responsibility for our lifesaving work and without interference or financial dependence on outsiders. From our Fellowship's earliest days, the expenses of the General Service Office, and the world services provided by it, have exceeded the amount derived from contributions of A.A. groups and members. As a result, providing these needed services has necessarily been supported in part by income from the sale of A.A. literature. It is the policy of the General Service Board that income from literature sales should only be in amounts required to allow continued provision of vitally needed services and maintenance of a prudent reserve fund. We hope that the day will come when A.A. groups and members, through their contributions, will be able to fund fully the services provided by the General Service Office. If that is achieved, revenues from literature sales will only be needed in amounts necessary to cover the actual costs associated with literature production and to maintain a prudent reserve fund."
- The committee discussed a request to produce a Seventh Tradition poster and took no action. The committee felt that while visual aids are frequently helpful, it did not feel that there was a need for a



"Conference-approved" Seventh Tradition poster, but hoped that local areas might create visual aids that could be shared with others.

## GRAPEVINE

- The committee discussed the contents of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook and noted that the new portable GvR Handbook requested by the 2008 Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine is scheduled for publication.

The committee also requested that the current A.A. Grapevine Workbook, *A Guide to the A.A. Grapevine*, continue to be posted on the A.A. Grapevine Web site as a free download.

The committee suggested that the location and description of the Workbook/Guide be reviewed to improve visibility and accessibility on the Web site.

- The committee considered a request that "the 2007 Conference Advisory Action recommending that 'the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña include a section on the medical, legal, and social aspects of alcoholism, with an appropriate disclaimer' be rescinded" and after lengthy and thoughtful discussion took no action.

- The committee requested that the disclaimer in the section on medical, legal and social aspects of alcoholism in the A.A. Grapevine (Alcoholism at Large) be placed more prominently and distinctively and that the language of the disclaimer in the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña be reviewed for both clarity and consistency.

- The committee considered a request that the 2004 Conference Advisory Action—"To allow the widest distribution of the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña to all purchasers, while guarding against affiliations with any outside enterprise, a) subscriptions to the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña magazines be issued only by A.A. Grapevine, Inc., or by A.A. trusted servants directly; and b) the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., adopt standardized sales practices and pricing structures for all purchasers. Note: This recommendation is to clarify the 1993 Advisory Action stating that the Grapevine Corporate Board not actively pursue the placement of Grapevine materials for resale in commercial (non-A.A.) outlets."—be rescinded and took no action. The committee noted that rescinding the 2004 Advisory Action would not have an impact on the 2009 subscription price.

- The committee supported the spirit of communication between the Grapevine Board and Conference members, as recommended in 1987 and reaffirmed in 1988 that: "The Grapevine staff be responsible for communicating updated information to the delegates at appropriate intervals regarding editorial, circulation/fulfillment, and financial matters."

- The committee expressed concerns regarding several changes and decisions made by the A.A. Grapevine office and Board in the last year, concerning items produced by A.A. Grapevine, Inc. The committee requested that the A.A. Grapevine Board review the history of Advisory Actions pertaining to the relationship between the A.A. Grapevine Board, A.A. Grapevine office and the



Conference Committee, on the decision-making process of matters that affect the Fellowship (i.e. pricing, redesign, name change and promotional items) and forward a report to the 60th General Service Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine for their review.

## INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS\*

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums consider ways that the broadcast of the 2010 International Convention Opening Flag Ceremony could be made more widely available than was the 2005 broadcast.

- The committee discussed the site-selection process for the 2020 International Convention, and requested that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums conduct a review and inventory of the site-selection process for International Conventions and prepare a report for the 2010 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Local Forums, including:

- Be enthusiastic in announcing the Forum in advance, and reporting on it afterwards.
- Write an article about the Forum for a local newsletter or Web site.
- Participation is key—get people involved in the planning of the Forum, as greeters, hospitality, registration, etc.
- Encourage all segments of the Fellowship to attend, including those who speak other languages.
- Seek ways to prevent conflicts with other local events, such as sharing weekend A.A. event schedules through a central office or intergroup.
- Let members know that Local Forums can be requested by any A.A. entity; the request does not need to come through the general service structure.
- Overcome challenges of the cost of attending Forums by encouraging members to ride together and share rooms; some areas have rented buses for members to travel together.

\*Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

## LITERATURE

- The committee considered the request to publish a book of stories from members living in remote communities and took no action. The committee noted that there was no widely expressed need.
- The committee considered the request to develop a second volume of *Daily Reflections* and took no action.

## POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee reviewed the "General Service Board Summary of Responses to Inventory Questions Pertaining to Regional Composition and Structure" and expressed their gratitude to the General Service Board for their thorough discussion of the inventory questions.

## PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the 2008 Annual Report from the trustees' Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site.
- The committee considered the request to add the text "Provide initial motivation" to the section "What A.A. Does Not Do" in the flyer "A.A. at a Glance," and took no action. The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee consider placing the full text of the section "What A.A. Does Not Do," from the service piece "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous," into the "What A.A. Does Not Do" section of the "A.A. at a Glance" flyer.
- The committee considered the request to develop a generic A.A. poster or posters for places such as hospitals, places of employment, doctors' offices, etc., and took no action. The committee noted that there is no widely expressed need for this item at this time and that experience with posters will be gained should the wall poster for young people become available.
- The committee reviewed current A.A. television public service announcements for relevance and usefulness, and suggested that no current television public service announcements be retired.
- The committee reviewed information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the 2008 A.A. television public service announcement "I Thought."
- The committee requested that the script be included in the packaging of the "Combination Radio P.S.A.s on CD."
- The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee consider distribution options in addition to DVD for the A.A. Videos for Young People, e.g., placement on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.
- The committee requested that the A.A. Videos for Young People Project continue, and that video submissions be encouraged from young people in the Fellowship, especially from Spanish-speaking members.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee consider the purpose, usefulness, frequency and methodology of the A.A. Membership Survey.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee develop text on the importance of not breaking the anonymity of living A.A. members in memorial announcements when one of our Fellowship dies. This text, intended for inclusion in the pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity," is requested to be

brought back to the 2010 Conference Committee on Public Information.

- The committee briefly discussed the use of the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña in Public Information endeavors.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and requested that the pamphlets "Too Young?" and "A.A. for the Older Alcoholic—Never Too Late" be included.

## REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee received a locally developed G.S.R. Preamble and decided not to include it in *The A.A. Service Manual Combined With Twelve Concepts for World Service*. The committee recognized that the G.S.R. Preamble is not broadly utilized within the Fellowship and the ideals expressed already exist in G.S.R. Material.
- Editorial responsibilities of the Publications Department of the General Service Office regarding *The A.A. Service Manual Combined With Twelve Concepts for World Service* will be limited to the following:
  - Update financial and publication data that changes on an annual basis.
  - Revise dates that require periodic updating.
  - Correct typographical and spelling errors.
  - Maintain an accurate index and cross references.
- The committee reviewed a request from the A.A.W.S. Board to add text regarding the desirability of business or professional background for regional and at-large trustees to the section of *The A.A. Service Manual Combined With Twelve Concepts for World Service* on "Qualifications of an Effective Trustee" found on p. S63. The committee strongly believes that placing such limitations on those who are willing to serve might prevent the selection of the most qualified candidate.
- The committee considered a suggestion to insert the page reference "(see page S63)" in the section on Regional Trustees found on page S65 and decided it was not needed.
- The committee reviewed suggested revisions to Chapters 10 and 12 of *The A.A. Service Manual Combined With Twelve Concepts for World Service* submitted by the A.A. Grapevine Board. The Committee suggested that the A.A. Grapevine Board forward revisions of Chapters 10 and 12 to the 2010 Conference Committee on Report & Charter and:
  - Use the current version (2009-2010) of Chapters 10 and 12 as the basic text.
  - Include any new charts necessary to the text.
  - Provide reasons for the proposed revisions.

The committee also suggested that the A.A. Grapevine Board may wish to retain accurate historical information currently in *The A.A. Service Manual Combined With Twelve Concepts for World Service*.

- The committee is forwarding a request to clarify language regarding nominating a regional trustee candidate in the same year when nominating a trustee-at-large candidate to the 2010 Conference Committee on Trustees, as the request includes reference to the 1985 Conference Committee on Trustees Advisory Action, "no area shall submit an individual as candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large U.S./Canada in the same year."

The committee noted inconsistencies in the current *A.A. Service Manual*, the current Conference Charter, and the 1985 Conference Advisory Action.

- The committee reviewed a list of proposed editorial changes to *The A.A. Service Manual Combined With Twelve Concepts for World Service* and forwarded them to the Publications Department.
- The committee reviewed a list of proposed editorial changes to *The A.A. Directories* and forwarded them to the Publications Department.
- The committee agreed to review the rough draft of the *Final Conference Report* and the tear sheets of *The A.A. Service Manual Combined With Twelve Concepts for World Service* with careful attention to accuracy and completeness of reporting. The committee agreed to return corrections or suggestions to the G.S.O. within 21 days of receipt.

### TREATMENT

- The committee considered a proposal to include additional information on carrying A.A.'s message to treatment facilities with out-patient programs. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities consider developing a section on carrying the A.A. message into out-patient treatment settings, using shared experience, for inclusion in the Treatment Facilities Workbook and the A.A. Guidelines on Treatment Facilities.

In addition, the committee suggested that staff continue to gather shared area experience regarding carrying the A.A. message into out-patient treatment settings and that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities continue to explore ways to carry the A.A. message to treatment professionals and patients in out-patient settings.

- The committee discussed possible uses of the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña in Treatment Facilities endeavors and suggested that the A.A. Grapevine consider developing an annual treatment facilities issue similar to its annual Corrections issue. In addition, it was suggested that if a new treatment facilities issue is published that it be placed in the Treatment Facilities Kit.

It was also suggested that groups be encouraged to adopt a treatment facility or center for the purpose of providing subscriptions and/or back issues of the A.A. Grapevine.

- Upon review of the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook, the committee suggested that an A.A. Grapevine as well as the DVD *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous*, be included in the kit.

It was also suggested that a one-page insert containing suggested uses/examples of the "Local Experiences" tab be added to the Treatment Facilities Kit.

### TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the résumés and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for East Central and Southeast regional trustee and for trustee-at-large/U.S.
- The committee thoroughly reviewed and unanimously accepted, with one correction noted, the report from the trustees' Committee on Nominating pertaining to the 2008 Additional Committee Consideration regarding Class B regional trustee and trustee-at-large successor terms in the event of an unexpected vacancy.

## RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

### LITERATURE

- The committee recommended that the revised draft pamphlet "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" be approved.
- The committee recommended updating the existing video/DVD, "Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine, and the General Service Structure" and adding one episode on G.S.R. and one episode on D.C.M. to the video/DVD. The committee looks forward to reviewing a progress report or a revised video/DVD at the 2010 Conference. [Note: The approximate cost is \$64,000]
- The committee recommended that the trustees' Committee on Literature develop a questionnaire to gather input from the Fellowship on whether there is a need to develop Conference-approved literature that focuses on the topics of spirituality, and agnostics or atheists/nonbelievers in A.A., and that a report which includes a summary of the results from the responses to the questionnaire be presented to the 2010 Conference Committee on Literature.

### POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee recommended that as part of a procedure for the submission of minority appeals to the General Service Conference, minority appeals be presented directly to the General Service Conference without being reviewed, vetted or approved by any committee of either the Trustees or the Conference.

## FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- Recommend that a thorough inventory of the charter be made a standing agenda item for the Conference Committee on Report and Charter. (**Conference voted not to consider**)
- Request a floor action with a needs assessment for Special Needs literature that includes scope, content and cost of such literature by trustees' Committee on Literature. (**Conference voted not to consider**)
- That the price increases proposed by Alcoholics Anonymous World Services in a letter dated March 20, 2009 be withdrawn and the current pricing structure be maintained. (**Not Approved**)
- To develop a uniform Conference-approved policy regarding full-face photography of actors or subjects appearing in our General Service Conference-approved videos/public service announcements/graphic arts projects before any new projects are placed in production. (**Not Approved**)
- The Kindle project/contract with Amazon.com be suspended immediately and a detailed review be conducted by the trustees' Literature Committee on the scope, substance, format, and pricing arrangements. This report is to be forwarded to the 2010 Conference Committee on Literature. (**Not Approved**)
- Do a voice over in the video "Hope – Alcoholics Anonymous" to change the discussion of the Traditions as "by-laws" to "guidelines" or some related term. (**Not Approved**)

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.  
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.  
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION**

December 31, 2008 (with comparative totals for 2007)

|                                         | General Service Board of A.A. |                   |                       |                             |                           |                      |                   |                   |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|----------------------|-------------------|-------------------|
|                                         | General Fund                  | Reserve Fund      | Capital Projects Fund | Postretirement Medical Fund | A.A. World Services, Inc. | A.A. Grapevine, Inc. | Consolidated 2008 | Consolidated 2007 |
| <b>ASSETS</b>                           |                               |                   |                       |                             |                           |                      |                   |                   |
| Cash                                    | \$ 709,343                    | \$ 371,120        |                       | \$ 116,350                  | \$ 647,628                | \$ 241,376           | \$ 2,085,817      | \$ 3,372,558      |
| Accounts and interest receivable        |                               | 128,932           |                       |                             | 267,127                   | 126,343              | 522,402           | 516,570           |
| Intercompany balances                   | (1,009,641)                   | (1,293,600)       |                       |                             | 684,405                   | 1,618,836            | -                 | -                 |
| Inventories                             |                               |                   |                       |                             |                           |                      |                   |                   |
| Books, pamphlets, etc.                  |                               |                   |                       |                             | 2,085,606                 | 253,232              | 2,338,838         | 1,872,964         |
| Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.      |                               |                   |                       |                             | 326,965                   | 7,150                | 334,115           | 335,968           |
| Investments - at fair value (Note 2)    |                               | 13,064,295        |                       | 470,791                     |                           |                      | 13,535,086        | 12,039,757        |
| Property and Equipment                  |                               |                   |                       |                             |                           |                      |                   |                   |
| (net of accumulated depreciation -      |                               |                   |                       |                             |                           |                      |                   |                   |
| 2008 - \$4,146,273;                     |                               |                   |                       |                             |                           |                      |                   |                   |
| 2007 - \$3,845,752) (Note 2)            |                               |                   | \$ 407,476            |                             | 292,756                   | 9,244                | 709,476           | 889,579           |
| Deferred charges and deposits           | 40,415                        |                   |                       |                             | 58,265                    | 63,480               | 162,160           | 136,092           |
| Prepaid conventions - 2010/2015/2020    | 316,896                       |                   |                       |                             |                           |                      | 316,896           | 213,655           |
| <b>Total Assets</b>                     | <b>57,013</b>                 | <b>12,270,747</b> | <b>407,476</b>        | <b>587,141</b>              | <b>4,362,752</b>          | <b>2,319,661</b>     | <b>20,004,790</b> | <b>19,377,143</b> |
| <b>LIABILITIES</b>                      |                               |                   |                       |                             |                           |                      |                   |                   |
| Accounts payable                        |                               |                   |                       |                             | \$ 781,672                | \$ 179,471           | \$ 961,143        | \$ 583,501        |
| Accrued royalties                       |                               |                   |                       |                             | 12,095                    |                      | 12,095            | 12,337            |
| Deferred income                         |                               |                   |                       |                             |                           |                      |                   |                   |
| - Orders and subscriptions              |                               |                   |                       |                             | 96,128                    | 1,848,872            | 1,945,000         | 1,784,700         |
| Accrued postretirement health benefits  |                               |                   |                       | \$ 3,965,968                |                           |                      | 3,965,968         | 4,122,317         |
| Accrued pension benefits                |                               | \$ 8,101,999      |                       |                             |                           |                      | 8,101,999         | 4,548,581         |
| <b>Total Liabilities</b>                | <b>\$ -</b>                   | <b>8,101,999</b>  | <b>\$ -</b>           | <b>3,965,968</b>            | <b>889,895</b>            | <b>2,028,343</b>     | <b>14,986,205</b> | <b>11,051,436</b> |
| Net Assets (Exhibit B)                  | 57,013                        | 4,168,748         | 407,476               | (3,378,827)                 | 3,472,857                 | 291,318              | 5,018,585         | 8,325,707         |
| <b>Total Liabilities and Net Assets</b> | <b>57,013</b>                 | <b>12,270,747</b> | <b>407,476</b>        | <b>587,141</b>              | <b>4,362,752</b>          | <b>2,319,661</b>     | <b>20,004,790</b> | <b>19,377,143</b> |

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.



**Exhibit B**

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.**  
**Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.**

**CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY**

Year Ended December 31, 2008 (with comparative totals for 2007)

|                                                    | General Service Board of A.A. |                 |                          |                                | A.A. Grapevine, Inc.         |              |                     | Consolidated<br>2008 | Consolidated<br>2007 |
|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------|---------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
|                                                    | General<br>Fund               | Reserve<br>Fund | Capital Projects<br>Fund | Postretirement<br>Medical Fund | A.A. World<br>Services, Inc. | English      | Spanish<br>Magazine |                      |                      |
| <b>INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE</b>               |                               |                 |                          |                                |                              |              |                     |                      |                      |
| Gross Sales                                        |                               |                 |                          |                                | \$ 12,777,333                | \$ 2,952,238 | \$ 124,635          | \$ 15,854,206        | \$ 15,708,507        |
| Less: Discounts                                    |                               |                 |                          |                                | 347,381                      | 116,919      | -                   | 464,300              | 447,524              |
| <b>Net Sales</b>                                   |                               |                 |                          |                                | 12,429,952                   | 2,835,319    | 124,635             | 15,389,906           | 15,260,983           |
| Cost of Literature Distributed                     |                               |                 |                          |                                |                              |              |                     |                      |                      |
| Printing                                           |                               |                 |                          |                                | (3,567,820)                  | (423,633)    | (42,356)            | (4,033,809)          | (4,132,544)          |
| Royalties on books                                 |                               |                 |                          |                                | (51,097)                     | -            | -                   | (51,097)             | (67,898)             |
| Direct shipping and warehousing                    |                               |                 |                          |                                | (1,862,685)                  | (671,269)    | (37,389)            | (2,571,343)          | (2,278,701)          |
| <b>Gross Profit from Literature</b>                |                               |                 |                          |                                | 6,948,350                    | 1,740,417    | 44,890              | 8,733,657            | 8,781,840            |
| <b>CONTRIBUTIONS</b>                               | \$ 6,462,760                  |                 |                          |                                |                              |              |                     | 6,462,760            | 6,526,002            |
| <b>INVESTMENT INCOME (Note 2)</b>                  | 2,206                         | \$ 660,897      |                          | \$ (164,233)                   | 3,552                        | 66,200       | -                   | 568,622              | 853,330              |
| <b>Total Income</b>                                | 6,464,966                     | 660,897         |                          | (164,233)                      | 6,951,902                    | 1,806,617    | 44,890              | 15,765,039           | 16,161,172           |
| <b>FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)</b>             |                               |                 |                          |                                |                              |              |                     |                      |                      |
| Program                                            | 5,643,407                     |                 |                          | -                              | 2,455,184                    | 1,196,177    | 121,154             | 9,415,922            | 8,842,552            |
| Supporting services                                | 3,803,853                     | (528,099)       | \$ 167,632               | (407,349)                      | 1,789,789                    | 748,896      | -                   | 5,574,722            | 5,363,394            |
| <b>Total Expenses</b>                              | 9,447,260                     | (528,099)       | 167,632                  | (407,349)                      | 4,244,973                    | 1,945,073    | 121,154             | 14,990,644           | 14,205,946           |
| <b>EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR</b>         | (2,982,294)                   | 1,188,996       | (167,632)                | 243,116                        | 2,706,929                    | (138,456)    | (76,264)            | 774,395              | 1,955,226            |
| Recognition of pension liability<br>under SFAS 158 | -                             | (4,081,517)     | -                        | -                              | -                            | -            | -                   | (4,081,517)          | (3,157,428)          |
| <b>INTERCOMPANY AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS</b>        |                               |                 |                          |                                |                              |              |                     |                      |                      |
| GSB La Viña support                                | (76,264)                      | -               | -                        | -                              | -                            | -            | 76,264              | -                    | -                    |
| Other Transfer                                     | 3,058,558                     | 700,000         | -                        | -                              | (3,758,558)                  | -            | -                   | -                    | -                    |
| <b>CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR</b>               | -                             | (2,192,521)     | (167,632)                | 243,116                        | (1,051,629)                  | (138,456)    | -                   | (3,307,122)          | (1,202,202)          |
| <b>NET ASSETS</b>                                  |                               |                 |                          |                                |                              |              |                     |                      |                      |
| Beginning of year                                  | 57,013                        | 6,361,269       | 575,108                  | (3,621,943)                    | 4,524,486                    | 429,774      | -                   | 8,325,707            | 9,527,909            |
| <b>NET ASSETS</b>                                  |                               |                 |                          |                                |                              |              |                     |                      |                      |
| End of year (Exhibit A)                            | 57,013                        | 4,168,748       | 407,476                  | (3,378,827)                    | 3,472,857                    | 291,318      | -                   | 5,018,585            | 8,325,707            |

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.  
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

**CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES**

Year Ended December 31, 2008 (with comparative totals for 2007)

| OPERATING EXPENSES                              | Group<br>Services  | Fellowship<br>Services | General<br>Service<br>Conference | World<br>Service<br>Meeting | Regional<br>Forums | Publishing          | Grapevine          | La Viña           | Supporting<br>Services | 2008<br>Total       | 2007<br>Total       |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------|---------------------|--------------------|-------------------|------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| Salaries                                        | \$ 712,261         | \$ 900,778             | \$ 177,670                       | \$ 3,209                    | \$ 161,729         | \$ 1,217,977        | \$ 473,451         | \$ 77,544         | \$2,385,095            | \$ 6,109,714        | \$ 5,916,370        |
| Payroll taxes                                   | 58,473             | 69,460                 | 12,088                           |                             | 12,482             | 88,005              | 45,217             | 6,629             | 182,627                | 474,981             | 434,202             |
| Health and group insurance                      | 108,904            | 129,365                | 22,514                           |                             | 23,248             | 163,906             | 89,192             | 7,008             | 501,602                | 1,045,739           | 989,716             |
| Retirement expense - funding                    | 195,544            | 232,282                | 40,426                           |                             | 41,742             | 294,302             | 57,791             |                   | 540,702                | 1,402,789           | 1,357,355           |
| Other program printing                          | 303,329            | 57,208                 | 65,789                           | 12,000                      | 52,222             | -                   |                    |                   | 1,203                  | 491,751             | 456,016             |
| Mailing labor                                   | 116,897            | 14,092                 | 1,697                            |                             |                    | -                   |                    |                   |                        | 132,686             | 128,074             |
| Postage and express                             | 207,610            | 117,110                | 49,710                           |                             | 35,360             | 47,944              | 4,319              | 250               | 38,722                 | 501,025             | 435,518             |
| Writers fees                                    | 18,762             | 93,838                 | 10,500                           | 7,341                       | 860                | 50,623              |                    |                   | 650                    | 182,574             | 203,990             |
| Foreign literature assistance                   |                    | 95,887                 |                                  |                             |                    |                     |                    |                   |                        | 95,887              | 124,454             |
| Selling expenses                                |                    |                        |                                  |                             |                    | 230,226             | 133,258            | 8,877             | 24,213                 | 396,574             | 292,018             |
| Professional fees                               |                    | 1,812                  |                                  |                             |                    |                     |                    | 360               | 250,822                | 252,994             | 286,088             |
| Contracted services                             | 61,693             | 168,068                | 18,447                           | 24,376                      | 28,256             | 84,348              | 193,739            | 11,118            | 533,610                | 1,123,655           | 1,049,615           |
| Occupancy                                       | 96,448             | 124,882                | 9,686                            |                             | 10,586             | 173,263             | 77,229             |                   | 348,339                | 840,433             | 835,773             |
| Telephone                                       | 15,015             | 17,211                 | 5,840                            | 504                         | 1,778              | 14,084              | 17,201             |                   | 45,255                 | 116,888             | 122,134             |
| Equipment maintenance                           | 602                | 2,532                  | 75                               |                             | 75                 | 11,909              |                    |                   | 108,481                | 123,674             | 123,377             |
| Furniture and equipment depreciation            | 22,719             | 23,581                 | 2,797                            |                             | 4,413              | 35,408              |                    | 235               | 61,547                 | 150,700             | 137,789             |
| Stationery and office supplies                  | 91,916             | 11,685                 | 10,135                           | 2,835                       | 461                | 1,192               | 52,390             |                   | 70,403                 | 241,017             | 221,898             |
| Office service and expense                      | 10,049             | 18,016                 | 28,623                           | 15,899                      | 12,109             | 19,641              | 52,390             | 4,373             | 306,571                | 467,671             | 297,928             |
| Travel, meals and accommodations                | 4,292              | 41,779                 | 593,997                          | 295,911                     | 55,509             | 22,356              |                    | 4,485             | 582,805                | 1,601,134           | 1,216,560           |
| Bad debts                                       |                    |                        |                                  |                             |                    |                     |                    | 275               | 26,185                 | 26,460              | 29,861              |
| Delegate fees                                   |                    |                        | (216,795)                        | (136,797)                   |                    |                     |                    |                   |                        | (353,592)           | (194,714)           |
| <b>Total Operating Expenses</b>                 | <u>2,024,514</u>   | <u>2,119,586</u>       | <u>833,199</u>                   | <u>225,278</u>              | <u>440,830</u>     | <u>2,455,184</u>    | <u>1,196,177</u>   | <u>121,154</u>    | <u>6,008,832</u>       | <u>15,424,754</u>   | <u>14,464,022</u>   |
| Severance benefits                              |                    |                        |                                  |                             |                    |                     |                    |                   | 333,706                | 333,706             | -                   |
| Postretirement health benefits                  |                    |                        |                                  |                             |                    |                     |                    |                   | (407,349)              | (407,349)           | (176,796)           |
| Retirement expense adjustment                   |                    |                        |                                  |                             |                    |                     |                    |                   | (528,099)              | (528,099)           | (270,788)           |
| Capital projects depreciation                   |                    |                        |                                  |                             |                    |                     |                    |                   | 167,632                | 167,632             | 189,508             |
| <b>Total Expenses</b>                           | <u>2,024,514</u>   | <u>2,119,586</u>       | <u>833,199</u>                   | <u>225,278</u>              | <u>440,830</u>     | <u>2,455,184</u>    | <u>1,196,177</u>   | <u>121,154</u>    | <u>5,574,722</u>       | <u>14,990,644</u>   | <u>14,205,946</u>   |
| Allocation of supporting services to activities | <u>1,089,147</u>   | <u>1,140,294</u>       | <u>448,244</u>                   | <u>121,195</u>              | <u>237,157</u>     | <u>1,789,789</u>    | <u>748,896</u>     | <u>-</u>          | <u>(5,574,722)</u>     | <u>-</u>            | <u>-</u>            |
| <b>Total Allocated Expenses</b>                 | <u>3,113,661</u>   | <u>3,259,880</u>       | <u>1,281,443</u>                 | <u>346,473</u>              | <u>\$677,987</u>   | <u>\$ 4,244,973</u> | <u>\$1,945,073</u> | <u>121,154</u>    | <u>-</u>               | <u>14,990,644</u>   | <u>14,205,946</u>   |
| Services                                        | \$3,113,661        | \$3,259,880            | \$1,281,443                      | \$346,473                   | \$677,987          |                     |                    |                   |                        | \$ 8,679,444        | \$ 8,270,004        |
| Publishing                                      | -                  | -                      | -                                | -                           | -                  | \$4,244,973         |                    |                   |                        | 4,244,973           | 4,035,900           |
| Grapevine                                       | -                  | -                      | -                                | -                           | -                  | -                   | \$1,945,073        | \$121,154         |                        | 2,066,227           | 1,900,042           |
|                                                 |                    |                        |                                  |                             |                    |                     |                    |                   |                        | <u>14,990,644</u>   | <u>14,205,946</u>   |
| COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 2007                       | <u>\$3,120,585</u> | <u>\$3,398,192</u>     | <u>\$1,110,730</u>               | <u>\$ -</u>                 | <u>\$640,497</u>   | <u>\$4,035,900</u>  | <u>\$1,765,221</u> | <u>\$ 134,821</u> |                        | <u>\$14,205,946</u> | <u>\$13,345,336</u> |

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.  
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.  
 Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.  
 Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows  
 Year Ended December 31, 2008  
 (with comparative totals for 2007)**

**CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)**

|                                                                                       | <u>2008</u>             | <u>2007</u>             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:</b>                                                     |                         |                         |
| Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)                                             | \$ (3,307,122)          | \$ (1,202,202)          |
| Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments                                | (87,438)                | (336,874)               |
| Amortization of bond premiums                                                         | 21,776                  | 4,470                   |
| Depreciation                                                                          | 318,322                 | 327,297                 |
| Changes in assets and liabilities:                                                    |                         |                         |
| Accounts receivable                                                                   | (5,832)                 | (44,771)                |
| Inventories                                                                           | (464,021)               | 281,659                 |
| Deferred charges and other assets                                                     | (129,309)               | (9,260)                 |
| Accounts and accruals payable                                                         | 377,400                 | (327,196)               |
| Deferred income                                                                       | 160,300                 | 10,853                  |
| Postretirement health benefits obligation                                             | (156,349)               | 94,107                  |
| Accrued pension benefits                                                              | <u>3,553,418</u>        | <u>2,856,179</u>        |
| <b><u>Net Cash Flows Provided</u></b><br><b><u>By Operating Activities</u></b>        | <u>281,145</u>          | <u>1,654,262</u>        |
| <b>FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:</b>                                                     |                         |                         |
| Purchases of property and equipment                                                   | (138,219)               | (291,923)               |
| Proceeds from sales of investments                                                    | 5,140,389               | 3,481,342               |
| Purchases of investments                                                              | <u>(6,570,056)</u>      | <u>(5,735,231)</u>      |
| <b><u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u></b><br><b><u>By Investing Activities</u></b> | <u>(1,567,886)</u>      | <u>(2,545,812)</u>      |
| Net Increase (Decrease) in Cash                                                       | (1,286,741)             | (891,550)               |
| Cash, beginning of year                                                               | <u>3,372,558</u>        | <u>4,264,108</u>        |
| Cash, end of year                                                                     | <u><u>2,085,817</u></u> | <u><u>3,372,558</u></u> |

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

# Report of the Independent Auditor

## AUDITORS' OPINION

April 14, 2009

The Board of Trustees  
The General Service Board of  
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.  
475 Riverside Drive  
New York, New York 10015  
Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying consolidated statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC., and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. as of December 31, 2008 and the related consolidated statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

We conducted our audit in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audit provides a reasonable basis for our opinion. The prior year summarized comparative information has been derived from the Organization's December 31, 2007 consolidated financial statements, and in our report dated April 7, 2008, we expressed an unqualified opinion on those financial statements.

In our opinion, the consolidated financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 2008 and the changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America.

Respectfully submitted,  
Owen J. Flanagan and Company  
Certified Public Accountants  
New York, N.Y.

### THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS DECEMBER 31, 2008

**Note 1 Organization:** The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., ("G.S.B.") and its affiliates A.A. World Services, Inc. ("A.A.W.S.") and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. ("A.A.G.V.") are not-for-profit corporations organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose. The trustees of G.S.B. are members ex officio of A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V., and as such, elect their boards of directors. As members, they also have the sole right to amend the A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V. by-laws, and approve their budgets.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in five separate funds, as follows:

**The RESERVE FUND** - This fund was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was re-defined by a special General Service Board

Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held for unfulfilled subscriptions reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees upon recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

**The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND** - This fund accounts for the cost of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and records annual depreciation on such assets.

**The CONVENTION FUND** - A separate fund established to record the direct income and expenses of international A.A. conventions held every five years. These events are separate from the regular operations of the General Service Office, but the General Fund receives any excess of income, or pays any excess of expense, resulting from the activity.

From a historical perspective, the net direct result of all conventions held to date is approximately an excess of income of \$716,000, and presently resides with all other income not required for working capital in the Reserve Fund.

**The POSTRETIREMENT MEDICAL FUND** - A fund established in 2006 with the goal of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the liability for postretirement health benefits by the end of ten years.

The Postretirement health benefits plan is described in more detail in Note 5.

**The GENERAL FUND** - This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

All net assets of the Corporations are free of donor restrictions.

**Note 2 Accounting Policies:** The Corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit pledges, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Contributions received from A.A. groups and members are for the general activities of the General Service Office, and are recorded as unrestricted. Donations received from foreign A.A. entities for the international literature fund are also treated as unrestricted, as A.A.'s ongoing foreign literature assistance program satisfies the donor's condition on a current basis.

Intercompany balances and transfers are eliminated in the consolidated totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been allocated based on its proportionate square footage; substantially all other ex-

penses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

**Cash:** For purposes of the consolidated statement of cash flows, cash is defined as cash on hand, checking and money market accounts and short term cash investments.

Cash in excess of federally insured limits are potentially exposed to concentrations of credit risk. However, the Organization only maintains accounts with quality financial institutions with high credit standings, so as a consequence, such risks are limited.

**Inventories:** Inventories held are recorded at lower of cost or market under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

**Property and Equipment:** The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated on a straight line basis over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are capitalized and depreciated over estimated useful lives of three to eight years by the operating entities.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 2008 and the accumulated depreciation at that date:

|                        | <u>Life</u>  | <u>Cost</u>      | <u>Current Year</u> | <u>Accumulated Depreciation</u> |
|------------------------|--------------|------------------|---------------------|---------------------------------|
| Leasehold improvements | Terms of     |                  |                     |                                 |
| 475 Riverside Drive    | Leases       | \$2,586,495      | \$ 88,093           | \$2,185,974                     |
| Furniture              | 8 Years      | 738,155          | 8,397               | 703,956                         |
| Computers - hardware   | 3 to 5 Years | 744,891          | 92,031              | 681,875                         |
| Software               | 5 Years      | 786,208          | 129,811             | 574,468                         |
|                        |              | <u>4,855,749</u> | <u>318,332</u>      | <u>4,146,273</u>                |

**Investments:** Investments are recorded at fair value. Gains and losses on sales or redemptions are recorded by comparison of proceeds to amortized cost on a specific identification basis.

The Corporations adopted FAS 157, Fair Value Measurements, effective January 1, 2008. FAS 157 establishes a framework for measuring fair value, and expands disclosures about fair value measurements. Investments are now classified into one of three categories.

Level 1 - Quoted prices are available in active markets for identical investments as of the reporting date.

Level 2 - Pricing inputs are other than quoted prices in active markets, which are either directly or indirectly observable as of the reporting date, and the fair value is determined through the use of models or other valuation methodologies.

Level 3 - Pricing inputs are unobservable for the investment and include situations where there is little, if any, market activity for the investment.

All of the securities held by the Corporations at December 31, 2008 and 2007 have been valued at Level 1 using quoted prices available in active markets.

As described above, all funds of the operating entities not required for working capital are consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes or Bills normally held to maturity.

The Postretirement Medical Fund holds investments designed to assist in reaching the stated goal of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the accrued postretirement health benefits by December 31, 2015. The fund invests in bond and equity mutual funds.

At December 31, 2008, investments were comprised as follows:

|                             | <u>Cost</u>       | <u>Fair Value</u> |
|-----------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| Reserve Fund                |                   |                   |
| Certificate of deposits     | \$1,500,000       | \$1,500,000       |
| U.S. Treasury               | 10,944,219        | 11,564,295        |
| Totals                      | <u>12,444,219</u> | <u>13,064,295</u> |
| Postretirement Medical Fund |                   |                   |
| Bond funds                  | 214,353           | 194,265           |
| Equity funds                | 451,585           | 276,526           |
|                             | <u>665,938</u>    | <u>470,791</u>    |
| Totals                      | <u>13,110,157</u> | <u>13,535,086</u> |

Investment income for 2008 and 2007 is comprised of the following:

|                                   | <u>2008</u>    | <u>2007</u>    |
|-----------------------------------|----------------|----------------|
| Interest and dividends            | \$ 494,412     | \$ 527,623     |
| Realized gains                    | 44,040         | 25,082         |
| Change in unrealized appreciation | 43,399         | 311,792        |
| Investment expenses               | (13,229)       | (11,167)       |
|                                   | <u>568,622</u> | <u>853,330</u> |

**Functional Expenses:** The consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the consolidated statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services". Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including the group services staff assignment, the Box 459 newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French and Spanish speaking groups in North America. Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives and loners and overseas services.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which can not be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human resources and miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Fundraising costs are immaterial.

**Operating Expenses:** For purposes of the Statement of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

**Management Estimates:** The management of the Corporations uses estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that a change in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates can not be determined.

**Note 3 Retirement Plan:** The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible U.S. employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2% of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65% of average social security earnings multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social security offset can not reduce the gross benefit by more than 50%.

Pension expense has been recorded in accordance with SFAS 87 and 132 in which costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon factors which are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirements. In addition, SFAS 87 required, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon a comparison of the Plan's assets to its benefit obligations.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are recorded by the operating companies as an expense. The difference between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic pension cost under SFAS 87 is recorded by the Reserve Fund as an adjustment to retirement expense as a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

The following tables set forth the Plan's funded status, assumptions, benefit cost and payments and employer contributions for 2008:

|                                                                                 |                     |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Fair value of plan assets (at December 31)                                      | \$ 10,818,905       |
| Benefit obligation (at December 31)                                             | <u>18,920,904</u>   |
| Funded status                                                                   | <u>(8,101,999)</u>  |
| Accrued pension cost recognized in consolidated statement of financial position | <u>\$ 8,101,999</u> |
| Weighted-average assumptions (at December 31)                                   |                     |
| Discount rate                                                                   | 6.0%                |
| Expected return on plan assets (based on historical returns)                    | 9.0%                |
| Rate of compensation increase                                                   | 4.5%                |
| Accumulated benefit obligation                                                  | \$15,968,554        |
| Benefit cost                                                                    | \$ 581,901          |
| Employers' contributions                                                        | \$ 1,110,000        |
| Benefits paid                                                                   | \$ 852,268          |
| Classification of benefit costs:                                                |                     |
| Operating expense (cash funding)                                                | \$ 1,110,000        |
| Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost)                     | <u>(528,099)</u>    |
|                                                                                 | <u>581,901</u>      |

The expected benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

|             |            |
|-------------|------------|
| 2009        | \$ 996,000 |
| 2010        | 1,090,000  |
| 2011        | 1,024,000  |
| 2012        | 1,108,000  |
| 2013        | 1,159,000  |
| 2014 - 2018 | 6,788,000  |

The employers' contributions for 2009 are currently budget to be \$1,430,000.

|                                                            |               |
|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Plan assets at December 31, 2008 were composed as follows: |               |
| Domestic Equity Mutual Funds                               | 41.0%         |
| International Equity Mutual Funds                          | 8.4%          |
| Bond Mutual Funds                                          | 46.1%         |
| Cash and equivalents                                       | 4.5%          |
|                                                            | <u>100.0%</u> |

The mutual funds in the plan are primarily index funds designed to achieve diversification between fixed income and equity investments among asset classes including S&P 500, small capitalization companies and international stocks.

The Financial Accounting Standards Board issued Statement #158 in September 2006. This statement revised financial reporting by requiring an employer to recognize the overfunded or underfunded status of a defined benefit plan as an asset or liability in its statement of financial position. The statement became effective for 2007. As a result, an additional pension

liability of \$3,157,428 was recognized on the consolidated statement of activity for 2007.

**Note 4 Lease Commitments:** At December 31, 2008, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$471,128 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008 and extended on August 10, 2006 through December 31, 2018.

\$97,915 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008 and extended on August 10, 2006 through December 31, 2018.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 2008 is \$5,690,000 as follows:

|              |                  |
|--------------|------------------|
| 2009         | \$ 569,000       |
| 2010         | 569,000          |
| 2011         | 569,000          |
| 2012         | 569,000          |
| 2013         | 569,000          |
| 2014 to 2018 | <u>2,845,000</u> |
|              | <u>5,690,000</u> |

**Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits:** The Corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

For employees hired after January 1, 2004 there is a three-tier structure in the level of group medical insurance premiums paid for on behalf of employees who retire directly from GSO. For employees with 5-9 years of service the corporations will pay 25%, 10-15 years 50% and more than 15 years 75%.

The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 6.0%. A discount rate of 6.0% has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B.

Prior to 2006 the Plan was unfunded. However, as described in Note 1, a Postretirement Medical Fund was created by the Board with the purpose of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the postretirement health benefits liability after ten years.

The following table sets forth the information regarding the Plan for 2008:

|                                     |                   |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Benefit obligation (at December 31) | \$3,965,968       |
| Benefits paid                       | <u>\$ 177,102</u> |
| Benefit cost                        | <u>\$ 20,753</u>  |
| Benefit cost reported by:           |                   |
| Operating entities as funded        | \$ 428,102        |
| Postretirement Medical Fund         | <u>(407,349)</u>  |
|                                     | <u>20,753</u>     |

The expected postretirement benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

|             |            |
|-------------|------------|
| 2009        | \$ 187,728 |
| 2010        | 198,992    |
| 2011        | 210,932    |
| 2012        | 223,588    |
| 2013        | 237,003    |
| 2014 - 2018 | 1,416,166  |

**Note 6 Tax Status:** The Corporations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, and are classified as public charities. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.

# The Budget Highlights

## 2009 G.S.O. Budget

These budget highlights describe the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office—which comprises A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation) and the General Fund (Service activities)—and the Grapevine Operations. They exclude any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund, Convention Fund, Post Retirement Fund or the Capital Projects Fund.

**Income:** The 2009 budget projects gross sales of \$13,900,000. Unit sales are expected to be approximately flat when compared with 2008. The increase in revenue will be derived from an increase in selected selling prices effective July 1, 2009. While reviewing and recommending the 2009 budget, the A.A.W.S. Board considered that revenue and expense assumptions ultimately affect the long term fiscal health of the General Service Board and its Reserve Fund.

Manufacturing costs are budgeted approximately 6% higher than actual 2008 costs and even with the 2008 budget. While we are anticipating higher paper and manufacturing component costs, our publishing department has done a very good job shopping and negotiating. Royalties are budgeted at \$50,000 this year. There are only 2 remaining recipients.

Shipping and warehousing costs are budgeted approximately 6% higher than the 2008 results as well. The effect of oil prices on the 2009 results will be interesting to see.

After subtracting manufacturing costs, royalties and shipping expense, gross profit is budgeted at \$7,729,900 or 57%. Gross profit has been budgeted about \$780,000 greater than 2008, a direct result of the increase in prices. The 57% gross profit percentage anticipated for 2009 compares with 55.9% for 2008. It should be recognized that as we continue to strive to have literature available throughout our Service Structure in the Spanish and French languages as well as English, lower print runs in non English languages usually result in higher production costs. We strive to have the same selling prices regardless of the manufacturing cost. The result is that lower gross profit margins for low volume items affect the overall gross profit percentages.

The table below reflects the Gross Profit Percentages from 2006 through the estimated for 2009.

| 2006  | 2007  | 2008  | 2009 Budget |
|-------|-------|-------|-------------|
| 58.8% | 56.8% | 55.9% | 57.0%       |

Even though Contribution revenue has shown positive movement for the last several years, total budget and 2007 receipts as well. Your GSO was hit hard during the last quarter of 2008, as was the country at large. Prudence dictates that actions have been necessary to control costs and reinforce the revenue stream so as to provide sufficient funds to continue providing services. Trusted Servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations as well as assess the services supplied.

**Contributions:** Contributions received for the year 2008 were \$63,000 (1%) less than 2007. For 2009, contributions have been budgeted at \$6,500,000, an increase of approximately 1%.

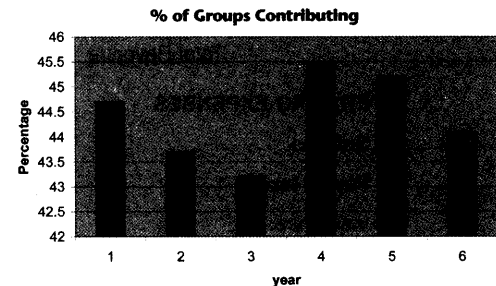
During 2008, contributions from groups and individuals of \$6,325,180 were \$203,000 (3%) less than budget and \$56,000 (1%) less than 2007. Contributions received from World Service Meeting countries toward the World Service Meeting International literature fund amounted to \$137,600, approximately \$7,000 less than 2007. In total, contributions received for 2008 were just over \$6,462,700.

The % of Groups Contributing chart reflects the approximate percentage of the AA groups that choose to list with the General Service Office that have participated in the 7<sup>th</sup> Tradition by contributing to the General Service Office.

Total Operating Revenue for the 2009 is anticipated at \$14,233,900, an increase of approximately \$800,000 due to the increase in selling prices.

Total Operating Expenses for 2009 have been budgeted at \$13,332,700, approximately \$360,000 or 2.6% less than 2008 expenses but even with the 2008 budget.

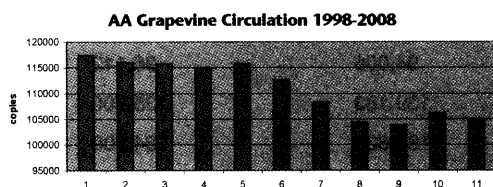
The 2009 G.S.O. budget anticipates an excess of revenue over expense for 2009 of \$900,000 and is intended to assist in maintaining the Reserve Fund at approximately a nine-month level. This compares with an actual loss of \$275,000 for 2008 and the 2008 adjusted net income of \$180,800.



## 2009 Grapevine Budget

The 2009 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation of 100,000, 7,000 copies less than the 2008 budget and approximately 5,000 copies less than the 2008 paid circulation of 104,993. Circulation for the last 11 years is depicted in the chart below.

**Income:** Magazine income of \$2,003,734 is expected, which is \$72,000 less than 2008. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$941,409, \$182,150 higher than 2008.



**Total Gross Profit:** Combining the magazine and other publishing items, a gross profit of \$1,705,728 is budgeted for 2009. This compares with \$1,740,417 achieved for 2008 and the 2008 budget of \$1,825,968.

**Total Operating Expenses:** Total Operating Expenses for 2009 are budgeted at \$1,939,286, \$5,800 less than the 2008 expenses of \$1,945,073.

**Net Income (loss):** For 2009 the Grapevine anticipates a loss of \$167,358. This compares with a 2008 budgeted profit of \$3,200 and an actual loss from operations of \$138,456.

## 2009 La Viña Budget

Following the 1995 General Service Conference Advisory Action #7, the publication of the Grapevine magazine in Spanish was approved by the Grapevine Board of Directors and the trustees' Finance Committee of the General Service Board. Recognizing this publication as a new venture, both boards were to review the financial impact on the Fellowship and the progress of circulation and continue to monitor the viability of this venture. In 2001 the General Service Board recommended and the 2001 Conference approved that the La Viña magazine continue to be published by the Grapevine but Funded by the General Service Boards, General Fund instead of continuing to draw funds from the Reserve Fund.

For 2009, La Viña expects a gross profit on the magazine of \$20,916, compared with \$22,611 achieved in 2008. Circulation for 2009 is estimated at 10,000, approximately 400 fewer than the 10,400 average for the year 2008 and 1,000 fewer than the 2008 budget. Other Publishing income is estimated at \$38,558, which after deducting cost of product of \$9,529, expects to contribute \$29,029 to revenue. Total costs and expenses are estimated at \$145,720 for 2009, approximately \$24,566 higher than 2008. The 2009 budget projects a net loss of \$95,775, \$19,500 higher than the 2008 loss of \$76,260. To date losses of approximately \$1,210,000 have been incurred.



## The General Service Office 2009 OPERATING BUDGET

| INCOME                                 | 2008 Budget  | 2008 Actual  | 2009 Budget  |
|----------------------------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|
| <b>GROSS SALES</b>                     | \$12,700,000 | \$12,777,333 | \$13,900,000 |
| Discounts allowed                      | 350,000      | 347,381      | 342,000      |
| <u>Net Sales</u>                       | 12,350,000   | 12,429,952   | 13,558,000   |
| Cost of Literature Distributed         |              |              |              |
| Manufacturing                          | 3,800,000    | 3,567,820    | 3,800,000    |
| Royalties                              | 52,000       | 51,097       | 50,000       |
| <u>Gross Margin</u>                    | 8,498,000    | 8,811,035    | 9,708,000    |
| <b>DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING</b> | 1,675,500    | 1,862,685    | 1,978,100    |
| <u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>    | 6,822,500    | 6,948,350    | 7,729,900    |
| Contributions Received                 | 6,675,000    | 6,462,760    | 6,500,000    |
| Interest Income                        | 10,000       | 5,758        | 4,000        |
| <u>Total Revenue</u>                   | 13,507,500   | 13,416,868   | 14,233,900   |
| <b>OPERATING EXPENSES</b>              |              |              |              |
| Salaries                               | \$5,414,250  | \$5,539,874  | \$5,253,000  |
| Payroll taxes                          | 374,000      | 393,760      | 394,000      |
| Insurance                              | 952,800      | 899,253      | 948,800      |
| Retirement expense                     | 1,313,500    | 1,316,789    | 1,607,000    |
| Other program printing                 | 475,200      | 491,750      | 443,203      |
| Mailing, labor, etc.                   | 130,700      | 132,686      | 132,500      |
| Postage & express                      | 440,000      | 496,454      | 444,500      |
| Writers' fees                          | 208,300      | 182,574      | 101,500      |
| Other literature assist                | 150,000      | 95,887       | 145,500      |
| Selling expenses                       | 173,050      | 254,439      | 238,000      |
| Professional fees                      | 208,500      | 161,798      | 163,500      |
| Contracted services                    | 881,000      | 918,799      | 842,000      |
| Occupancy                              | 755,509      | 725,509      | 744,200      |
| Telephone                              | 94,300       | 91,370       | 87,567       |
| Equipment maintenance                  | 94,200       | 94,006       | 96,142       |
| Furniture & equipment                  | 164,740      | 139,183      | 135,700      |
| Stationery & office expense            | 171,300      | 188,626      | 184,200      |
| Office service & expense               | 270,555      | 383,439      | 303,125      |
| Travel, meals, & accommodations        | 1,044,800    | 1,178,131    | 1,058,301    |
| Bad debts                              | 10,000       | 7,906        | 10,000       |
| TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES               | \$13,326,704 | \$13,692,233 | \$13,332,738 |
| <b>INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD</b>        | 180,796      | (275,365)    | 901,162      |

# The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

## 2009 BUDGET

|                                         | ENGLISH          |                  |                  | SPANISH        |                |                |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
|                                         | 2008 Budget      | 2008 Actual      | 2009 Budget      | 2008 Budget    | 2008 Actual    | 2009 Budget    |
| <b>PAID CIRCULATION —</b>               |                  |                  |                  |                |                |                |
| <b>AVERAGE # OF COPIES</b>              | <u>107,000</u>   | <u>104,993</u>   | <u>100,000</u>   | <u>11,000</u>  | <u>10,404</u>  | <u>10,000</u>  |
| <b>INCOME FROM MAGAZINE</b>             |                  |                  |                  |                |                |                |
| Subscription income                     | \$1,927,418      | \$1,905,401      | \$1,833,600      | \$84,286       | \$87,038       | \$84,000       |
| Single copies and back issues           | 84,617           | 96,934           | 96,934           | 17,865         | 7,589          | 11,513         |
| Digital Archives Project subs           | 47,426           | 51,495           | 51,600           |                |                |                |
| Audio Grapevine                         | 30,000           | 22,230           | 21,600           |                |                |                |
| <u>Total magazine income</u>            | <u>2,089,461</u> | <u>2,076,060</u> | <u>2,003,734</u> | <u>102,151</u> | <u>94,627</u>  | <u>95,513</u>  |
| <u>Total direct costs</u>               | <u>790,081</u>   | <u>826,840</u>   | <u>931,975</u>   | <u>67,293</u>  | <u>72,016</u>  | <u>74,597</u>  |
| <b>Gross Profit on Magazine</b>         | <u>1,299,380</u> | <u>1,249,220</u> | <u>1,071,759</u> | <u>34,858</u>  | <u>22,611</u>  | <u>20,916</u>  |
| <b>OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME</b>          | 812,719          | 759,259          | 941,409          | 40,800         | 30,008         | 38,558         |
| <u>Total direct costs</u>               | <u>286,131</u>   | <u>268,062</u>   | <u>307,440</u>   | <u>10,500</u>  | <u>7,729</u>   | <u>9,529</u>   |
| <b>Gross Profit on Special Items</b>    | <u>526,588</u>   | <u>491,197</u>   | <u>633,969</u>   | <u>30,300</u>  | <u>22,279</u>  | <u>29,029</u>  |
| <b>Total Gross Profit</b>               | <u>1,825,968</u> | <u>1,740,417</u> | <u>1,705,728</u> | <u>65,158</u>  | <u>44,890</u>  | <u>49,945</u>  |
| <b>COSTS AND EXPENSES</b>               |                  |                  |                  |                |                |                |
| <b>EDITORIAL COSTS</b>                  |                  |                  |                  |                |                |                |
| Salaries, including temporary help      | 318,641          | 305,054          | 331,969          | 58,300         | 56,252         | 57,000         |
| Payroll taxes and benefits              | 126,053          | 135,634          | 162,538          | 19,481         | 10,712         | 26,085         |
| Occupancy costs                         | 80,408           | 70,301           | 73,774           | 343            | 4,373          | 4,373          |
| Office supplies and expenses            | 25,248           | 32,532           | 21,718           |                |                |                |
| Magazine Redesign                       | 25,000           | 24,000           |                  |                |                |                |
| Product development & Web               | 45,909           | 32,697           | 77,309           |                |                |                |
| <u>Total Editorial</u>                  | <u>621,259</u>   | <u>600,218</u>   | <u>667,308</u>   | <u>78,124</u>  | <u>71,337</u>  | <u>87,458</u>  |
| <b>CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS</b>         |                  |                  |                  |                |                |                |
| Salaries, including temporary help      | 483,552          | 488,948          | 450,084          | 23,400         | 21,292         | 24,148         |
| Payroll taxes and benefits              | 172,544          | 164,437          | 191,104          | 2,332          | 2,925          | 2,964          |
| Kable fulfillment                       | 143,424          | 137,042          | 139,783          | 10,496         | 11,118         | 11,340         |
| Occupancy costs                         | 75,234           | 70,141           | 73,648           |                |                |                |
| Office supplies and expenses            | 55,331           | 72,248           | 62,248           |                |                |                |
| Selling expense-regular                 | 128,000          | 118,665          | 136,900          | 10,775         | 8,877          | 15,175         |
| - GvR program                           | 24,700           | 14,593           | 23,400           | 511            | 250            | 265            |
| Postage                                 | 6,780            | 4,319            | 4,578            |                |                |                |
| <u>Total Circulation and Business</u>   | <u>1,089,565</u> | <u>1,070,393</u> | <u>1,081,745</u> | <u>47,514</u>  | <u>44,462</u>  | <u>53,892</u>  |
| <b>GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE</b>       |                  |                  |                  |                |                |                |
| Computer Consulting                     | 32,096           | 29,668           | 39,910           |                |                |                |
| Severance payments                      |                  | 32,000           |                  |                |                |                |
| Insurance                               | 6,926            | 7,331            | 7,331            |                |                |                |
| Professional fees                       | 45,456           | 90,835           | 54,000           | 2,000          | 360            | 360            |
| Meetings and conferences                | 64,552           | 64,927           | 41,646           | 3,500          | 4,485          | 3,500          |
| Furniture and equipment                 | 8,783            | 11,282           | 11,282           | 1,009          | 235            | 235            |
| Canadian exchange and other             | 1,000            | 11,444           | 8,828            |                |                |                |
| Bank service charges                    | 9,000            | 8,694            | 8,955            |                |                |                |
| Bad debts                               | 16,904           | 18,281           | 18,281           | 382            | 275            | 275            |
| <u>Total General and Administrative</u> | <u>184,717</u>   | <u>274,462</u>   | <u>190,233</u>   | <u>6,891</u>   | <u>5,355</u>   | <u>4,370</u>   |
| <b>TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES</b>         | <u>1,895,541</u> | <u>1,945,073</u> | <u>1,939,286</u> | <u>132,529</u> | <u>121,154</u> | <u>145,720</u> |
| Interest earned                         | <u>72,779</u>    | <u>66,200</u>    | <u>66,200</u>    |                |                |                |
| <b>NET INCOME (Loss) FOR PERIOD</b>     | <u>3,206</u>     | <u>-138,456</u>  | <u>-167,358</u>  | <u>-67,371</u> | <u>-76,264</u> | <u>-95,775</u> |

# 2008 Contributions From Groups, Individuals, Specials, Special Meetings — by Delegate Area (in U.S. Dollars)

| AREA # | GENERAL SERVICE<br>CONFERENCE AREA | #GPS.<br>REPORTED | #GPS.<br>CONTRIB. | % OF GPS.<br>CONTRIB. | TOTAL GROUP<br>CONTRIB. | MEMBERSHIP | CONTRIBUTION<br>PER CAPITA | INDIVIDUAL<br>MEMBERS | MEMORIAL | SPECIALS <sup>(1)</sup> | SPECIAL<br>MEETINGS <sup>(2)</sup> | TOTAL AREA<br>CONTRIBUTIONS | PER<br>CAPITA |
|--------|------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------|------------|----------------------------|-----------------------|----------|-------------------------|------------------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------|
| 1.     | Ala./N.W. Fla.                     | 434               | 216               | 49.8%                 | 51,015                  | 9,299      | \$5.48                     | 2,199                 |          | 1,086                   | 93                                 | \$54,392.00                 | \$5.85        |
| 2.     | Alaska                             | 187               | 87                | 46.5                  | 16,401                  | 3,181      | 5.16                       | 1,720                 |          | 1,199                   |                                    | \$19,319.08                 | \$6.07        |
| 3.     | Arizona                            | 983               | 450               | 45.7                  | 114,250                 | 22,960     | 4.98                       | 5,646                 | 1,625    | 3,287                   | 44                                 | \$124,852.61                | \$5.44        |
| 4.     | Arkansas                           | 261               | 132               | 50.5                  | 23,275                  | 4,660      | 4.98                       | 391                   |          | 2,633                   |                                    | \$26,299.08                 | \$5.64        |
|        | <b>California</b>                  |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                            |                       |          |                         |                                    |                             |               |
| 5.     | Southern                           | 1,208             | 391               | 32.3                  | 121,017                 | 42,115     | 2.86                       | 9,007                 | 2,000    | 2,637                   | 315                                | \$134,976.54                | \$3.20        |
| 6.     | N. Coastal                         | 1,843             | 1,074             | 58.2                  | 286,246                 | 57,089     | 5.01                       | 13,728                | 3,100    | 1,880                   | 399                                | \$305,353.69                | \$5.35        |
| 7.     | N. Interior                        | 865               | 416               | 48.0                  | 84,336                  | 24,949     | 3.38                       | 5,079                 | 80       | 2,054                   | 100                                | \$91,649.62                 | \$3.67        |
| 8.     | San Diego/Imp.                     | 899               | 384               | 42.6                  | 78,620                  | 26,032     | 3.02                       | 3,185                 | 4,000    | 3,005                   | 502                                | \$89,312.66                 | \$3.43        |
| 9.     | Mid-South.                         | 1,809             | 778               | 43.0                  | 182,496                 | 57,709     | 3.16                       | 10,673                |          | 7,433                   | 646                                | \$201,248.46                | \$3.49        |
| 10.    | Colorado                           | 738               | 390               | 52.8                  | 107,830                 | 17,709     | 6.08                       | 7,110                 | 2,020    | 13,539                  | 273                                | \$130,772.36                | \$7.38        |
| 11.    | Connecticut                        | 1,568             | 634               | 40.3                  | 132,076                 | 38,989     | 3.39                       | 12,123                | 320      | 17,932                  | 314                                | \$162,765.78                | \$4.17        |
| 12.    | Delaware                           | 229               | 124               | 54.0                  | 36,160                  | 3,521      | 10.27                      | 115                   | 100      | 970                     |                                    | \$37,345.12                 | \$10.61       |
| 13.    | D.C.                               | 473               | 213               | 44.9                  | 56,945                  | 14,503     | 3.93                       | 560                   |          | 1,669                   |                                    | \$59,174.66                 | \$4.08        |
|        | <b>Florida</b>                     |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                            |                       |          |                         |                                    |                             |               |
| 14.    | North                              | 860               | 408               | 47.3                  | 92,912                  | 18,442     | 5.03                       | 11,469                | 100      | 18,155                  | 30                                 | \$122,665.79                | \$6.65        |
| 15.    | South/                             | 1,800             | 873               | 48.5                  | 203,923                 | 39,110     | 5.21                       | 16,194                | 2,200    | 30,801                  | 217                                | \$253,335.66                | \$6.48        |
| 16.    | Georgia                            | 712               | 433               | 60.8                  | 100,345                 | 17,018     | 5.90                       | 8,010                 | 1,000    | 2,638                   | 139                                | \$112,131.85                | \$6.59        |
| 17.    | Hawaii                             | 314               | 168               | 53.4                  | 37,926                  | 5,097      | 7.43                       | 665                   |          | 858                     | 86                                 | \$39,534.73                 | \$7.76        |
| 18.    | Idaho                              | 228               | 109               | 47.8                  | 20,779                  | 4,705      | 4.41                       | 361                   |          | 2,406                   | 35                                 | \$23,581.84                 | \$5.01        |
|        | <b>Illinois</b>                    |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                            |                       |          |                         |                                    |                             |               |
| 19.    | Chicago                            | 1,212             | 302               | 24.9                  | 86,048                  | 29,300     | 2.93                       | 2,386                 | 5        | 9,784                   | 50                                 | \$98,273.59                 | \$3.35        |
| 20.    | North                              | 1,112             | 448               | 40.3                  | 71,681                  | 22,750     | 3.14                       | 4,509                 | 2,000    | 17,879                  | 129                                | \$96,197.82                 | \$4.23        |
| 21.    | South                              | 449               | 155               | 34.4                  | 26,716                  | 8,387      | 3.18                       | 176                   | 3,025    | 573                     | 42                                 | \$30,531.78                 | \$3.64        |
|        | <b>Indiana</b>                     |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                            |                       |          |                         |                                    |                             |               |
| 22.    | North                              | 626               | 247               | 39.5                  | 33,342                  | 9,286      | 3.59                       | 702                   | 1,025    | 1,385                   | 15                                 | \$36,470.17                 | \$3.93        |
| 23.    | South                              | 648               | 275               | 42.4                  | 38,869                  | 11,745     | 3.31                       | 334                   |          | 276                     | 60                                 | \$39,539.69                 | \$3.37        |
| 24.    | Iowa                               | 650               | 274               | 42.2                  | 42,256                  | 13,605     | 3.10                       | 497                   |          | 30                      | 312                                | \$43,094.74                 | \$3.17        |
| 25.    | Kansas                             | 380               | 185               | 48.7                  | 35,843                  | 9,792      | 3.65                       | 361                   | 300      | 6,169                   |                                    | \$42,673.99                 | \$4.36        |
| 26.    | Kentucky                           | 675               | 294               | 43.5                  | 76,134                  | 11,008     | 6.92                       | 4,334                 |          | 3,988                   | 25                                 | \$84,481.39                 | \$7.67        |
| 27.    | Louisiana                          | 451               | 160               | 35.4                  | 35,546                  | 9,356      | 3.79                       | 1,888                 |          |                         |                                    | \$37,434.21                 | \$4.00        |
| 28.    | Maine                              | 508               | 155               | 30.4                  | 17,338                  | 8,353      | 2.07                       | 3,403                 | 10       | 4,717                   | 120                                | \$25,588.05                 | \$3.06        |
| 29.    | Maryland                           | 1,009             | 412               | 40.7                  | 83,330                  | 16,108     | 5.16                       | 2,958                 | 115      | 2,095                   | 3,182                              | \$91,679.76                 | \$5.69        |
|        | <b>Massachusetts</b>               |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                            |                       |          |                         |                                    |                             |               |
| 30.    | East                               | 1,388             | 528               | 37.9                  | 129,318                 | 46,858     | 2.75                       | 5,946                 |          | 971                     |                                    | \$136,235.91                | \$2.91        |
| 31.    | West                               | 296               | 152               | 51.3                  | 21,216                  | 5,327      | 3.97                       | 1,051                 |          |                         |                                    | \$22,267.29                 | \$4.18        |
|        | <b>Michigan</b>                    |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                            |                       |          |                         |                                    |                             |               |
| 32.    | Central                            | 628               | 262               | 41.6                  | 42,331                  | 13,461     | 3.14                       | 1,973                 |          | 1,370                   | 25                                 | \$45,699.83                 | \$3.39        |
| 33.    | Southeast                          | 888               | 294               | 33.0                  | 58,339                  | 20,363     | 2.86                       | 2,054                 | 6,075    | 279                     |                                    | \$66,746.57                 | \$3.28        |
| 34.    | West                               | 560               | 213               | 37.9                  | 39,479                  | 11,813     | 3.33                       | 1,671                 | 1,861    | 7,227                   | 170                                | \$50,408.87                 | \$4.27        |
|        | <b>Minnesota</b>                   |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                            |                       |          |                         |                                    |                             |               |
| 35.    | North                              | 555               | 232               | 41.8                  | 25,546                  | 8,746      | 2.91                       | 1,437                 |          | 475                     |                                    | \$27,458.30                 | \$3.14        |
| 36.    | South                              | 1,103             | 449               | 40.7                  | 93,767                  | 27,326     | 3.43                       | 1,021                 | 20       | 5,924                   | 129                                | \$100,860.77                | \$3.69        |
| 37.    | Mississippi                        | 229               | 95                | 41.5                  | 23,366                  | 4,648      | 5.03                       | 175                   |          | 1,930                   |                                    | \$25,470.80                 | \$5.48        |
|        | <b>Missouri</b>                    |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                            |                       |          |                         |                                    |                             |               |
| 38.    | East                               | 537               | 218               | 40.5                  | 45,543                  | 8,919      | 5.11                       | 4,447                 | 43       | 1,823                   |                                    | \$51,856.11                 | \$5.81        |
| 39.    | West                               | 233               | 116               | 49.7                  | 21,510                  | 6,976      | 3.08                       | 38                    | 100      | 56                      | 10                                 | \$21,713.86                 | \$3.11        |
| 40.    | Montana                            | 285               | 128               | 44.8                  | 29,320                  | 4,995      | 5.87                       | 1,497                 |          | 533                     |                                    | \$31,350.17                 | \$6.28        |
| 41.    | Nebraska                           | 707               | 315               | 44.5                  | 55,084                  | 16,110     | 3.41                       | 826                   |          | 685                     | 125                                | \$56,719.93                 | \$3.52        |
| 42.    | Nevada                             | 523               | 194               | 37.1                  | 39,792                  | 12,477     | 3.18                       | 3,407                 |          | 1,841                   | 6                                  | \$45,045.68                 | \$3.61        |
| 43.    | New Hampshire                      | 600               | 250               | 41.7                  | 35,282                  | 11,283     | 3.13                       | 909                   | 125      | 2,397                   |                                    | \$38,713.36                 | \$3.43        |
|        | <b>New Jersey</b>                  |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                            |                       |          |                         |                                    |                             |               |
| 44.    | North                              | 1,265             | 583               | 46.1                  | 124,144                 | 31,080     | 3.98                       | 12,714                | 5,450    | 2,904                   | 102                                | \$145,314.14                | \$4.68        |
| 45.    | South                              | 514               | 262               | 51.0                  | 73,307                  | 8,780      | 8.35                       | 1,664                 | 552      | 7,099                   | 300                                | \$82,921.19                 | \$9.44        |
| 46.    | New Mexico                         | 381               | 178               | 46.6                  | 36,924                  | 6,689      | 5.51                       | 2,273                 |          | 6,082                   | 230                                | \$45,509.93                 | \$6.80        |
|        | <b>New York</b>                    |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                            |                       |          |                         |                                    |                             |               |
| 47.    | Central                            | 723               | 253               | 34.9                  | 43,948                  | 12,193     | 3.59                       | 1,957                 | 3,310    | 1,816                   | 7                                  | \$51,038.34                 | \$4.19        |
| 48.    | H./M./B.                           | 777               | 288               | 37.1                  | 26,782                  | 11,244     | 2.38                       | 961                   |          | 5,017                   |                                    | \$32,760.13                 | \$2.91        |
| 49.    | Southeast                          | 1,762             | 734               | 41.6                  | 220,713                 | 56,310     | 3.92                       | 13,446                | 2,879    | 5,065                   | 100                                | \$242,203.09                | \$4.30        |
| 50.    | West                               | 352               | 90                | 25.5                  | 14,560                  | 5,827      | 2.49                       | 162                   |          |                         | 29                                 | \$14,750.74                 | \$2.53        |
| 51.    | N. Carolina                        | 994               | 492               | 49.4                  | 113,616                 | 16,524     | 6.87                       | 4,998                 |          | 2,493                   |                                    | \$121,106.60                | \$7.33        |
| 52.    | North Dakota                       | 151               | 83                | 54.9                  | 15,138                  | 3,309      | 4.56                       | 301                   | 25       | 2,397                   |                                    | \$17,861.18                 | \$5.40        |
|        | <b>Ohio</b>                        |                   |                   |                       |                         |            |                            |                       |          |                         |                                    |                             |               |
| 53.    | Cent. & S.E.                       | 754               | 201               | 26.7                  | 28,076                  | 10,649     | 2.64                       | 1,603                 |          | 1,194                   |                                    | \$30,874.07                 | \$2.90        |
| 54.    | Northeast                          | 1,458             | 349               | 23.9                  | 43,329                  | 20,613     | 2.09                       | 979                   | 4,095    | 2,500                   | 80                                 | \$50,983.06                 | \$2.47        |
| 55.    | N.W. Ohio/<br>S.E. Mich.           | 307               | 109               | 35.4                  | 14,700                  | 4,431      | 3.31                       | 17                    |          | 100                     |                                    | \$14,817.35                 | \$3.34        |
| 56.    | S.W. Ohio                          | 552               | 249               | 45.0                  | 44,841                  | 10,337     | 4.33                       | 342                   | 100      | 571                     | 55                                 | \$45,909.04                 | \$4.44        |
| 57.    | Oklahoma                           | 391               | 204               | 52.1                  | 38,239                  | 7,928      | 4.81                       | 496                   |          | 2,315                   |                                    | \$41,050.13                 | \$5.18        |
| 58.    | Oregon                             | 1,013             | 406               | 40.1                  | 84,781                  | 19,723     | 4.29                       | 2,910                 | 1,020    | 3,711                   | 141                                | \$92,563.11                 | \$4.69        |

|                                             |                          |        |        |      |                 |           |      |               |             |              |              |                 |         |                |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------|--------|------|-----------------|-----------|------|---------------|-------------|--------------|--------------|-----------------|---------|----------------|
| Pennsylvania                                |                          |        |        |      |                 |           |      |               |             |              |              |                 |         |                |
| 59.                                         | East                     | 1,480  | 750    | 50.7 | 175,361         | 37,180    | 4.71 | 9,969         | 2,584       | 9,952        | 205          | \$198,070.66    | \$5.33  |                |
| 60.                                         | West                     | 842    | 393    | 46.7 | 56,074          | 11,937    | 4.69 | 1,153         | 25          | 1,198        |              | \$58,450.68     | \$4.90  |                |
| 61.                                         | Rhode Island             | 259    | 108    | 41.6 | 26,934          | 5,450     | 4.93 | 519           |             | 7,494        |              | \$34,947.18     | \$6.41  |                |
| 62.                                         | South Carolina           | 336    | 195    | 57.9 | 56,807          | 8,427     | 6.73 | 265           |             | 8,346        |              | \$65,418.35     | \$7.76  |                |
| 63.                                         | South Dakota             | 179    | 75     | 41.9 | 10,600          | 5,227     | 2.02 | 9             |             | 735          |              | \$11,343.86     | \$2.17  |                |
| 64.                                         | Tennessee                | 553    | 254    | 45.8 | 54,346          | 12,971    | 4.19 | 5,362         |             | 2,381        | 505          | \$62,594.29     | \$4.83  |                |
| Texas                                       |                          |        |        |      |                 |           |      |               |             |              |              |                 |         |                |
| 65.                                         | Northeast                | 470    | 203    | 43.1 | 81,915          | 20,323    | 4.03 | 4,250         |             | 1,740        | 160          | \$88,064.54     | \$4.33  |                |
| 66.                                         | Northwest                | 223    | 71     | 31.7 | 16,478          | 5,662     | 2.90 | 213           |             | 3,963        |              | \$20,653.68     | \$3.65  |                |
| 67.                                         | Southeast                | 586    | 269    | 45.9 | 60,405          | 16,879    | 3.57 | 7,013         | 875         | 4,712        |              | \$73,004.67     | \$4.33  |                |
| 68.                                         | Southwest                | 550    | 240    | 43.5 | 74,199          | 13,287    | 5.57 | 3,608         |             | 4,505        |              | \$82,313.17     | \$6.20  |                |
| 69.                                         | Utah                     | 288    | 169    | 58.6 | 34,588          | 6,025     | 5.74 | 832           |             | 861          | 60           | \$36,341.72     | \$6.03  |                |
| 70.                                         | Vermont                  | 267    | 102    | 38.1 | 17,088          | 4,633     | 3.69 | 10,804        |             | 575          |              | \$28,466.23     | \$6.14  |                |
| 71.                                         | Virginia                 | 1,268  | 664    | 52.3 | 137,130         | 23,539    | 5.82 | 5,237         | 20          | 2,357        | 140          | \$144,884.12    | \$6.16  |                |
| 72.                                         | Western Washington       | 1,287  | 586    | 45.5 | 132,189         | 27,898    | 4.73 | 8,147         | 1,000       | 8,881        | 40           | \$150,256.66    | \$5.39  |                |
| 73.                                         | West Virginia            | 319    | 132    | 41.4 | 14,313          | 3,471     | 4.12 | 234           |             | 1,409        |              | \$15,956.22     | \$4.60  |                |
| Wisconsin                                   |                          |        |        |      |                 |           |      |               |             |              |              |                 |         |                |
| 74.                                         | N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich. | 668    | 272    | 40.7 | 30,561          | 10,195    | 2.99 | 1,962         | 325         | 281          |              | \$33,129.11     | \$3.25  |                |
| 75.                                         | South                    | 984    | 417    | 42.4 | 50,447          | 18,389    | 2.74 | 260           |             | 265          |              | \$50,971.87     | \$2.77  |                |
| 76.                                         | Wyoming                  | 113    | 61     | 54.0 | 14,188          | 2,078     | 6.82 | 758           |             | 1,051        |              | \$15,997.34     | \$7.70  |                |
| 77.                                         | Puerto Rico              | 118    | 71     | 60.2 | 7,792           | 1,235     | 6.31 | 35            |             | 571          | 125          | \$8,523.61      | \$6.90  |                |
| 78.                                         | Alberta/N.W.T.           | 513    | 258    | 50.3 | 85,083          | 8,565     | 9.93 | 3,084         |             | 4,745        | 94           | \$93,006.25     | \$10.86 |                |
| 79.                                         | B.C./Yukon               | 752    | 400    | 53.2 | 111,621         | 14,508    | 7.68 | 636           |             | 5,784        | 122          | \$118,162.64    | \$8.14  |                |
| 80.                                         | Manitoba                 | 151    | 45     | 29.8 | 13,519          | 3,909     | 3.46 |               |             | 344          |              | \$13,863.20     | \$3.55  |                |
| 81.                                         | N.B./P.E.I.              | 190    | 94     | 49.4 | 14,623          | 3,443     | 4.25 |               |             | 365          | 487          | \$15,474.11     | \$4.49  |                |
| 82.                                         | N.S./Nfld./Lab.          | 239    | 113    | 47.3 | 17,501          | 3,273     | 5.35 | 202           |             | 3,952        |              | \$21,654.84     | \$6.62  |                |
| Ontario                                     |                          |        |        |      |                 |           |      |               |             |              |              |                 |         |                |
| 83.                                         | East                     | 552    | 221    | 39.9 | 59,453          | 14,172    | 4.19 | 1,281         |             | 8,467        | 679          | \$69,880.15     | \$4.93  |                |
| 84.                                         | Northeast                | 157    | 60     | 38.1 | 12,860          | 1,898     | 6.78 | 105           |             | 1,906        |              | \$14,870.97     | \$7.84  |                |
| 85.                                         | Northwest                | 71     | 17     | 23.9 | 4,869           | 1,080     | 4.50 | 69            |             | 767          |              | \$5,705.74      | \$5.28  |                |
| 86.                                         | West (3)                 | 562    | 238    | 42.3 | 62,911          | 10,618    | 5.92 | 175           | 150         | 26,294       | 633          | \$90,163.17     | \$8.49  |                |
| Quebec                                      |                          |        |        |      |                 |           |      |               |             |              |              |                 |         |                |
| 87.                                         | Southwest                | 530    | 450    | 84.8 | 16,952          | 13,418    | 1.25 | 2,899         |             | 13,223       |              | \$33,073.48     | \$2.46  |                |
| 88.                                         | Southeast                | 190    | 152    | 80.0 | 930             | 3,063     | 0.29 | 639           |             | 11,052       |              | \$12,620.90     | \$4.12  |                |
| 89.                                         | Northeast                | 307    | 277    | 90.1 | 1,168           | 6,089     | 0.18 | 892           |             | 42,003       |              | \$44,063.25     | \$7.24  |                |
| 90.                                         | Northwest                | 354    | 337    | 95.1 | 2,458           | 6,476     | 0.37 | 1,253         |             | 57,470       |              | \$61,180.91     | \$9.45  |                |
| 91.                                         | Saskatchewan             | 281    | 118    | 42.0 | 20,454          | 3,474     | 5.89 | 419           |             | 4,239        |              | \$25,112.17     | \$7.23  |                |
| 92.                                         | Washington East          | 473    | 196    | 41.4 | 31,300          | 6,361     | 4.91 | 940           |             | 503          |              | \$32,742.82     | \$5.15  |                |
| 93.                                         | Central Calif            | 924    | 397    | 43.0 | 96,998          | 25,510    | 3.79 | 5,236         | 50          | 3,781        | 390          | \$106,455.82    | \$4.17  |                |
|                                             | Total U.S./Canada        | 60,093 | 26,519 | 44.1 | \$ 5,480,770.92 | 1,342,380 | 4.08 | \$ 279,520.54 | \$53,709.55 | \$476,026.41 | \$ 12,277.23 | \$ 6,302,304.65 | \$4.69  |                |
| Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings |                          |        |        |      | \$345,507.32    |           |      |               |             |              |              |                 |         |                |
| Specials                                    |                          |        |        |      | \$476,026.41    |           |      |               |             |              |              |                 |         |                |
| Total for U.S. & Canada                     |                          |        |        |      | \$6,302,304.65  |           |      |               |             |              |              |                 |         |                |
| FOREIGN AND OTHER                           |                          |        |        |      |                 |           |      |               |             |              |              |                 |         |                |
| On Line Meetings                            |                          |        |        |      |                 |           |      |               |             |              | \$917.35     |                 |         |                |
| Correctional & Hospital facility groups     |                          |        |        |      |                 |           |      |               |             |              | \$231.63     |                 |         |                |
| Foreign                                     |                          |        |        |      |                 |           |      |               |             |              | \$154,433.03 |                 |         |                |
| Internationalists                           |                          |        |        |      |                 |           |      |               |             |              | \$10.00      |                 |         |                |
| International Doctors in A.A.               |                          |        |        |      |                 |           |      |               |             |              | \$3,000.00   |                 |         |                |
| International Lawyers in A.A.               |                          |        |        |      |                 |           |      |               |             |              | \$1,254.66   |                 |         |                |
| Loners                                      |                          |        |        |      |                 |           |      |               |             |              | \$608.33     |                 |         |                |
| Grand Total                                 |                          |        |        |      | \$6,302,304.65  |           |      |               |             |              |              |                 |         | \$6,462,759.65 |

#### CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON - 2008-2007 (in U.S. dollars)

|                       | #GPS.<br>REPORTED | #GPS.<br>CONTRIB. | % OF GPS.<br>CONTRIB. | TOTAL GROUP<br>CONTRIB. | MEMBERSHIP | CONTRIBUTIONS<br>PER CAPITA | TOTAL PER CAPITA<br>INCLUDING<br>SPECIALS ETC |                                  |        |        |
|-----------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------|------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------|--------|
| U.S. & Canada<br>2008 | 60,093            | 26,519            | 44.1%                 | \$5,480,770.92          | 1,342,380  | \$4.08                      | \$4.69                                        |                                  |        |        |
| U.S. & Canada<br>2007 | 58,340            | 26,389            | 45.2%                 | \$5,370,330.43          | 1,314,552  | \$4.09                      | \$4.82                                        | 2008                             | 2007   |        |
| Increase (Decrease)   | 1,753             | 130               | -1.1%                 | \$110,440.49            | 27,828     | (\$0.01)                    | (\$0.13)                                      | EST. COST OF SERVICES PER CAPITA | \$7.04 | \$6.49 |

(1) A Special contribution is one that comes from any number of entities that is not an AA Group. For example, a Conference, a Committee, an Area, a District, an Intergroup, etc.

(2) A Special Meeting is a meeting that does not want to be a group but does want to contribute to the General Service Board.

(3) Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed through their Conference Areas (per info from areas)

# 2009 Conference Committees

## Conference Agenda

<sup>2</sup>Martin Aire  
Quinn Gross  
Torvald Hansen  
Mike Kimling  
<sup>1</sup>Joan Ramsey  
Monte Stokes  
John Teupel  
Irma Van De Bon  
Tom Zamaria  
*Secretary:* Doug Richardson

## Cooperation With the Professional Community

Ken Clark  
<sup>1</sup>Al Davenport  
Alain Desbiens  
<sup>2</sup>Barbara Frizzell  
Betsy Gerber  
Ruben Gonzalez  
John Johnson  
John Zidarín  
*Secretary:* Mary Dargan

## Corrections

<sup>2</sup>Dodie Ash  
Joe Barrett  
Rick Carter  
Elaine Gaisey  
Elizabeth Martin  
Réal Normandin  
J.G. Regnier  
<sup>1</sup>Kevin Short  
*Secretary:* Gayle Solheim Riese

## Finance

Dave Bruha  
Fred Ellis  
Danny Fitzgerald  
Jim Foley  
<sup>2</sup>Gail Nelson  
Chet Parker  
Richard Sime  
JoAnne Taylor  
<sup>1</sup>Suzanne Welham  
*Secretary:* Donald Meurer

## Grapevine

Jimmy Dean  
<sup>1</sup>David Fox  
Lori Geistlinger  
Gregg King  
Judy Lavezzi  
Mike Peery  
Bob Williams  
Ginette Williams  
<sup>2</sup>\*Frank Ziemba  
*Secretary:* Amber Eden

## Literature

David Adelhart  
<sup>2</sup>Hari Boggs  
Andrew Coyne  
Derek Daniel  
Vada Good  
Helen Hill  
Jeff Johnson  
Lorna O'Connor  
<sup>1</sup>Leon Roberts  
*Secretary:* Eva Sanchez

## Policy/Admissions

Scott Ahlgren  
Cheryl Akin  
Cathie Feenie  
Robert Hill  
Cathie Jones  
<sup>1</sup>Bruce Kesi  
<sup>2</sup>Rad Miller  
Barbara Simington  
*Secretary:* Adrienne Brown

## Public Information

John Antol  
Carole Boerner  
Jason Carter  
<sup>2</sup>John Conway  
Ross Drinen  
Jean Smythe  
<sup>1</sup>Sally Spencer  
Ralph Trigg  
*Secretary:* Irene Kontje

## Report and Charter

Deborah Attix  
Brooke Collins  
Billy Corbett  
<sup>1</sup>Kathi Davis  
Stu Elwing  
Lowell Long  
<sup>2</sup>David Morgan  
David Noll  
*Secretary:* Mary Clare Lynch

## Treatment Facilities

Ken Bird  
<sup>1</sup>Sylvain LeLièvre  
JoAnne Nelson  
Antonio Rodriguez  
Bonnie Smith  
Dean Strassner  
Dave Tully  
<sup>2</sup>Dennis Wilson  
*Secretary:* Warren Stafford

## Trustees

John Howland  
Kathy O'Shea  
<sup>1</sup>Michalene Reilly  
<sup>2</sup>Tom Revelle  
Sandy Smith  
Marty Watters  
Lee Wilson  
Lisa Wilson  
Steve Yocum  
*Secretary:* Valerie O'Neill

## <sup>3</sup>Archives

<sup>2</sup>Dave Bruha  
Bill Corbett  
Vada Good  
Torvald Hansen  
Réal Normandin  
Lorna O'Connor  
Michalene Reilly  
<sup>1</sup>Ralph Trigg  
Tom Zamaria  
*Secretary:* Michelle Mirza

## <sup>3</sup>International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Scott Ahlgren  
Alain Desbiens  
Elaine Gaisey  
<sup>2</sup>John Johnson  
Bruce Kesi  
Elizabeth Martin  
<sup>1</sup>David Morgan  
Suzanne Welham  
*Secretary:* Rick Walker

## 2010 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS<sup>4</sup>

| Committee                                        | Chairperson                           |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Agenda                                           | Tom Zamaria, Virginia                 |
| Cooperation With the Professional Community      | Ken Clark, South Florida              |
| Corrections                                      | Rick Carter, Iowa                     |
| Finance                                          | Danny Fitzgerald, Northeast Ohio      |
| Grapevine                                        | Jimmy Dean, Northeast Texas           |
| Literature                                       | Derek Daniel, Southeast Michigan      |
| Policy/Admissions                                | Scott Ahlgren, South Minnesota        |
| Public Information                               | Carole Boerner, Montana               |
| Report and Charter                               | Deborah Attix, North Carolina         |
| Treatment                                        | Ken Bird, Connecticut                 |
| Trustees                                         | Marty Watters, British Columbia/Yukon |
| <sup>3</sup> Archives                            | Lorna O'Connor, North Dakota          |
| <sup>3</sup> International Conv./Regional Forums | Elizabeth Martin, Hawaii              |

## Alternate

Quinn Grose, Western Missouri  
Alain Desbiens, Northern Quebec  
Réal Normandin, Southeast Quebec  
Chet Parker, North Florida  
Judy Lavezzi, Colorado  
Jeff Johnson, Central California  
Barbara Simington, Northern Indiana  
Jason Carter, Nevada  
David Noll, Northern California  
Dave Tully, Western Washington  
John Howland, Eastern Massachusetts  
Billy Corbett, Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador  
Elaine Gaisey, District of Columbia

<sup>1</sup>Chairperson

<sup>2</sup>Alternate Chairperson

<sup>3</sup>Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

<sup>4</sup>The 2009 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 58th General Service Conference.

\*Alternate delegate, replacing Joe Schranck, who died.

# 2009 Trustees' Committees\*\*

## Archives

Conley Byrd, *chairperson*  
Ginger Bell  
Bill Clark  
Howard Lowery  
George Martin  
Ray Massey  
Vic Phillips  
Michelle Mirza, *acting secretary*

## Audit

Howard Lowery, *chairperson*  
Terry Bedient  
Herb Goodman  
Madeleine Parmley  
John Skilton  
Don Meurer, *secretary*

## Compensation

Herb Goodman, *chairperson*  
Madeleine Parmley  
John Skilton  
Jeanne Woodford  
Don Meurer, *consultant*  
Eugene O'Brien, *consultant*  
Olga Mesonjnik, *secretary*

## Conference

Bill Clark, *chairperson*  
Ken Brueggemann  
John Kane  
Jo-Anne Lowenberger  
George Martin  
Madeleine Parmley  
Jane Tolar  
Doug Richardson, *secretary*

## Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities

Bob Mayer, *chairperson*  
Conley Byrd  
Bill Clark  
Ward Ewing  
Rogelio Flores  
Vic Phillips  
Roberta Lindeman  
Ray Massey

Mary Dargan, *secretary* —C.P.C.  
Warren Stafford, *secretary*  
—Treatment Facilities

## Corrections

Jeanne Woodford, *chairperson*  
Terry Bedient  
Ken Brueggemann  
Bill Clark  
Rogelio Flores  
Roberta Lindeman  
Jo-Anne Lowenberger  
George Martin  
Vic Phillips  
Gayle Solheim Riese, *secretary*

## Finance & Budgetary

Terrance Bedient, *chairperson*  
Ginger Rhoades Bell  
Herb Goodman  
Dorothy Hurley  
John Kane  
Howard Lowery  
George Martin  
Madeleine Parmley  
John Skilton  
Kevin Sunkel,  
*consultant/independent auditor*  
Donald Meurer, *secretary*

## International

Dorothy Wilson, *chairperson*  
Terry Bedient  
James Branscome  
Ken Brueggemann  
Paul Cleary  
Herb Goodman  
Jo-Anne Lowenberger  
Bob Mayer  
Julio Espallat, *secretary*

## International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Herb Goodman, *chairperson*  
Ginger Rhoades Bell  
Conley Byrd  
Dorothy Hurley  
John Kane  
Jane Tolar  
Dorothy Wilson  
Rick Walker, *secretary*

## Literature

Dorothy Hurley, *chairperson*  
Ginger Bell  
James Branscome  
\*Lizz Hudson  
John Kane  
Roberta Lindeman  
Howard Lowery  
Jane Tolar  
Christopher Cavanaugh, *consultant*  
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*  
Eva Sanchez, *secretary*

## Nominating

Paul Cleary, *chairperson*  
Ward Ewing  
Rogelio Flores  
Raymond Massey  
Bob Mayer  
John Skilton  
Dorothy Wilson  
Jeannne Woodford  
Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*

## Public Information

Ray Massey, *chairperson*,  
James Branscome  
Paul Cleary  
Ward Ewing  
\*Larry Fennelly  
\*Tina Hornsby  
\*Paul Hutchinson  
Roberta Lindeman  
Jeanne Woodford  
Irene Kontje, *secretary*

## General Sharing Session

Jeanne Woodford, *chairperson*  
Adrienne Brown, *secretary*



## Officers of the General Service Board

Chair  
Leonard Blumenthal  
First vice-chairperson  
Herb Goodman  
Second vice-chairperson  
Bill Clark  
Secretary  
Bob Mayer  
Treasurer  
Terrance Bedient  
Assistant secretary  
Adrienne Brown  
Assistant treasurer  
Donald Meurer

The new slate of officers  
is given on page 8

\*Denotes appointed committee members

\*\*Leonard Blumenthal is an ex officio member on all committees; Phyllis Halliday is an ex officio on all committees except the Audit Committee, the Compensation Committee and the Nominating Committee.

# 2009 Conference Members

## NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

**\*Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D.** (23205 Hwy 623, Rolly View, Alberta TOC 2KA, Canada) was elected chairman of the board in April 2005, and has served as a Class A trustee since 2000. In 1998 Len retired as chief executive officer of the Alberta Alcohol and Drug Abuse Commission, where he had worked for 30 years. He remains active in the alcoholism field as speaker, consultant and a resource person.

**Terrance M. Bedient** (99 Washington Ave., Suite 410, Albany, NY 12210) was elected a Class A trustee in May 2008. Terry holds a graduate degree in Healthcare Administration from George Washington University and is a fellow of the American College of Healthcare Executives. He is currently vice president of the Medical Society of New York. He has recently served as consultant on the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee, which he now chairs. He also serves on the Audit, Corrections and International Committees.

**William D. Clark, M.D.** (143 Temple Road, Woolwich, ME 04579) was elected a Class A trustee in 2004. He is a graduate of Harvard University and Harvard Medical School, and is board certified in internal medicine. Bill was medical director of the Addiction Resource Center (Brunswick, ME) and an attending physician at Mid Coast Hospital in Brunswick until he retired from patient care activities in 2004. Throughout his career he has taught physicians about alcoholism, with particular attention to doctor-patient communication and relationship issues. He teaches in medical schools and post-graduate programs (residency), presents seminars and programs on alcoholism and writes papers and book chapters on these topics. He chairs the Conference Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, Archives and Corrections Committees.

**Ward B. Ewing, D.D.** (The General Theological Seminary, 175 Ninth Avenue, New York, NY 10011) was elected a Class A trustee in 2004. Ward is a graduate of the General Theological Seminary, where he is now dean and president. For over 30 years he served as pastor of Episcopal congregations in his native Tennessee, and in Florida, Kentucky and Buffalo, New York. He is involved in community ministries and is the author of several books and articles. Ward serves on the Nominating, Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, and Public Information Committees.

**The Hon. Rogelio R. Flores** (Superior Court of the State of California, Santa Maria Div., 312-M East Cook St., Santa Maria, CA 93456-5165) was elected Class A trustee in April 2007. A graduate of the UCLA School of Law, Judge Flores is now the Senior Judge on the Superior Court of Santa Barbara. He is assigned to various collaborative courts, including Drug Court and Mental Health Court, and is on the Board of Directors of the National Association of Drug Court Professionals. Rogelio serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, Corrections and Nominating Committees.

**\*Herbert I. Goodman** (5710 Tecumseh Circle, Houston, TX 77057) was elected a Class A trustee in 2003. Herbert holds degrees in chemistry, international economics and business from the University of Pittsburgh, Harvard, and the University of Besancon in France. Herbert is CEO of an international corporation involved with petroleum products and energy conservation. He chairs the International Conventions/Regional Forums and Compensation Committees and serves on the Audit, Finance & Budgetary and International Committees.

**Jeanne S. Woodford** (San Francisco Adult Probation Dept., 880 Bryant St., Rm. 200, San Francisco, CA 94103) was elected a Class

A trustee in April 2005. Jeanne's background is in criminal justice and she has served in various positions, from correctional counselor to warden at the California State Prison, San Quentin. She was the former undersecretary, California Department of Corrections and Rehabilitation, Sacramento. She is currently the Adult Chief Probation Officer for the city and county of San Francisco. Jeanne chairs the Corrections Committee and serves on the Nominating and Public Information Committees.

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## ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

**Kenneth Brueggemann** (6111 Belvedere Blvd., Omaha, NE 68111-1274) was elected West Central Regional trustee in May 2008. A Panel 48 delegate, Ken remains active in his area. When he served as area remote communities chair he was instrumental in having A.A. literature translated into Nuer for the Sudanese population, and for 25 years has worked with groups in prisons and jails. Having taught high school for 32 years, Ken continues to substitute teach. He serves on the Conference, Corrections and International Committees.

**Conley F. Byrd, Jr.** (Box 3, 1506 S. Hwy. 365, Redfield, AR 72132) was elected Southwest regional trustee in April 2007. A Panel 43 delegate, Conley is active in his group, district and area. A graduate of LSU School of Veterinary Medicine, he is owner and sole practitioner of a Veterinary Hospital. Conley chairs the Archives Committee and serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Board.

**\*Paul E. Cleary** (2963 Butler Street, Oceanside, CA 92054) was elected general service trustee in April 2005. Paul started in service work in young people's groups. As a Panel 42 delegate he chaired the 1993 Conference Literature Committee, and was a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board from 2002-2005. A clinical social worker, Paul is currently an account executive for a behavioral healthcare firm. He is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board, chairs the Nominating Committee and serves on the International and Public Information Committees.

**Dorothy L. Hurley** (304 Donna Dr., Plymouth Meeting, PA 19462) was elected general service trustee in April 2007. Dorothy served as a nontrustee director on the Grapevine Board (2004-2007) and has been active in her group and intergroup. With a professional background in organization development, administration, and education, she is now a university professor. Dorothy chairs the Literature Committee and serves on Finance and Budgetary, and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees. She is a member of the Grapevine Board.

**John J. Kane, Jr.** (549 Grant Ave., Collingswood, NJ 08107-1926) was elected Northeast regional trustee in April 2007. A Panel 46 delegate, he served on committees in Area 45 and is an active sponsor. A mechanical engineer by profession, John is currently Community Development Director of his town. John serves on the Conference, Literature, Finance and Budgetary and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees. He is also a director on the A.A.W.S. Board.



**Jo-Anne Lowenberger** (303 Regal Ave., Winnipeg, MB R2M 0P4, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 2007. A Panel 52 delegate, Jo-Anne spearheaded the Canadian Archives Display for the 2005 Spiritual Homecoming in St. Louis. Always active in her area, any happening or service activity is of special interest. After almost 30 years working as a pricing department manager for a large food chain, Jo-Anne joined the ranks of the "retired" in January 2009. Jo-Anne serves on the Conference, Corrections and International Committees.

**\*Howard Lowery** (P.O. Box 684, Columbia, MS 39429) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2005. A former Panel 42 delegate, Howard is actively involved in his home group, sponsorship, and district and area A.A. activities. He owns and manages a local retail store. Howard chairs the Audit Committee and serves on the Archives, Literature, and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

**\*Raymond Massey** (79 Edenvold Place NW, Calgary, AB T3A 3T8, Canada) was elected general service trustee in April 2005. A former Panel 44 delegate, Ray has been involved in Canadian Remote Communities and Young Offenders meetings. He has served as nontrustee director on the Grapevine Board. He owns and operates a Painting and Decorating Contracting business and is a member of the Alberta Apprenticeship & Industry Training Board. Ray chairs the Public Information Committee and serves on the Archives, Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, and Nominating Committees. He is a member of the Grapevine Board.

**\*Robert Mayer** (Box 405, Oak Creek, WI 53154-0405) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2005. A Panel 50 delegate, Bob has been treasurer of the East Central region, actively sponsors, and remains active in area, district and group activities. A Forester by profession, he has worked for the eastern region of the U.S. Forest Service for over 29 years. Currently Bob is a resource specialist, working as the regional fire planner for the eastern region of the United States Forest Service, focusing on out year planning of wild-fire fighting resources and fire program management budgeting. Bob serves as Secretary to the General Service Board, has chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee for two years, and serves on the International and Nominating Committees.

**Madeleine Parmley** (2840 N. Englewood Place, Meridian, ID 83646) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 2006. She served as a Panel 52 delegate and has long been active in carrying the message into jails and prisons, and has volunteered as a camp counselor for incarcerated mothers and their children. Madeleine is a trauma care nurse. She chairs the Grapevine Board and also serves on the Audit, Conference and Finance and Budgetary Committees.

**Victor Phillips** (Suite 204, 516 Cedar Crescent SW, Calgary, AB T3C 2Y8, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in May 2008. A Panel 54 delegate, Vic facilitates workshops and sharing sessions and is an active member in his area's work with remote communities. Vic's professional background is in finance and management. He serves on the Archives, Corrections and Cooperation With the Professional Communities/Treatment Facilities Committees.

**John C. Skilton** (201 Kerby Hill Rd., Fort Washington, MD 20744), a Panel 47 delegate, was elected general service trustee in April 2007. From 2003 to 2007 he was a nontrustee director of the A.A. Grapevine Board. Now retired, John has been a researcher and professor at several universities. He chairs the A.A.W.S. Board and serves on the Finance and Budgetary and Nominating Committees. John died prior to the 2009 Conference.

**\*Dorothy Wilson** (2602 Walker Avenue, Indianapolis, IN 46203) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2005. A Panel 44 delegate, Dorothy had remained active in her group, district, area and region. She has worked with children in a variety of educational programs. Dorothy chairs the International Committee and serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees. She is a director on the A.A.W.S. Board.

### ***Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 2009 Conference***

**Frances L. Brisbane, Ph.D.** (53 Rustic Ave., Medford, NY 11763) was elected a Class A trustee in 2009. A graduate of Columbia University School of Social Work, she received a doctorate in Organization Development from Union Graduate School, Yellow Spring, Ohio. Frances is the author of many articles and publications and has over 100 major presentations, nationally and internationally, on topics relating to substance abuse prevention and people of African ancestry. She is currently dean and professor, School of Social Welfare, S.U.N.Y. at Stony Brook, New York.

**Corliss Burke, B.Ed.** (11 Hayes Place, Whitehorse, Yukon Y1A 0E1) was elected a Class A trustee in 2009. During her 26 years in the addiction field, Corliss has worked as a counselor, trainer, senior manager and Deputy Minister. Throughout this time, she has always been involved with Alcoholics Anonymous, attending open A.A. meetings in many countries and working to implement the Bridging the Gap program in Alberta and in the Yukon. Currently, her consulting business focuses on addictions program design and development, as well as on counselor training.

**George G. Martin** (209 East Liberty St., Milford, MI 48381) was elected general service trustee in April 2009. George has been a nontrustee director on the A.A. World Services Board, and has served on several trustees' committees, as well as the Employees' Retirement Committee. An attorney, his law practice primarily involves representation of nonprofit corporations in finance and business transactions.

**Don Massey** (3928 Uri St, Metairie, LA 70002) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2009. Don was a Panel 55 delegate and today is an active sponsor who also facilitates group, district and other A.A. entities inventories. An attorney, Don is adjunct professor, University of New Orleans and is an active member of various legal organizations.

**Don Miller** (P.O. Box 270389, Louisville, CO 80027) was elected general service trustee in April 2009. Don, a Panel 49 delegate, served on the A.A. World Service Board as a nontrustee director, 2003-2006. He is involved in project management and organizational development for new businesses.

**Eleanor (El) W. Nault** (588 Crowe Mountain Rd., Walhalla, SC 29691) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2009. A Panel 56 delegate, El remains active not only in her home group, but in many area and district service functions. El's professional background is in city and regional planning; she recently retired as a teacher and administrator of a four-year research university.

**Pamela Reising** (31829 Sheridan Dr., Beverly Hills, MI 48025) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2009. A former Panel 45 delegate, Pam is now Michigan Statewide treasurer and facilitator of her area's monthly G.S.R. orientation. Pam's background is in the criminal justice field and she teaches at a state university.

## A.A. World Services Directors

John Skilton, *chairperson, general service trustee*  
 Paul Cleary, *general service trustee*  
 Phyllis Halliday, *G.S.O. general manager*  
 John Kane, *regional trustee*

Roberta Lindeman, *director*  
 George Martin, *director*  
 Jane Tolar, *director*  
 Dorothy Wilson, *trustee-at-large/Canada*  
 Adrienne Brown, *G.S.O. staff member*

## A.A. Grapevine Directors

Madeleine Parmley, *chairperson, regional trustee*  
 Ginger Rhoades Bell, *director*  
 James Branscome, *director*

Robin Bromley, *executive editor*  
 Conley Byrd, *regional trustee*  
 Dorothy Hurley, *general service trustee*  
 Ray Massey, *general service trustee*

## General Service Office Staff

Phyllis Halliday, *general manager*  
 Adrienne Brown  
 Mary Dargan  
 Julio Espallat  
 Irene Kontje  
 Mary Clare Lynch

Valerie O'Neill  
 Doug Richardson  
 Gayle Solheim Riese  
 Eva Sanchez  
 Warren Stafford  
 Rick Walker

## Grapevine Staff

Robin Bromley, *executive editor*  
 Amber Eden, *managing editor*

## Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Militza Alma-Noyola, *staff assistant*  
 Janet Arzooman, *GV assoc. editor*  
 Nadine Baker, *staff assistant*  
 Ellie Biscuti, *support services*  
 Daniel O. Brown, *digital media manager*  
 Janet Bryan, *GV office mgr./executive asst.*  
 Shawn Bunkley, *office coordinator*  
 Angel Calvillo, *Spanish translator*  
 Christopher Cavanaugh, *publications director*  
 Sheila Coppin-Thorn, *staff assistant*  
 Cathalina Davis, *copy room coordinator*  
 Daniel DeFilippis, *asst. controller/business admin.*  
 Joseph Dennon, *executive assistant to general manager*  
 John de Stefano, *Spanish-language editor*  
 John Hackett, *executive editor*  
 Karen Hale, *manager, support services*  
 John Kirwin, Jr., *A.A. events consultant*  
 Elsa Lathan, *staff assistant*  
 Fern Leclerc, *French translator*  
 Marsha Levine, *GV assoc. editor*  
 Ayleen Martinez, *staff assistant*  
 Donald Meurer, *C.F.O., G.S.O.*  
 Michelle Mirza, *senior archivist*  
 Eugene O'Brien, *GV controller*  
 Lise Payette, *French-language editor*  
 Ivelisse Rivera, *asst. to Regional Forums coordinator*  
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*  
 Sharisse Seabury, *staff assistant*  
 Frank Segui, *finance secretary*  
 Charlie Shell, *consultant, project management office*  
 Robert Slotterback, *controller*  
 Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*  
 Yee Tully, *Conference staff assistant*  
 Andre Washington, *office manager*  
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor: Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*  
 Nannie Williams, *staff assistant*  
 Jadine Zernsky, *GV circulation dir.*

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Michael Alexander  
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## Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 59th Conference includes Panel 58 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 59 (new delegates).

## UNITED STATES

| State                                   | Area no. | Panel |                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------|----------|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Alabama/N.W. Florida                    | 1        | 59    | Lisa Wilson<br>8121 Lillian Hwy, #45<br>Pensacola, FL 32506                      |
| Alaska                                  | 2        | 58    | Torvald Hansen<br>Box 1386<br>Anchor Point, AK 99556                             |
| Arizona                                 | 3        | 58    | Dennis Wilson<br>3222 N. Cottontail Circle<br>Tucson, AZ 85749                   |
| Arkansas                                | 4        | 59    | James (J.G.) Regnier<br>51 Kingspark Rd.<br>Little Rock, AR 72227                |
| California<br>Southern                  | 5        | 59    | Mike Peery<br>476 Sturtevant Dr., #K<br>Sierra Madre, CA 91024-1396              |
| Central                                 | 93       | 59    | Jeff Johnson<br>11006 Orion Ave.<br>Missions Hills, CA 91345-1337                |
| Northern Coastal                        | 6        | 59    | David Noll<br>1005H Bryant Way<br>Sunnyvale, CA 94087                            |
| Northern Interior                       | 7        | 58    | Lee Dennis (Lee) Wilson<br>2844 Seine Ave.<br>Davis, CA 95616                    |
| San Diego/Imperial                      | 8        | 58    | Gail Nelson<br>192 Elm Ave.<br>Imperial Beach, CA 91932                          |
| Mid-Southern                            | 9        | 58    | Joe Barrett<br>120 S. Lakeview Ave.<br>Anaheim, CA 92807                         |
| Colorado                                | 10       | 59    | Judith (Judy) Lavezzi<br>2280 Forest Ave.<br>Boulder, CO 80304                   |
| Connecticut                             | 11       | 59    | Ken Bird<br>6 Plant Dr.<br>Waterford, CT 06385                                   |
| Delaware                                | 12       | 58    | *Frank Ziemba<br>1 Lindsay Lane<br>Ocean View, DE 19970                          |
| District of Columbia                    | 13       | 59    | Delma (Elaine) Gaisey<br>1825 Maryland Ave. NE, #18<br>Washington, DC 20002-3072 |
| Florida<br>North                        | 14       | 59    | Chet Parker<br>1006 Eastern Way<br>Orlando, FL 32804                             |
| S. Florida/<br>Bahamas/V.I./<br>Antigua | 15       | 59    | Ken Clark<br>601 23rd Place SW<br>Vero Beach, FL 32962-8110                      |
| Georgia                                 | 16       | 58    | David Morgan<br>Box 355<br>Abbeville, GA 31001                                   |
| Hawaii                                  | 17       | 59    | Elizabeth Martin<br>46-271 Heeia St.<br>Kaneohe, HI 96744                        |
| Idaho                                   | 18       | 58    | David Fox<br>Box 1975<br>Sun Valley, ID 83353-1975                               |

\* Alternate delegate, who replaced the delegate, Joe Schranck, who died prior to Conference.

| <u>State</u>         | <u>Area<br/>no.</u> | <u>Panel</u> |                                                                        | <u>State</u>                        | <u>Area<br/>no.</u> | <u>Panel</u> |                                                                     |
|----------------------|---------------------|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|---------------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Illinois</b>      |                     |              |                                                                        | <b>Montana</b>                      | 40                  | 59           | Carole Boerner<br>4522 Shasta Ln.<br>Billings, MT 59101             |
| <i>Chicago</i>       | 19                  | 59           | Ruben Gonzalez<br>9261 S. Western Ave.<br>Chicago, IL 60643            | <b>Nebraska</b>                     | 41                  | 58           | Lori Geistlinger<br>Box 265<br>Hallam, NE 68368                     |
| <i>Northern</i>      | 20                  | 58           | John Conway<br>5107 Patton Dr.<br>Wonder Lake, IL 60097                | <b>Nevada</b>                       | 42                  | 59           | Jason Carter<br>4255 Wedekind Rd., #726<br>Sparks, NV 89431         |
| <i>Southern</i>      | 21                  | 59           | Dean Strassner<br>724 N. Bruns Lane, #D<br>Springfield, IL 62702       | <b>New Hampshire</b>                | 43                  | 58           | Kevin Short<br>18 Sunridge Rd.<br>Windham, NH 03087                 |
| <b>Indiana</b>       |                     |              |                                                                        | <b>New Jersey</b>                   |                     |              |                                                                     |
| <i>Northern</i>      | 22                  | 59           | Barbara Simington<br>6703 Waveland Ave.<br>Hammond, IN 46323           | <i>Northern</i>                     | 44                  | 59           | Cathie Feenie<br>401 Hickory St.<br>Kearny, NJ 07032                |
| <i>Southern</i>      | 23                  | 58           | Michalene Reilly<br>912 W. Countryside Lane<br>Bloomington, IN 47403   | <i>Southern</i>                     | 45                  | 58           | Frederick (Fred) Ellis<br>19 W. Linden Ave.<br>Lindenwold, NJ 08021 |
| <b>Iowa</b>          | 24                  | 59           | Rick Carter<br>1551 Washington St.<br>Muscatine, IA 52761              | <b>New Mexico</b>                   | 46                  | 58           | Ralph Trigg<br>4 Maize Trail<br>Placitas, NM 87043                  |
| <b>Kansas</b>        | 25                  | 58           | Bruce Kesl<br>333 Tallgrass Dr.<br>Lawrence, KS 66049                  | <b>New York</b>                     |                     |              |                                                                     |
| <b>Kentucky</b>      | 26                  | 58           | Barbara Frizzell<br>415 Tinchier Dr.<br>Versailles, KY 40383           | <i>Central</i>                      | 47                  | 59           | Vada Good<br>45 Winston Woods<br>Brockport, NY 14420                |
| <b>Louisiana</b>     | 27                  | 59           | Robert (Bob) Williams<br>2149 Helen St.<br>Opelousas, LA 70570         | <i>Hudson/Mohawk/<br/>Berkshire</i> | 48                  | 58           | Joan Ramsey<br>2 Wendell Dr.<br>Albany, NY 12205                    |
| <b>Maine</b>         | 28                  | 58           | Kathi Davis<br>2629 H Rd.<br>Acton, ME 04001                           | <i>Southeast</i>                    | 49                  | 59           | Richard Sime<br>50 Morningside Dr., #62<br>New York, NY 10025       |
| <b>Maryland</b>      | 29                  | 58           | Thomas (Tom) Revelle<br>763 Match Point Dr.<br>Arnold, MD 21012        | <i>Western</i>                      | 50                  | 58           | Cheryl Akin<br>10 Juliet St.<br>Jamestown, NY 14701                 |
| <b>Massachusetts</b> |                     |              |                                                                        | <b>North Carolina</b>               | 51                  | 59           | Deborah Attix<br>2401 W. Club Blvd.<br>Durham, NC 27705             |
| <i>Eastern</i>       | 30                  | 59           | John Howland<br>105 Mt. Pleasant Ave.<br>Roxbury, MA 02119             | <b>North Dakota</b>                 | 52                  | 59           | Lorna O'Connor<br>121 9th Ave. West<br>Dickinson, ND 58601          |
| <i>Western</i>       | 31                  | 58           | Sara (Sally) Spencer<br>182 N. Washington St.<br>Belchertown, MA 01007 | <b>Ohio</b>                         |                     |              |                                                                     |
| <b>Michigan</b>      |                     |              |                                                                        | <i>Central Southeast</i>            | 53                  | 59           | Jean Smythe<br>8411 Central College Rd.<br>New Albany, OH 43054     |
| <i>Central</i>       | 32                  | 59           | Michael (Mike) Kimling<br>2461 Steff-Ann Dr.<br>Adrian, MI 49221       | <i>Northeast</i>                    | 54                  | 59           | Dan (Danny) Fitzgerald<br>25 Frederick Ave., #4<br>Akron, OH 44310  |
| <i>Southeast</i>     | 33                  | 59           | Derek Daniel<br>200 S. West, #2<br>Royal Oak, MI 48067                 | <i>NW Ohio/SE Mich.</i>             | 55                  | 58           | John Zidarín<br>3774 Hill Ave., #100<br>Toledo, OH 43607            |
| <i>Western</i>       | 34                  | 58           | Gregg King<br>526 Third St.<br>Manistee, MI 49660                      | <i>Southwest</i>                    | 56                  | 58           | Suzanne Welham<br>8025 Kimbee Dr.<br>Cincinnati, OH 45224           |
| <b>Minnesota</b>     |                     |              |                                                                        | <b>Oklahoma</b>                     | 57                  | 59           | Ross Drinen<br>11013 E. 63rd St.<br>Tulsa, OK 74133                 |
| <i>Northern</i>      | 35                  | 58           | JoAnne Nelson<br>816 Fir St.<br>Brainerd, MN 56401                     | <b>Oregon</b>                       | 58                  | 58           | David (Dave) Adelhart<br>Box 2974<br>Oregon City, OR 97045          |
| <i>Southern</i>      | 36                  | 59           | Scott Ahlgren<br>10970 43rd Ave., N<br>Plymouth, MN 55442              | <b>Pennsylvania</b>                 |                     |              |                                                                     |
| <b>Mississippi</b>   | 37                  | 58           | Helon Hill<br>6237 Browning Dr.<br>Ocean Springs, MS 39564             | <i>Eastern</i>                      | 59                  | 59           | Lowell Long<br>733 W. Third St.<br>Williamsport, PA 17701           |
| <b>Missouri</b>      |                     |              |                                                                        | <i>Western</i>                      | 60                  | 59           | Bonnie Smith<br>211 Phillips Dr.<br>Pittsburgh, PA 15241            |
| <i>Eastern</i>       | 38                  | 59           | Jim Foley<br>510 Sarah Lane, #A<br>Creve Coeur, MO 63141               |                                     |                     |              |                                                                     |
| <i>Western</i>       | 39                  | 59           | Quinn Grose<br>4820 SW Leafwing Dr.<br>Lee's Summit, MO 64082          |                                     |                     |              |                                                                     |

| <u>State</u>                     | <u>Area<br/>no.</u> | <u>Panel</u> |                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------|---------------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Rhode Island                     | 61                  | 58           | Al Davenport<br>1300 Wallum Lake Rd.<br>Pascoag, RI 02859                                         |
| South Carolina                   | 62                  | 58           | Robert Hill<br>Box 51<br>Newberry, SC 29108                                                       |
| South Dakota                     | 63                  | 58           | John Teupel<br>Box 916<br>Spearfish, SD 57783                                                     |
| Tennessee                        | 64                  | 58           | John Antol<br>921 S. Chilhowee Dr.<br>Knoxville, TN 37914                                         |
| Texas                            |                     |              |                                                                                                   |
| <i>Northeast</i>                 | 65                  | 59           | Jimmy Dean<br>8111 LBJ Freeway, #860<br>Dallas, TX 75251                                          |
| <i>Northwest</i>                 | 66                  | 58           | Leon Roberts<br>103 Loma Linda<br>Borger, TX 79007                                                |
| <i>Southeast</i>                 | 67                  | 59           | Betsy Gerber<br>12810 Fox Arrow Lane<br>Houston, TX 77041                                         |
| <i>Southwest</i>                 | 68                  | 58           | Steve Yocum<br>903 N. West<br>Burnet, TX 78611                                                    |
| Utah                             | 69                  | 59           | Monte Stokes<br>138 S. Eccles Ave.<br>Ogden, UT 84404-4015                                        |
| Vermont                          | 70                  | 58           | Andrew (Andy) Coyne<br>Box 167<br>Jamaica, VT 05343                                               |
| Virginia                         | 71                  | 59           | Thomas (Tom) Zamaria<br>13828 Delaney Rd.<br>Woodbridge, VA 22193                                 |
| Washington                       |                     |              |                                                                                                   |
| <i>State East</i>                | 92                  | 58           | Rad Miller<br>1320 Terrace Court<br>East Wenatchee, WA 98802-4348                                 |
| <i>Western</i>                   | 72                  | 59           | David (Dave) Tully<br>13217 Fourth Ave. SW<br>Seattle, WA 98146-3338                              |
| West Virginia                    | 73                  | 59           | Kathleen (Kathy) O'Shea<br>Box 1144<br>Huntington, WV 25713                                       |
| Wisconsin                        |                     |              |                                                                                                   |
| <i>No. WI/<br/>  Up. Pen. MI</i> | 74                  | 58           | Dorothy (Dodie) Ash<br>221 Tainter St.<br>Chetek, WI 54728                                        |
| <i>Southern</i>                  | 75                  | 59           | Stu Elwing<br>Box 357<br>Campbellsport, WI 53010-0357                                             |
| Wyoming                          | 76                  | 58           | Brooke Collins<br>38 Monarch Rd.<br>Ranchester, WY 82839                                          |
| Puerto Rico                      | 77                  | 58           | Juan Andonio (Antonio)<br>Rodriguez<br>Box 175<br>Portales de San Juan<br>San Juan, PR 00924-4582 |

## CANADA

| <u>Province</u>                       | <u>Area<br/>no.</u> | <u>Panel</u> |                                                                               |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Alberta/N.W.T.                        | 78                  | 58           | Dave Bruha<br>Box 551<br>Consort, AB T0C 1B0                                  |
| B.C./Yukon                            | 79                  | 59           | Martin (Marty) Watters<br>9478 Greenglade Rd.<br>Sidney, BC V8L 3T7           |
| Manitoba                              | 80                  | 58           | John Johnson<br>#4-388 McKay Ave.<br>Winnipeg, MB R2G 0N4                     |
| New Brunswick/P.E.I.                  | 81                  | 58           | Hari Boggs<br>304-22 Mutch Dr.<br>Stratford, PEI C1B 1S2                      |
| Nova Scotia/<br>Newfoundland/Labrador | 82                  | 59           | William (Billy) Corbett<br>509 English Mountain Rd.<br>Kentville, NS B4N 3V8  |
| Ontario                               |                     |              |                                                                               |
| <i>Eastern</i>                        | 83                  | 59           | Sandra (Sandy) Smith<br>38 Bourdeau Crescent<br>Embrun, ON K0A 1W0            |
| <i>Northeast</i>                      | 84                  | 59           | Cathie Jones<br>130 Churchill Blvd.<br>Sault Ste. Marie, ON P6A 3Z8           |
| <i>Northwest</i>                      | 85                  | 59           | JoAnne Taylor<br>412 N. James St.<br>Thundar Bay, ON P7C 4T2                  |
| <i>Western</i>                        | 86                  | 58           | Martin Aire<br>14 Gibson Ave.<br>Hamilton, ON L8L 6J5                         |
| Quebec                                |                     |              |                                                                               |
| <i>Southwest</i>                      | 87                  | 58           | Ginette Williams<br>43, Rue Dupont<br>St-Antoine-Sur-Richelieu,<br>PQ J06 1R0 |
| <i>Southeast</i>                      | 88                  | 59           | Réal Normandin<br>380, rue St-Georges<br>Windsor, PQ J1S 1K7                  |
| <i>Northeast</i>                      | 89                  | 59           | Alain Desbiens<br>249 avenue Nolin<br>Alma, PQ G8B 3N5                        |
| <i>Northwest</i>                      | 90                  | 58           | Sylvain LeLièvre<br>925 Jean-Casavan<br>Lavaltrie, PQ J5T 2V4                 |
| Saskatchewan                          | 91                  | 59           | Irma Van De Bon<br>Box 488<br>Esterhazy, SK S0A 0X0                           |

